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DELIVERIES START FROM 20TH JULY

Burnham poised to become next British PM with support from most Labour MPs

Reuters
London, July 10

ANDY BURNHAM is on the brink of becoming Britain's next prime minister after an overwhelming show of support from Labour lawmakers left him all but certain to replace Keir Starmer.

Burnham said he had received nominations from 322 out of the 403 Labour members of parliament on the first day of nominations on Thursday, leaving him one short of ensuring he can be the only candidate.

"It's all starting to feel very real," Burnham said in a short video clip. The nominations for the Labour leadership close next Thursday. Burnham is expected to be formally anointed as Labour leader next Friday and will be officially named as prime minister on July 20.

Once Burnham reaches 323 nominations, no other candidate would be able to secure the backing of the 81 needed to enter the contest to replace Starmer.

QATARI MEDIATORS ARRIVE IN TEHRAN TO REVIVE NEGOTIATIONS

Trump says US agreed to Iran's request for talks, but truce is over

Ahmed Elimam, Eman Abouhassira & Andrew Mills
Dubai, July 10

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said on Friday that Iran had asked to continue talks and the US had agreed, but that the June ceasefire was "over".

His comments came after three Qatari and Saudi commercial tankers came under fire this week, prompting the US to hit Iranian sites, and Iran to respond with strikes on US military installations in neighbouring Gulf states on Thursday. No attacks were reported on Friday.

"The Islamic Republic of Iran has asked us to continue 'talks.' We have agreed to do so, but the United States has stated to them, in no uncertain terms, that the Cease Fire is OVER!" he wrote in a post on Truth Social.

The two nations reached an interim deal last month to end a four-month conflict that has killed thousands and throttled



Vessels in the Strait of Hormuz on Thursday. REUTERS

worldwide energy supplies.

Qatari negotiators were meeting officials in Iran on Friday to seek to de-escalate tensions after the exchange of fire and to discuss navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, a source with knowledge of the situation told Reuters.

Daily tanker traffic through

the critical waterway appeared to have slowed on Friday, after the series of attacks stoked concerns about the recovery of global oil supplies and shipping, and highlighted the fragility of the interim truce.

The Qatari talks in Iran aim to address the implementation of the US-Iran memorandum

of understanding and the issues that triggered the recent escalation, including disputes over navigation in the strait, the source said.

Under the interim deal, the US ended its naval blockade of Iranian ports, and Iran agreed to ensure safe passage of commercial vessels.

However, this week Washington accused Iranian forces of attacking three tankers in the area and struck military sites in Iran in response. While Iran has not claimed responsibility for those attacks, analysts say Tehran uses such actions to gain leverage in negotiations.

Iran then attacked US military sites in Gulf states on Thursday. The US said its action aimed to keep the strait open and that Iran did not control the waterway.

The UN shipping agency's governing council on Friday condemned efforts by Iran to impose sovereignty over the Strait of Hormuz and Tehran's

"unilateral decision" to create a body to control traffic through it.

Prior to this week's attacks, daily tanker traffic had risen to its highest since the war began, averaging 40 ships transiting the strait. That was still far off the pre-conflict average of 125 to 140 daily sailings.

Iran on Thursday buried its slain Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei at the country's holiest shrine in Mashhad, capping a week of funeral processions and rallies. The whereabouts of the new Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei have been a mystery to Iranians and the rest of the world alike, leaving people to guess at his plans for Iran at a turbulent time in the Islamic Republic's 47-year history.

Meanwhile, Trump's inability to end the war has frustrated the president, whose Republican Party faces midterm elections later this year amid high gas prices and voter discontent. REUTERS

Sheikh Hasina plans Bangladesh return in Dec, says may get arrested or killed

Krishna N Das
New Delhi, July 10

OUSTED BANGLADESHI Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina, facing a death sentence back home where her party is banned, told Reuters she and senior party colleagues plan to return from exile in India around December and surrender.

Hasina said she and members of her Awami League aim to return voluntarily to the country they fled two years ago and present themselves in court, testing Bangladesh's handling of its most prominent political opponent. "They may arrest me on my return, they may even kill me," Hasina, 78, said in the nearly hour-long telephone interview late on Thursday and into Friday.

"Still, I have to go," she said. "My party leaders and workers are being subjected to tremendous repression. If death comes, I want it to come on my own soil, where my parents are buried and where their blood was shed"

Hasina said she has held online meetings covering 125 of Bangladesh's 300 parliamentary constituencies as part of efforts to reorganise the Awami League. "They may have convicted me, and I may not be able to contest elections," she said. "But why should they suspend the Awami League? If we have done badly, let the people decide."

Hasina fled Bangladesh in 2024 after protests ended her 20 years as prime minister across multiple terms. The country's war-crimes court sentenced her in November to death in her absence for ordering a deadly crackdown on a student-led uprising. She has denied the charges from exile. REUTERS



“My party leaders and workers are being subjected to tremendous repression. If death comes, I want it to come on my own soil, where my parents are buried and where their blood was shed

SHEIKH HASINA, FORMER BANGLADESH PM

"Cases have been filed against almost all of our leaders and workers, and many of them are in hiding," Hasina told Reuters from her exile home in Delhi. "So I said that this time I am returning home, and one day, all of you should come. All together, we will all surrender in court."

She declined to give a date for her return or say exactly when she would surrender or to what court. "I believe in justice and I feel that once proceedings start, it will be clear to the people how farcical the court is — and that I want to prove it."

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Hasina fled Bangladesh in 2024 after protests ended her 20 years as prime minister across multiple terms. The country's war-crimes court sentenced her in November to death in her absence for ordering a deadly crackdown on a student-led uprising. She has denied the charges from exile. REUTERS

Protests erupt in Nepal after self-immolation by youth

Yubaraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, July 10

GANESH NEPALI, 25, was exploring work opportunities abroad, preferably in the Gulf. But his entry into the passport office yesterday, and an altercation with security personnel after they clamped a wheel lock on his motorbike, ended every dream he had.

Nepali removed petrol from his motorbike, poured it over himself, and set himself on fire in protest. He was rushed by police to Bir Hospital, less than two kilometers away, with 55 per cent burns. He breathed his last today at 11:19 a.m., soon after Prime Minister Balen Shah announced that arrangements had been made to air-transport him to Delhi's AIIMS at state expense.

The incident has sparked nationwide fury, both in parlia-

ment and on the streets, targeting the Prime Minister and Home Minister Sudan Gurung. The latter disclaimed any government role in the incident — from wheel-locking to Nepali's death — while responding to the House of Representatives after members warned against politicising someone's pain.

Nepali had apparently parked his motorbike in front of Gate No. 3 of the Passport Office, a no-parking zone, and took the extreme step after Kathmandu Metropolitan security staff wheel-locked his vehicle. Protesters from student unions assembled at Maitighar, a designated protest area near the Prime Minister's office, demanding he remove his "dark glasses" to see the people's grief. One placard read: "Kalo chasma, kalo coat, dekhdaida janata ko chot" ("You wear dark glasses

and a black coat, and hardly see the grief of the people").

As members accused the Home Minister, who visited the hospital at night, of staging stunts instead of helping the patient, Gurung said that as Home Minister it was his responsibility to protect ordinary citizens and he was doing just that. He added that the security personnel involved were attached to Kathmandu Metropolitan, now ruled by the opposition party, and that the central government had no hand in the incident.

Prime Minister Shah chose not to attend Parliament even today, as the House spent its initial hours raising the issue. Gurung announced that an investigating committee led by a Deputy Inspector General of Police has been constituted to probe the incident.



Deadly wildfire in Spain

A firefighting vehicle in Almeria province of Spain on Friday. One of Spain's deadliest wildfires on record killed 12 people overnight. Several victims of the fire in the southern province of Almeria, a popular holiday destination, were found inside burnt-out vehicles and were thought to have died while trying to flee the flames. REUTERS

Man partly sucked out of plane window, others pull him back in

Costas Kantouris
Thessaloniki (Greece) July 10

A MAN was partially sucked out of an airplane window shortly after takeoff Friday on a Ryanair flight from Greece to Germany, but nearby passengers pulled him back inside.

A Greek hospital official said the 61-year-old passenger was treated for neck and shoulder injuries and friction burns. The official spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak publicly to the media.

The morning flight from the northern Greek city of Thessaloniki to Memmingen near Munich was operated by Ryanair subsidiary Malta Air. Ryanair said the flight "returned to Thessaloniki shortly after takeoff when a passenger window dislodged in-flight."

One passenger, identified only as Christina, told Thessaloniki radio that passengers panicked and screamed and that one passenger was partially sucked out of the window

The airline said in a statement the plane landed normally and passengers returned to the terminal, and one passenger requested and received medical assistance on the ground in Thessaloniki. A replacement aircraft was later provided to fly the passengers to Germany.

Passengers told Greek media that they heard a loud bang, oxygen masks dropped and the plane began to lose altitude.

One passenger, identified only as Christina, told Thessaloniki radio that passengers panicked and screamed and that one passenger was partially sucked out of the window.

"His whole head, neck, shoulders" were pulled out of the window, she said, adding that those seated near him pulled him back in.

"Most people had fallen asleep, we had closed our eyes. We heard a sound, I'd describe it like a tire bursting... but very loud," she said.

"We knew straight away we lost pressure because we lost altitude. ... Screams, shrieks, shouting."

China achieves first controlled recovery of reusable rocket booster

Press Trust of India
Beijing, July 10

CHINA ON Friday achieved its first controlled recovery of an orbital-class reusable rocket booster after its Long March-10B carrier rocket, marking a major milestone in the country's reusable space technology.

The achievement comes over a decade after US-based SpaceX, founded by Elon Musk, became the first company to successfully recover an orbital-class rocket booster in December 2015.

Friday's mission marked China's first successful controlled recovery of a carrier rocket's first stage and represented a major breakthrough in the country's reusable rocket technology, state-run Xinhua

news agency reported.

A controlled recovery of a carrier rocket's first stage involves safely returning a rocket booster back to Earth for reuse after it delivers its payload.

Last December, two other Chinese reusable rockets attempted SpaceX-style vertical landings using grid fins and landing legs, but both attempts ended in failure, the Hong Kong-based South China Morning Post reported.

The Long March-10B carrier rocket was launched from south China's Hainan Province and successfully placed its payload into the designated orbit, Xinhua reported. After the separation of the rocket's first and second stages, the first-stage booster returned and was successfully captured on a sea-based platform using a net-capture system.

MORE THAN 2,40,000 HOUSEHOLDS IN THE CITY KEEP OVER 4,00,000 PET CATS AND DOGS

Dining companions: Hong Kong eateries welcome dogs as city relaxes ban

Alice Fung
Hong Kong, July 10

HONG KONG dog owners and their four-legged friends have gained new freedoms after the city relaxed a decades-old rule, allowing the pets to join them at eateries.

Since 1994, only guide dogs and those performing statutory duties were allowed in restaurants under the city's food business regulation. But the policy change aimed at promoting a pet-friendly culture kicked in Thursday, covering over 900 approved restaurants in the measure's first phase.

It is the city's latest step toward building an animal-

friendly society. Hong Kong now allows pets on certain ferry routes and some metro trains serving rural areas, and public hospitals have started permitting pet visits for palliative care patients.

According to the government, more than 240,000 households in the city keep over 400,000 pet cats and dogs, accounting for about 9% of the city's households.

At Wan Land Cafe, owner Kelvin Chan proudly put up a poster saying his establishment can welcome dogs. Previously, dogs were only allowed in its outdoor area, making it tough for the animals during the hot and humid Hong Kong summer.

Chan doesn't think the new policy will bring a spike in business, but as a dog owner himself, he hopes that it will cultivate a more pet-friendly society. He noted that while dog lovers welcome the change, it might be a challenge for those who are not used to eating out with dogs around.

He hopes that responsible pet owners in restaurants and other public spaces will eventually help nonpet lovers warm up to the idea and understand that being inclusive of pets is a progressive move.

"It could become part of our lives," he said.

Franco Li, a regular at this cafe, said his Shiba, named



A customer feeds his dog inside the Wan Land Cafe. AP

Piku, is happy to have embraced a new way of living that allows it to join Li around the dining table and play with

other dog friends.

"This is such a great step forward for civilization," Li said, holding Piku in his arms.

To prepare for the change, some dog owners have been taking their pets to "dog dining etiquette workshops."

Heyton Lee, a dog trainer for 19 years, was particularly busy ahead of the new measure. His two-hour program that simulated a restaurant setting started with dog owners walking around the restaurant to encourage their pets to stay calm and not get overly-excited when they see their dog friends.

Lee also demonstrated some hand signs which are commonly used to instruct dogs to behave. The main goal was to teach dogs to be calm and show them how to take part in human society. For

example, helping them understand that when people walk past them, the humans do not intend to kick them, he said.

"If a dog is just at home, when it goes out, it could get very nervous. Even if it's just that people want to touch them, they might not want to let people do that," he said.

Under the new measure, dogs must be kept on a leash not exceeding 1.5 meters (5 feet) that must be held by an adult or tied to a fixture. The dogs should also be kept off tables, and may not consume food directly from reusable human utensils.

Dogs considered to be among the "fighting breed" by government standards are not allowed

in the establishments at all.

Restaurants cannot cook food for the dogs but can offer prepackaged food to the pets.

Many eateries have also geared up to welcome their furry customers, with some of them hoping it would help boost their revenues.

Old Fung Teahouse, a dim sum restaurant, invested more than 10,000 Hong Kong dollars (\$1,276) in its preparation, installing an air purifier and setting up simple partitions to separate an area for tables serving pet owners. It also provides pet strollers and cleaning products. Its operators hope opening up to dogs might bring up to a 15% increase in business. AP

SATURDAY, JULY 11, 2026



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JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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EXPRESS special

‘His *laash* (corpse) proved too heavy for State... my father haunted system since 1995 and, clearly, he still does’

Divya Goyal Gopal
Ludhiana, July 10

NAVKIRAN KAUR Khalsa was 10 and her brother Janmeet was eight when they saw their father, human rights activist Jaswant Singh Khalsa, for the last time on the morning of September 6, 1995. By the time they returned from school, he had been picked up from their Amritsar home by the Punjab police.

Three decades later, Khalsa, who was killed in police custody after weeks of torture, is back in public discourse after his biopic, *Satluj*, was removed from an OTT platform.

The Indian Express spoke to Navkiran, now an engineer based in the United States, about growing up with her father, the impact of his case, the controversy around *Satluj*,

EXPRESS
interviewNAVKIRAN KAUR KHALRA
JASWANT SINGH KHALRA'S DAUGHTER

and why she believes his work continues to unsettle the establishment. Excerpts:

You were only 10 when your father was abducted. What do you remember

about those days?

I was young, but my father never hid what he was doing. I remember accompanying him when Ram Narayan Kumar was filming (the documentary) »CONTINUED ON PAGE 9

Govt panel wants ban on *Satluj* to stay, says film whitewashes terror

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, July 10

A GOVERNMENT panel reviewing “*Satluj*”, which was pulled from OTT platform ZEE5 for viewers in India two days after its release on July 3, has recommended to the Information and Broadcasting (I&B) Ministry that the movie remain blocked from public access in the country, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The film, directed by Honey Trehan and starring Diljit Dosanjh, is set in Punjab during the tumultuous insurgency in the 1990s and is based on the life of

THE BIG PICTURE

JASWANT SINGH KHALRA: THE MAN WHO COUNTED THE MISSING [PAGE 14](#)

POLITICS [PAGE 6](#)

CENTRE CONSIDERS AMENDING IT RULES TO REGULATE FILMS ON ALL PLATFORMS

human rights activist Jaswant Singh Khalsa, and shows his death in police custody in the wake of his campaign to probe hundreds of disappearances during the militancy years.

Sources said that the panel, the Inter-Departmental Committee (IDC), has invoked national security and told the Ministry that the film has the potential to threaten the security of the state. It is learnt that the IDC has said the film is appropriately covered under Section 69A of the IT Act.

It is learnt that the committee contended that the film »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

ETHANOL BLENDED PETROL PROGRAMME

E20 here to stay, giving choice not feasible: Govt

• GOVT ADDRESSES QUESTIONS

1 Why did India appear to rush its ethanol blending targets when Brazil took decades?

2 Why don't consumers have the choice of buying pure petrol, E10 or E20?

3 Why isn't E20 cheaper than E10 or pure petrol?

4 There are concerns E20 damages rubber components,



and many vehicle manuals specifically mention 'E10 compatible'.

May cut mileage by up to 5%, but is cleaner, superior in other performance parameters: Ministry

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, July 10

COUNTERING CRITICISM over its ethanol blended petrol programme, the government on Friday said while the current base fuel E20 — 80% petrol, 20% ethanol — can reduce fuel economy in some vehicles by 3-5%, it is cleaner and superior in other performance parameters vis-a-vis pure petrol and lower ethanol-petrol blends.

On consumers not getting the option to choose between pure petrol and ethanol-blended

petrol of different blend levels, the government said that offering multiple grades of base fuel across the country would create an “enormous logistical challenge”, apart from raising costs and reducing operational efficiency in the complex fuel retail network.

The government also argued that achieving 20% ethanol blending levels required massive investments, and going back to a lower blend level would not be prudent on various counts. India achieved 20% ethanol blending in petrol last year and the E20 fuel is currently the standard petrol variant across the country.

There has been public backlash over the E20 fuel, with claims ranging from reduction in mileage to engine component wear and tear in older vehicles whose engines were not designed for higher »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

BUSINESSMAN'S HOUSE IN UPSCALE AREA TARGETED; 4 SHOOTERS KILLED

‘Like a movie scene’: 65 rounds fired in Gurgaon gunbattle

Alok Singh
Gurgaon, July 10

THE CRACKLE of gunfire continued non-stop for a long time, terrifying residents of Gurgaon's Sushant Lok. “It was like a scene from a film,” a woman resident of the upscale neighbourhood told *The Indian Express* on Friday.

“We had never imagined such an incident could happen here. I first thought the sound was of firecrackers, or maybe a transformer sparking,” she said. “But then messages started appearing on our residents' WhatsApp group saying there was shooting going on. We were told to stay indoors as bullets were flying around,” the woman, who declined to give her name, said.

Late on Thursday evening,



A police officer carries arms and ammunition recovered at the site of the shootout in Gurgaon's Sushant Lok, Friday. [RELATED REPORTS, PAGE 4](#)

Gurgaon Police killed four alleged shooters of London-based gangster Deepak Nandal in a dramatic exchange of fire that also left three policemen with gunshot injuries.

Police swept up to the scene shortly after the alleged shooters opened fire outside »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

MANAGEMENT EDUCATION

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



NATION

PAGE 9



SURAT FLOOD TOLL 34, BODIES OF MANY MISSING FOUND ON BANKS OF CREEKS

TO MEET PM CHRISTOPHER LUXON TODAY

Modi first Indian PM to visit New Zealand in 40 years, trade and sports top agenda

Shubhrajit Roy
New Delhi, July 10

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi will meet New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon on Saturday, with talks focused on trade and investment, and high-tech innovation in dairying, farming and high-performance sports, sources said.

Modi arrived in Auckland on the final leg of his three-nation visit, where he was received by Luxon at the airport. This is the first visit to New Zealand by an Indian prime minister in 40 years.

Modi is slated to meet Luxon at Government House in Auckland for bilateral talks on Saturday. “Reached Auckland a short while ago. Thankful to Prime Minister Luxon for the »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E. EXPLAINED

Indo-Pacific outreach

PM's NZ visit is part of Delhi's outreach to the Indo-Pacific countries, as China's assertive behaviour in the region has been a challenge. India has engaged with Japan, Australia and Indonesia in the last few weeks. New Zealand too is reaching out to India for expanding its market, which is part of its economic diversification.

SPORT [PAGE 20](#)

BIG BASH LEAGUE OPENER TO BE PLAYED IN CHENNAI



Prime Minister Narendra Modi being received by New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon in Auckland on Friday. ANI

Facing funding cuts, CSDS faculty speaks up: Grant not stopped even in Emergency

Ritika Chopra
Mumbai, July 10

BREAKING THEIR silence for the first time since the Centre for the Study of Developing Societies (CSDS) came under scrutiny over alleged irregularities, the institute's faculty on Friday expressed “deep concern” over the possibility of losing government funding, saying that “never in the past” had its faculty and staff been denied salaries.

“Even in the years of the Emergency, which most CSDS faculty opposed, the ICSSR grant was not suspended,” the CSDS faculty said in a resolution passed at a meeting on Friday. *The Indian Express* reported on Friday that an inquiry committee appointed by the ICSSR had recommended action against the institute under its grants-in-aid rules, a move that could jeopardise funding that accounts for over 83 per cent of CSDS's income and nearly 90 per cent of its salary bill.

Friday's resolution marks the first time the faculty body has collectively responded since the ICSSR issued a show-cause notice to the institute in August last year following a now-withdrawn post on X by CSDS professor Sanjay Kumar on voter data in Maharashtra. The faculty had remained silent on the inquiry until now.

When contacted, CSDS Director Professor Awadhendra Sharan said, “CSDS will respond formally when it receives a copy of the report. In the meanwhile, the faculty has expressed its response to the story carried by *The Indian Express* suggesting possible »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

SUSPECTED COLLUSION WITH PRIVATE BUYER

Diversion of rice meant for poor in North-East: 5 senior Food Corporation officials suspended

FCI Executive Director (Joint Secy-rank officer) among those under scrutiny

Shyam Lal Yadav
New Delhi, July 10

FIVE OFFICIALS of the Food Corporation of India (FCI), including its Executive Director, have been suspended for alleged irregularities in the sale of

rice meant for public distribution in the North Eastern states, *The Indian Express* has learned.

On July 6, the Department of Food and Public Distribution, under the Ministry, issued a suspension order against Ashutosh Joshi, FCI's Executive Director.

Joshi, a 1994-batch Indian Audit and Accounts Service (IA&AS) officer — equivalent to Joint Secretary rank — who joined FCI in 2023, was suspended with immediate effect. Joshi was unavailable for comment.

The next day, FCI issued suspension orders for: Anupam Dubey, General Manager, FCI Headquarters, Delhi; Vikash Krishna, Deputy General Manager, FCI Headquarters,

Delhi; and Brahm Prakash, Assistant General Manager, Gurugram.

These three suspension orders, issued by FCI Managing Director Rabindra Kumar Agarwal, state that disciplinary proceedings against the officers are related to the findings of a committee. Its probe, sources say, found alleged irregularities, including diversion, in the sale of »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• LAST YEAR, BOMBAY HC ACQUITTED ALL 12 CONVICTS; MAHARASHTRA GOVT HAS CHALLENGED IT IN SUPREME COURT

7/11 Mumbai train blasts: 20 yrs on, survivors rebuild lives — still wait for justice

Purnima Sah
Mumbai, July 10

TWENTY YEARS after seven coordinated bomb blasts ripped through Mumbai's packed Western Railway suburban trains during the evening rush hour on July 11, 2006, many of the survivors continue to carry the physical, emotional and financial consequences of that evening.

The blasts killed 187 people and injured 817. Last year, the Bombay High Court acquitted all 12 men convicted by a special court in the case, holding that the prosecution had failed to prove its case beyond a reason-

able doubt. The Maharashtra government has since challenged the acquittal before the Supreme Court.

For many survivors, the acquittal reopened wounds they had spent years trying to heal. Alongside the uncertainty over who was responsible, many say they continue to receive little long-term support despite living with permanent disabilities.

‘I don't let the wheelchair define me’

For Chirag Arvind Chauhan, 40, a chartered accountant, lawyer and founder of CA Chauhan & Co in Malad, life has been di-

vided into two distinct halves.

“It has been 20 years. I have lived 20 years of a normal life and 20 years in a wheelchair, so it feels like I have lived life in two equal halves,” Chauhan said.

In 2006, then 20-year-old Chauhan was pursuing chartered accountancy and doing his articleship at a firm in the Fort area. On the evening of July 11, he was returning home when the explosion changed his life. The blast left him with a spinal cord injury that paralysed nearly 85% of his body below the chest.

He remained hospitalised for nearly two-and-a-half months before beginning physiotherapy. The recovery



was slow, and it took almost two years before he could sit comfortably for long hours.

“Initially, even sitting up-



(Left) Mahendra Vilas Pitale, an office superintendent with Western Railway, lost a hand in the blast and uses a prosthetic limb; Chirag Arvind Chauhan, a CA, uses a wheelchair due to his spinal injury

right would make me feel faint. Slowly, my body adapted,” he recalled.

Rather than dwell on what

he had lost, Chauhan said he consciously chose to rebuild. “At that point, the biggest challenge was deciding whether I

wanted to keep looking back or move forward. I chose to look forward,” he said.

He credits his mother, three elder sisters, friends and colleagues for helping him restart his life. His articleship firm supported him financially and arranged a laptop so he could continue working from home. He later completed his chartered accountancy, founded his own practice in 2012 after a failed start-up venture, completed an LLB, learnt to drive a hand-controlled car, and has now driven over 1.5 lakh kilometres across India.

Today, he follows a disciplined routine: waking up at 6 am, going to the gym and work-

ing full-time at his office. “I don't let the wheelchair define me,” he said.

Yet, despite moving on personally, Chauhan says the question of justice continues to trouble survivors.

He said, “When the acquittal came last year, we were all upset because justice had not been delivered. We still don't know who actually carried out the blasts. The authorities say one thing, while those who were accused say they are also victims. So, who do we believe? Maybe the real accused are still roaming free.”

He demanded that the actual culprits be punished as per »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma with state Finance Minister Jayanta Malla Baruah in the Assembly on Friday. ANI

In Assam Budget, satellite city near Guwahati airport, semiconductor push

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 10

THE RECENTLY elected second-term Himanta Biswa Sarma-led Assam government presented its Budget for 202-2027 on Friday, in which it announced several new projects, including the development of an 'aerotropolis' satellite city around the Guwahati international airport and a 'Semiconductor Ecosystem' project, and setting up of a proton therapy facility for cancer treatment at the state-run Gauhati Medical College and Hospital.

Finance Minister Jayanta Mallabaruah presented a Rs 2,85,084 crore Budget, which CM Sarma termed a "revenue neutral Budget".

Mallabaruah's Budget speech outlined the state government's plans for next five years. Among its flagship initiatives, he said, is acting on its promise of two lakh jobs.

"Over the next five years, the government will target 2 lakh employment opportunities across the broader public sector ecosystem of the state... A dedicated Task Force under the chairmanship of the Chief Secretary has already been constituted to prepare a comprehensive roadmap..." he said.

He proposes to allocate over Rs 6,000 crore under different grants for the government's basket of flagship beneficiary welfare schemes. However, during his speech, he said that any man "practicing polygamy" shall not be eligible to avail benefits under any government welfare scheme "in order to promote women's empowerment and gender justice." This comes after the government has passed state's Uniform Civil Code Bill and enacted a legislation making polygamy a criminal offence. Along with announcing out-

lay for furthering the road, bridge and energy projects in the state, Mallabaruah announced the allocation of a sum of Rs. 2100 crore for land acquisition for an airport satellite city project.

"I propose the development of an Aerotropolis around the Lokpriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport as the nucleus. The new bridge over Brahmaputra near the airport will give further fillip to the urban growth. The project will be implemented through the Guwahati Satellite City Development Authority (GSCDA), a dedicated Special Purpose Vehicle of Government of Assam. This will be a 100 percent Government-owned project, ensuring that the benefits of development accrue directly to the people of Assam," he said.

He announced a proton therapy facility, at an investment of around Rs 550 crore, is expected to be operational at Gauhati Medical College and Hospital within three year, and the government will undertake a feasibility study for integrating a metro project over or alongside the existing Guwahati Ring Road project.

He announced Tata Electric's semiconductor assembly and testing facility in the state is expected to commence production, and proposed to launch 'Semiconductor Ecosystem on Manufacturing and Innovation project' in partnership with Japan International Cooperation Agency. Estimating an outlay of around Rs. 1164 over five years, he said, "The project will create world-class infrastructure, establish a dedicated ecosystem to attract global investments, generate employment, strengthen MSMEs and place Assam at the forefront of India's semiconductor revolution."

'Like a movie scene'

the three-storey residence of businessman Vishal Beri. "It happened between 10 pm and 10.30 pm," another resident of the neighbourhood, a businessman who lives in a bungalow not far from Beri's home, said. "We heard a volley of gunshots for a few minutes. Then it stopped, and started again after some time. A few minutes later, we saw a large number of policemen in the lane," he said.

Several residents recorded videos of the shootout from their homes. In one of the videos, a man holding a weapon can be seen moving towards Beri's residence. Residents said they had been told later that the man was a plainclothes police officer.

A police source said that a Crime Branch team under the supervision of DCP (Crime) Hitesh Yadav had laid a trap near Beri's residence, located at a T-junction in a lane in Sushant Lok Phase 1, about 500 metres from M G Road. The lane has both bungalows and buildings comprising builder floors. "On Thursday evening, the Crime Branch received a tip-off about the movement of some shooters near Beri's residence. Officials from police stations in Sectors 17, 39, and 40 were immediately called, and a joint team was formed. Policemen were deployed around the locality in three vehicles," the source said.

Around 9.45 pm, a black Scorpio SUV with its front number plate covered by black tape, entered the lane from the MG Road side, police said. As soon as the vehicle stopped, three men got off and allegedly opened fire at Beri's residence.

Another man recorded the shooting on a mobile phone, apparently as proof for their boss. Police believe the occupants of the vehicle intended to be inside the neighbourhood before 11 pm, after which no vehicles are allowed to enter without prior registration.

Beri had received several threats earlier, and police suspect the accused had carried out prior reconnaissance of the area. According to the source, they had demanded Rs 10 crore, and threatened him with serious consequences if he failed to pay up.

As the firing began, the Crime Branch team, which was lying in wait, moved in from three sides, taking advantage of the house's location at a T-junction. On spotting the police, the shooters allegedly opened fire, and the officers retaliated. A police officer said the driver of the Scorpio rammed the vehicle into some bushes by the roadside.

All five occupants of the Scorpio and three of the policemen sustained gunshot injuries. Four of the shooters were declared dead in hospital. They had received more than two dozen bullets in their bodies, sources said.

According to another police source, around 65 rounds were fired by both sides during the encounter. Five foreign-made semi-automatic pistols were recovered from the accused. "It is suspected they planned to open fire at Beri's residence to frighten the family. However, the motive and sequence of events are being investigated. One of the accused remains in critical condition in hospital," the source said.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

E20 here to stay

ethanol blends.

The government has been attempting to allay such fears, saying that the drop in mileage in older vehicles would be marginal, outweighed by benefits like higher octane rating, superior anti-knock characteristics, faster combustion, better pickup, smoother acceleration and cleaner engine operation. The government has also rejected claims that E20 fuel could damage engine components.

As reported on Friday, Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari had told The Indian Express that reports of vehicular damage being circulated on social media were "overblown" and part of a concerted "false narrative". He had said that while average mileage could dip as ethanol content increases, the West Asian crisis has shown that India must explore all alternatives to fossil fuel imports.

There have also been questions on why consumers were not being offered a choice between pure petrol, E10 and E20 fuels, as is the practice in some countries.

"...if a cleaner, faster and less-polluting fuel is available, why would we deliberately choose an inferior alternative? The suggestion that every petrol pump should stock pure petrol, E10 and E20 simultaneously also ignores the realities of India's fuel distribution network. India operates over one lakh retail outlets, supported by an extensive network of refineries, terminals, depots and pipelines. Maintaining multiple grades of base petrol

across this vast supply chain would create an enormous logistical challenge, increase handling costs, complicate inventory management and reduce operational efficiency," the Petroleum Ministry said in a detailed note on Friday.

"Over the past several years, public sector banks have financed nearly Rs 1 lakh crore/yr of investments in ethanol production and associated infrastructure... If, after creating this capacity, we were to arbitrarily revert to E10, what happens to these investments? What happens to the surplus production capacity? What happens to thousands of crores invested by farmers, cooperatives, entrepreneurs, financial institutions and public sector companies in good faith based on a national policy? Public policy must balance consumer interest with energy security, environmental sustainability, farmer welfare and prudent use of national resources," the ministry said.

Seeking to dismiss concerns that ethanol blending in petrol was accelerated in haste, the ministry said the rollout was not based "on assumptions", but done after detailed consultations with automobile manufacturers and other stakeholders, and extensive testing and field validation covering engine durability, fuel systems, material compatibility, corrosion resistance, drivability, emissions and performance.

However, following the backlash, there are indications that introduction of higher blends of ethanol in petrol may be delayed by the government. On Tuesday, The Indian Ex-

press had reported that the government was likely to push back the proposed shift to E25 fuel.

In its note on Friday, the ministry reiterated that the ethanol-petrol blending programme dates back over two decades, and "nobody questioned ethanol as a fuel", given its use in various countries, including the US and Brazil. After languishing for about a decade, India's ethanol blending programme gathered pace over the past few years as the government made concerted efforts to ensure sufficient ethanol availability.

"When India decided to move towards higher ethanol blends, the automobile industry was involved at every stage. For E10 compatibility, manufacturers were consulted well in advance, as early as 2020-21. India achieved its E10 target in June 2022... For E20, an even more rigorous process was followed. Extensive consultations were held with automobile manufacturers, component suppliers, testing agencies and research institutions. The roadmap of the IMC (Inter-Ministerial Committee) had been in the public domain from 2021 and laid out a calibrated path to reaching E20," the ministry said.

"Had automobile manufacturers not been fully satisfied with the results, they would never have stood behind the product or honoured vehicle warranties. The fact that virtually every manufacturer today is honouring warranty for all vehicles (old or new) is because they have been part of the consultation. Further, Maruti Suzuki serviced 2.84 crore vehicles during FY 2025-26, including 1.5 crore older, non-E20-certified vehicles, and re-

ported no E20-linked corrosion, abnormal wear or component-life damage. Hero MotoCorp has reported similar field experience. This real-world evidence is far more reliable than isolated anecdotes," it said.

According to the ministry, if E20 was damaging rubber components, fuel lines or engines, there would have been lakhs of warranty claims by vehicle owners, widespread component failures, and an avalanche of complaints across the country, which "has simply not happened". The government also assured that the ethanol supply chain is among the most tightly regulated fuel supply systems, and that ethanol and blended petrol conform to strict Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) specifications and undergo quality checks at every stage from the "distillery to the depot to the retail outlet".

"E20 is a safe, cleaner, proven and scientifically validated fuel that Indian consumers can use with confidence. Its quality, safety and compatibility have been validated and assured by all responsible stakeholders, including automobile manufacturers, testing and homologation agencies, oil marketing companies, and regulatory authorities. Consumers are therefore advised not to be misled by misinformation, scaremongering or unverified content circulating on social media," it said.

On pricing, the ministry said E20 is not necessarily cheaper because ethanol procurement prices are fixed at remunerative levels to support farmers and can exceed the cost of petrol when international crude prices are relatively low.

FCI

rice to the North Eastern Regional Agricultural Marketing Corporation Limited (NERA-MAC) under the Open Market Sale Scheme (Domestic) by FCI's Delhi Region.

On May 25, KP Asha, General Manager, FCI Regional Office, Delhi was suspended. Her suspension order alleged that she "has committed serious derelictions of duty and administrative lapses while discharging her official responsibilities and failed to maintain the desired standards of operation in issue of Rice without auction to NERA-MAC which is not covered under the current OMSS(D) Policy."

When contacted by *The Indian Express*, FCI Managing Director Rabindra Kumar Agarwal declined to comment. Sources said that action against additional officials is likely in the coming days. Minister for Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, under whom FCI falls, Pralhad Joshi was unavailable for comment.

Sources said rice earmarked for distribution to poor beneficiaries under the public distribution system in Assam and other North Eastern states was allegedly diverted and sold to a private entity in violation of government policy. Officials are suspected of colluding with the private buyer.

NERAMAC, a public sector enterprise under the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (DoNER), had earlier suspended two of its officials in connection with the same case. On June 23 this year, NERAMAC announced the suspension of its Managing Director Bhaskar Barua (w.e.f. June 17) and Additional General Manager (Agribusiness & I/c Marketing) Anjal Kr. Dutta (w.e.f. June 18).

The Open Market Sale Scheme (Domestic) is a government initiative under which FCI sells surplus foodgrains through e-auctions at predetermined reserve prices to stabilise market prices and ensure steady supply.

95". However, the makers did not comply with the 127 cuts and title change suggested by the censor board, and mounted a legal challenge in the Bombay High Court before withdrawing the plea.

ZEE5's takedown of the film had triggered widespread debate with political parties and the Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC) pushing for screening to be resumed and Dosanjh stating that he "had a feeling that something like this would happen".

OTT content is not regulated by the CBFC but covered under the provisions of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021. A code of ethics, which is part of the IT Rules, requires OTT platforms to avoid publishing content prohibited by law and to undertake age-based classification of content.

The Bombay High Court has placed an interim pan-India stay on Rules 9(1) and 9(3) of the IT Rules 2021, which required digital news media and online publishers to adhere to the "code of ethics" and a three-tier grievance redressal mechanism.

Section 69A of the IT Act has generated debate over the years about free speech and censorship, given its increasing use. While the Government has underlined its necessity for national security, critics say the process is opaque, heavily executive-driven, and prone to excessive censorship.

Under this section, data provided by the Government in Parliament shows, as many as 36,838 URLs were blocked between January 2018 and October 2023. The operative language of the section states that the Centre may issue directions for blocking when it is "necessary or expedient" to do so in the interest of sovereignty and integrity of India, defence of India, security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, or to prevent incitement to cognizable offences — the rules under it require reasons in writing and a defined procedure.

now taking the matter to the Supreme Court, he said survivors are waiting to see how the case progresses.

After the blast, Pitale received a letter asking him to apply for a government job on compassionate grounds. He applied in 2008 but was appointed by Western Railway only in 2015, he said, after former MP Kirit Somaiya intervened. His biggest struggle today is rehabilitation. "A good prosthetic hand costs around Rs 10 lakh. The government has never provided financial assistance for it."

While he received compensation and insurance after the blast, none of it covered prosthetic limbs, which require replacement every four to five

Modi in New Zealand

welcome at the airport," Modi said in a post on X.

"This visit is historic, being the first Prime Ministerial visit to New Zealand in four decades. I look forward to holding talks with Prime Minister Luxon and discussing the complete range of the India-NZ friendship. I will also be addressing a community programme tomorrow in Auckland," he said.

In a post on X, the Ministry of External Affairs said, "This historic visit is set to strengthen bilateral ties and unlock new avenues of cooperation across several areas especially trade, defence, sports, culture, education, and people-to-people exchanges."

Calling it a "special welcome in Auckland", the Ministry said in another post that the iconic Sky Tower was illuminated to mark Modi's visit, "symbolising the friendship between our two countries". In his departure statement in New Delhi, Modi had said his visit would "meaningfully build" upon the strong momentum in India-New Zealand ties following Luxon's visit to India in March 2025.

Modi's visit comes at a significant time, following the recent signing of the India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement (FTA). The two sides had decided to start negotiations in March 2025, during Luxon's visit to India, and completed the FTA talks in April this year, signing the pact in a record 13-month span.

Bilateral trade with New Zealand currently stands at US\$2.25 billion. With the FTA and an almost tariff-free business environment, officials said there is a strong likelihood of rapid trade growth. Both countries are also aiming to double their trade in goods and services

by 2030, and the FTA's provision for US\$20 billion in investment in India over the next 15 years is expected to drive stronger economic partnership, officials said.

The strategic and geopolitical backdrop to the visit is New Zealand's desire to diversify its economic partnerships, given its heavy dependence on a single market — a space India is hoping to fill.

Technology and innovation one of New Zealand's strong suits, will be a key focus of the visit. New Zealand spends roughly 1.5% of its GDP on R&D and has achieved excellence in sectors such as dairying, farming and high-performance sports.

"We are trying to partner with New Zealand to learn from their best practices and innovations to strengthen corresponding Indian sectors. New Zealand is in the process of launching Kiwifruit Action Plan, Apple and Pear Action Plan and Honey Action Plan in India; and setting up Centres of Excellence in Kiwifruit in Nagaland and in Uttarakhand," an official said.

"We are also discussing similar cooperation in sports through a Joint Action Plan in Sports," the official said, adding that Modi will attend sports and business engagements at the Viaduct Business Center. India and Australia also signed a sports cooperation roadmap during Modi's visit.

People-to-people ties will be another key aspect of the visit, with New Zealand home to around 3 lakh persons of Indian origin who share a strong connection with India and play an important role in the country's politics, economy and business. Modi will also address the Indian diaspora at a community programme.

CSDS

withdrawal of funds."

Sanjay Kumar had declined to comment on the matter on Thursday, saying he was unaware that the report had been submitted.

The controversy dates back to August 2025 when Kumar posted on X that the number of registered voters in Ramtek and Devlali in Maharashtra had declined sharply between the Lok Sabha and Assembly elections. He later withdrew the post and apologised, saying the research team had misread the data.

On August 28, 2025, the ICSSR issued a showcase notice to CSDS, questioning the "impartiality, objectivity, and quality" of its research, alleging possible political bias and a deliberate attempt to malign constitutional authorities. It also raised issues relating to the institute's administration and finances, and constituted an inquiry committee to examine the matter.

As reported by The Indian Express on Friday, the committee, in its report submitted to the ICSSR, is learnt to have alleged "irregularities": academic appointments in violation of UGC regulations, requisite qualifications; processing of financial matters without complying with General Financial Rules; and appointment of non-academic staff without public advertisement. It has recommended that ICSSR take action against CSDS as per its "grants-in-aid" rules. This can mean suspension of grants, through which most of the salaries at CSDS are paid.

Referring to the inquiry, the faculty said CSDS had fully cooperated with both the committee and the ICSSR. "To date, the CSDS faculty has not seen any draft report of this committee," the faculty resolution stated.

The faculty also disclosed that CSDS has not received

grants from the ICSSR since July 2025, but said academic and administrative work had continued despite the funding uncertainty. The Indian Express has learnt that salary disbursement has been "irregular" since then.

"We wish to underline that while CSDS has not received grants from ICSSR since July 2025, the faculty has continued to discharge all its responsibilities — conducting research, publishing books and articles and organising lectures and workshops. The non-academic staff too has continued to discharge their duties," the resolution said. It added that any withdrawal of grants would have a "debilitating effect" on the institute's functioning.

"As The Express report points out, 90% of our salaries are met from the grants-in-aid and a withdrawal of the same will have a debilitating effect on our academic and institutional functioning," it said.

The resolution also highlighted the long institutional relationship between the CSDS and the ICSSR, noting that the latter has been represented on the CSDS Board of Governors since 1973 and has remained informed of the institute's academic activities through regular reports. It recalled that CSDS founder-director Rajni Kothari went on to serve as ICSSR chairperson between 1977 and 1980, while several other faculty members had served on ICSSR committees and councils over the years. "It will not be an exaggeration to say that the CSDS has been one of ICSSR's flagship institutes," the faculty said.

Describing CSDS as one of India's earliest centres for advanced social science research, the faculty warned that any attempt to "shut down or financially cripple" the institution would be "a major loss for ideas all over the Global South" and would cause "irremediable hardship" to its staff.

he died of a heart attack.

"My father was 47 years old when the blasts took place. He was returning home from work," she recalled.

The blast severely damaged his eardrums, leaving him with permanent hearing loss. He wore hearing aids for the rest of his life. His right arm was also injured, limiting his ability to lift objects. Even years later, rainwater or loud noises caused him pain. "When the explosion happened, my father lost consciousness. He remembered nothing until he regained consciousness later. The only thing he recalled was waking up and walking over dead bodies," she said.

It was only later that doctors discovered he had also suffered

a heart attack during the blast. Because he did not initially appear critically injured, the family said he received only basic treatment. Later complications had to be treated at their own expense. "He could not work for some time. Since he was the only earning member of the family, it created serious financial difficulties. Although he eventually returned to work, he took a local job because he could no longer commute by train. I don't think he ever travelled alone by train after that incident.

Like many of the survivors' and victims' family members, she feels it is essential for those responsible for the blasts to be brought to justice. "...accountability is important," she said.

8 MORE HELD, 23 ARRESTED SO FAR; 9 INFANTS RESCUED

In trafficking racket probe, cops find ‘desire for male child’ link

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, July 10

A RETIRED teacher from Mathura in Uttar Pradesh who allegedly bought a newborn, a community health worker accused of mediating the sale of children, among other mediators, and biological parents — these are among the eight people arrested recently in the interstate child trafficking racket busted last month by the Delhi Police, taking the total number of arrests to 23, officers said on Friday. Three more newborns from Delhi, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand have been rescued, said officers, taking the total number of rescued infants to nine. Police are now searching for Dr Hira Kapoor, the husband of key accused Dr Viveki Kapoor, who ran the hospital in Delhi where the syndicate was operating.

He is absconding and is believed to have played a key role in the alleged racket. The probe so far has revealed that the “desire for a male child” was one of the key factors driving several couples to allegedly bypass the legal adoption process and purchase infants through the syndicate, according to investigators.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh said that sustained questioning of the accused, technical surveillance and financial



Delhi Police holds a press briefing on Friday. EXPRESS

analysis helped investigators dig deeper. “The investigation has revealed that the accused were part of a well-organised network that procured infants from vulnerable biological parents and supplied them to childless couples in different states for substantial monetary consideration. We have also unearthed financial transactions involving several lakhs of rupees,” Singh said.

According to Singh, investigators have identified some of the biological parents involved in the racket. “No IVF or surrogacy angle has emerged during the investigation so far. The syndicate allegedly operated on a demand-and-supply model by identifying couples seeking children outside the legal adop-

tion process and connecting them with vulnerable parents willing to part with their infants for money,” he said.

Eight people who have been arrested recently have been identified as Jyoti, an ASHA (Accredited Social Health Activist) worker from Gurgaon, who allegedly acted as a mediator; Shankar Gamar, a mediator who allegedly sourced infants from biological parents; Sugnaben Gamar and her husband Kantibhai Gamar of Gujarat, who allegedly sold their newborn son; Ketki Gupta, who allegedly purchased a one-month-old baby boy for around Rs 4 lakh; Ram Prakash Nishad, a retired teacher from Mathura, who allegedly bought a male child in 2025; Abha Singh from Haridwar, who, along with her husband Amit Pratap Singh, allegedly procured an eight-month-old baby boy for around Rs 5 lakh.

Even as several biological parents allegedly sold their infants for money, one woman had approached the accused after an unintended pregnancy, said police.

According to investigators, she believed she was giving up the child “for free” and was unaware that the infant would later be sold through the trafficking network. But she terminated the pregnancy and turned into a witness.

Officers said the investiga-

tion has also uncovered financial links between the accused. They alleged that transactions made by a couple from Haridwar were traced to a bank account operated by an accused identified as Pratibha, who was arrested earlier in the case.

All nine rescued children, officers said, have been produced before the Child Welfare Committee, which has issued directions regarding their care, protection and rehabilitation. Police said further investigation is underway to identify other members of the syndicate, trace the remaining financial transactions and make further arrests.

The probe into the alleged racket gained momentum when the Anti Narcotics Cell of the Central district allegedly intercepted three accused near RK Ashram Metro Station during a decoy operation on June 5. Police claimed the trio was attempting to sell a newborn infant to decoy buyers.

A four-to-five-day-old baby boy was rescued and Rs 20,000, allegedly paid as token money during the operation, was recovered. An FIR was subsequently registered at Paharganj police station under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Juvenile Justice Act. Given the sensitivity, Delhi Police constituted a Special Investigation Team (SIT) headed by Additional DCP-II Prashant Chaudhary in the case.

Declare Mandi Road a national highway: Delhi CM writes to Gadkari after requests to NHAI

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 10

DELHI CHIEF Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday wrote a letter to Union Transport Minister Nitin Gadkari, urging him to declare the 8.8-km long Mandi Road stretch — a vital link between the Capital and neighbouring Gurgaon and Faridabad — a national highway. The letter comes after several requests were sent by the Delhi government in the last one year to the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) to take over the project, and streamline the widening and upgrade of Mandi Road from MG Road to Delhi-Haryana Border, said officials.

In her letter, the CM underlined that the road plays an important role in facilitating smooth inter-state traffic movement. The CM pointed out that the Governing Body of the Unified Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure (Planning & Engineering) Centre (UTTIPCE), the nodal agency aimed at en-



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday. AMIT MEHRA

hancing mobility across the National Capital Territory (NCT), had supported the proposal at its 68th meeting held on September 27, 2023. “...Considering the road’s strategic significance, its existing and future traffic demand, and its direct connectivity with National Highway-148A, it should be considered for inclusion under the jurisdiction of the NHAI,” she said.

Urging Gadkari to consider the proposal “favourably”, the CM underlined the move will strengthen connectivity across Delhi-NCR and give fresh momentum to regional economic growth.

16 councillors from AAP breakaway faction join BJP

Drishti Jain
New Delhi, July 10

IN A shot in the arm for BJP, 16 MCD councillors of the Indraprastha Vikas Party (IVP), a breakaway group of the AAP, joined hands with the ruling party on Friday, citing ‘consistent cooperation’.

With the merger, the BJP’s strength in the 250-member MCD has increased to 139, while the AAP’s tally stands at 102.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Mukesh Goel, president of the IVP, explained the rationale behind the move, “When we left AAP, CM Rekha Gupta had taken charge for only 2-3 months. We were unsure if they’ll be able to manage the

work. But now there is visible development on the ground. They have even given funds to the councillors, they are cleaning the Yamuna, lighting the streets and also approving Chief Minister Development Fund (CMDf),” he said.

“Even members who joined the party after defection have been nominated for roles of member of Standing committee, deputy chairman as well as chairman in BJP,” he said.

At the press conference on Friday, Gupta said that she had worked with several of the newly inducted councillors at different times, both while in government and in the opposition, and was well aware of their capabilities.

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Come Aug 1, women need ‘Pink’ card for free bus travel

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 10

COME AUGUST 1, women travelling on Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses in the Capital will have to carry a “Pink Saheli Smart Card” to continue availing the free bus travel scheme. With this, the existing paper-based pink tickets will be phased out.

According to a circular issued by the DTC, pink tickets

will continue to be issued to eligible women passengers till July 31. As announced by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta earlier, the card will provide free travel on DTC buses only to women residents of Delhi.

From August 1, free travel can only be availed by women who possess a valid Pink Saheli Smart Card (National Common Mobility Card) and tap it while boarding DTC buses and cluster buses operated by the Delhi In-

tegrated Multi-Modal Transit System (DIMTS).

Passengers without the smart card will no longer be issued pink tickets after July 31. They will have to purchase regular tickets and pay the applicable fare, the circular read. The initiative was launched by President Droupadi Murmu on March 2.

Under this, the Delhi BJP government replaced the ticketing system launched by the previous AAP government in 2019

with the Centre’s ‘One Nation, One Card’ initiative through the Pink NCMC card, making the free travel restricted for only Delhi residents.

The DTC has directed conductors and all enforcement staff to advise women passengers that they should obtain Pink Saheli Smart Card from the nearest designated distribution centre before July 31 so that they can continue to avail free travel facility.

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MR. SEBASTIAN ROBERT
Pastor, Delhi Tamil Church
Director, Faith Academy Schools and Projects
Director, News, All India Radio (AIR), on 10th July 2026.

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Saturday, 11th July 2026 at 1 PM
Massey Hall, Faith Academy School
John L. Dorsey Road, Prasad Nagar, New Delhi

Burial:
Saturday, 11th July 2026 at 4 PM
Noida Christian Cemetery, Sector 126, Noida

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Sunday, 12th July 2026 at 4 PM
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4 MEN LINKED TO GANGSTER KILLED IN 40-MINUTE GUNFIGHT WITH GURGAON COPS



The SUV in which the accused arrived; a forensic team and Gurgaon Police personnel at the site of the encounter at Sushant Lok on Friday.**ANI**



Music producer, worked with Badshah: Gangster Deepak Nandal in spotlight

Alok Singh & Abhimanyu Hazarika
New Delhi, July 10

DEEPAK NANDAL was once a producer and rapper in the Haryanvi music industry, believed to have worked with singers such as Rahul Fazilpuria and Badshah and associated with several popular Haryanvi songs.

However, police claimed, his association with criminals in Haryana gradually drew him into criminal activities. What started as petty disputes involving colleagues in the music industry soon turned into extortion and shootings.

Today, the 39-year-old, originally from Rohtak, is among the most-wanted gangsters operating in the National Capital Region (NCR). Police claimed he has been running an extortion network from London after fleeing India in 2024.

Nandal's name resurfaced on Thursday after four of his alleged shooters were killed and another injured in an exchange of fire with the Gurgaon Police in the city's upscale Sushant Lok area. According to police, the men had gone to target a businessman's residence after allegedly demanding Rs 10 crore in extortion.

String of crimes

Nandal, who used to live in Gurgaon, is wanted by the Delhi and Haryana Police in multiple cases of extortion, attempted murder and firing incidents.

According to a police officer, the first case against him was registered in 2009 in connection with an attempted murder in Gurgaon's Sadar Bazar. He was later acquitted in that case.

Last week, he allegedly demanded Rs 5 crore from a singer in Delhi, prompting the Delhi Police's Special Cell to register an FIR.

Among the most high-profile cases linked to Nandal is the attack on Fazilpuria, once a close associate in the music industry. "Because of his aggressive nature, his relationship with Fazilpuria deteriorated. He allegedly orchestrated the attack on the singer in Gurgaon in July last year," a police officer said.

According to investigators, the attack was carried out by associates of Sunil Sardania, a Rohtak resident facing



Deepak Nandal is among the most-wanted gangsters operating in the NCR. **FILE**

multiple criminal cases and considered a close associate of Nandal. Soon after, a purported social media post surfaced claiming that Fazilpuria had borrowed Rs 5 crore from Nandal and had failed to return the money, prompting the attack.

Police said Nandal allegedly masterminded the attack while operating from London. Investigators believe he fled India in July 2024 via Dubai and has since been directing criminal activities from abroad.

In August 2025, his name surfaced in connection with the killing of property dealer Rohit Shaukeen in Gurgaon.

Police also alleged that Nandal orchestrated firing incidents targeting businesses to enforce extortion demands.

In September 2025, around 25-30 shots were fired at the office of MNR Builders in Gurgaon's Sector 45. Nandal allegedly claimed responsibility for the attack through a social media post.

On October 29 the same year, his associates allegedly fired 55-60 rounds at the office of Unisys Info Solutions Pvt. Ltd. in Alpha City, Karnal.

A case was registered at Sadar Police Station, Karnal, under sections 109(1) and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) and Section 25 of the Arms Act.

Apart from these incidents, Nandal has been named in at least three other cases of attempted murder and extortion in Gurgaon over the past year.

In 2019, Nandal made headlines after a video allegedly showing him assaulting social media influencer Deepak Kalal was widely shared on social media.

The assault was reportedly triggered by a video posted by Kalal that Nandal considered to be in poor taste.

Threat calls and voice messages from abroad: Cops kept watch on bizman's house for a week

Alok Singh & Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, July 10

BUSINESSMAN VISHAL Beri, who lives with his family in a three-storey house at Sushant Lok Phase I in Gurgaon, had been receiving threat calls, messages and voice notes from an international number for over a week, police said.

According to an officer, Beri owns several properties that generate substantial rental income.

He is also involved in the event management business.

"His father, Rajesh Beri, was the founder of a private university. However, the family later dissociated itself from the university's management," the officer said.

ficer said.

After receiving continuous threat calls and messages, Beri allegedly approached the police seeking security for himself and his family.

Considering the matter sensitive, the local Sushant Lok police station under the Sector 29 police district was directed to keep a close watch on his residence, said police.

"The voice notes and messages allegedly warned that he would soon face the consequences if he did not comply with their demands and pay them money," the officer said.

According to sources, a few police personnel in plain clothes remained deployed outside his house, keeping a watch on the movement of sus-



Outside the house of businessman Vishal Beri. **ABHIMANYU HAZARIKA**

picious persons and vehicles.

The surveillance is believed to have contributed to the Crime

Branch's swift action in neutralising the suspected gangsters, who had allegedly come to tar-

get Beri's residence in A Block, Sushant Lok Phase I.

Police suspect that Beri's involvement in the event management business may have led gangster Deepak Nandal and his associates to learn about him and his properties, making him a potential target.

In the wake of the encounter, a case by case evaluation by police in Gurgaon is likely of the alleged threats received recently by prominent business families in the city, police said on Friday. No orders, however, have been issued to upgrade their security cover, they added.

"We are approached for a lot of allegations... Many of them are not credible enough to pursue so we plan to monitor each

on a case-to-case basis before giving any protection. As of now, we have not issued any orders to increase protection to businesspersons or families as such," a senior officer said.

Over the past few years, Gurgaon has witnessed a sharp spike in extortion demands from international crime syndicates.

The Deepak Nandal gang has claimed responsibility for a string of violent incidents in recent months.

Beyond the Nandal syndicate, the city's businessmen have frequently been in the crosshairs of networks led by incarcerated gangsters such as Kaushal Chaudhary and the Lawrence Bishnoi-Goldy Brar alliance, officers said.

The shooters: Class 10 student, 17-year-old Javelin athlete, labourer who said was going for Kanwar Yatra & man with 14 criminal cases

Alok Singh & Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, July 10

A 17-YEAR-OLD Javelin athlete, a Class 10 student with two criminal cases against him, a labourer who had told his family he was leaving for the Kanwar Yatra and an alleged gangster facing 14 criminal cases were among the four persons killed in an encounter by the Gurgaon Police in Sushant Lok late Thursday. The youngest among the four — 17 years old, according to his father — was from Rohtak, about 80 km from Gurgaon.

Waiting for his body outside the mortuary, the father, who

runs an e-rickshaw garage in Rohtak, said his son had been training as a javelin athlete at a stadium for the last two years.

"He left home on Wednesday after practice, saying he was going to get my motorcycle repaired and would soon return. He was not carrying a mobile phone... When he did not return, I searched for him for 48 hours and filed a missing person complaint," he said.

The man said he visited the police station several times in the last 48 hours for news about his son's whereabouts.

"Today morning, I got a call from my village sarpanch asking me to go to Sector 29 police



station in Gurgaon... Around the same time, the local police also called asking me to come for identification," he added.

Police said the boy left Rohtak on a motorcycle with



A seized pistol and a bullet mark on a wall of the house. **ABHIMANYU HAZARIKA & PTI**

Nitin — another man killed in the encounter — from the district. Nitin's father, Sanjay, said he had also filed a missing person complaint after his son went missing. A taxi driver in

Rohtak, he added, "Nitin was studying in Class 10. I don't know he was in contact with whom."

He said that Nitin had two previous criminal cases registered against him in Rohtak, including charges of attempt to murder and the Arms Act.

Another of those killed, Ankit, worked as a part-time labourer and had studied till Class 8, his family said.

His father, Anil, also a labourer, said, "Ankit left home two days ago saying he was travelling to Haridwar for the Kanwar Yatra."

The fourth person killed, Sandeep alias Deepa, was facing

14 criminal cases in Haryana, including attempt to murder, robbery and offences under the Arms Act, police said.

Hailing from Fatehabad in Haryana, he had left home several years ago, said police, adding that his family has maintained that they did not know where he had been staying.

When contacted, his family members refused to comment. Following the post-mortem examination, the bodies of all four were handed over to their families.

Police said that while they are verifying the teenager's age, the others were in the 20-24 age group.

● SECOND SUCCESSFUL LITTER FOR BREEDING PAIR

At Delhi zoo, Asiatic lion cubs born second consecutive year

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 10

THREE-DAY-OLD Asiatic lion cubs curl up beside their mother in a quiet maternity enclosure at the National Zoological Park, away from public view, taking their first tentative steps into the world.

Their birth at the zoo on Tuesday, July 7, marks the second successful litter for breeding pair Mahagauri and Maheshwar, who belong to the endangered Asiatic lion species. The births assume significance because, before Mahagauri's first litter in 2025, the Delhi Zoo had not recorded the birth of an Asiatic lion cub in nearly 16 years, with the previous successful litter dating back to 2009.

In an official statement issued on Friday, the zoo announced that Mahagauri gave birth to three Asiatic lion cubs on July 7. According to the zoo, the lioness and her cubs are being housed in a secure maternity enclosure, where they are being provided a "calm and undisturbed environment" crucial during the early stages of development.

The cubs remain under the constant care of their mother and are being closely monitored by the zoo's veterinary and animal care teams through a CCTV surveillance system, an official said. The zoo added that the re-



The three Asiatic lion cubs at the National Zoological Park. **EXPRESS**

peated breeding success of Mahagauri and Maheshwar marks an important milestone for its conservation breeding programme for the endangered species. The latest litter comes just over a year after the same pair produced two healthy cubs, amale, Kartik, and a female, Karnion, on April 27 last year.

With the new births, the National Zoological Park now houses nine Asiatic lions. The collection comprises three males (Sundaram, Maheshwar and Kartik), three females (Mahagauri, Shailja and Karni), and the three newborn cubs.

Mahagauri, Maheshwar and another lioness, Shailja, were brought to Delhi from Gujarat's Sakkarbaug Zoo in 2021 under an animal exchange programme aimed at strengthening the zoo's efforts to breed Asiatic lions.

When Mahagauri delivered her first litter last year, zoo officials described the first 48 hours after birth as the most critical period, noting that newborn cubs are particularly vulnerable and that any human intervention could distress the mother. A senior zoo official said a hands-off approach is used to care for the litter, relying on round-the-clock CCTV surveillance and stepping in only if a medical emergency arises. Officials also noted that Mahagauri displayed strong maternal instincts, nursing and caring for the cubs without assistance.

The zoo further said that successful births are an important component of ex-situ conservation efforts for the Asiatic lion, whose only wild population survives in and around Gujarat's Gir landscape.

Drishti Jain
Ghaziabad, July 10

"THE WEATHER is very nice. Enjoy the rain."

Those were the last words 23-year-old Ghaziabad resident Narendra Kacchi said to his elder brother, Kamlesh, on Thursday afternoon. Less than an hour later, Kamlesh came to know that Narendra, also called as Bablu, had died of electrocution near a waterlogged park in Ghaziabad. The news had first travelled nearly 600 km to their village in Madhya Pradesh's Chhatarpur district and then to Kamlesh, a plumber who lives in Indirapuram. "I got a call from my mother asking me to check on him," said Kamlesh.

Narendra, a caretaker of a building who also washed cars, died around 3 pm after allegedly coming in contact with an electrified, waterlogged stretch near a transformer.

Local residents said Narendra and another man were walking out of a waterlogged park when they crossed accumulated water around a transformer located at the exit. A purported video of the incident, widely circulated on social media, shows Narendra collapsing after suffering an electric shock, while the other man narrowly escaped.

Police have registered an FIR against unidentified per-



Police barricade the area where Narendra Kacchi (right) died on Thursday. **PRAVEEN KHANNA**

sons under sections related to causing death by negligence. The post-mortem examination has been conducted and the report is awaited, they said.

"I met him on my way to work. He was sitting with friends, joking about the rain... Half an hour later, I found out he had died."

"I cannot make my mother understand that he is no more," he added.

Narendra, one of the four siblings, had stayed back in Ghaziabad with Kamlesh five years

GROUNDreport

‘Enjoy the rain’, he told his brother; minutes later, Ghaziabad man electrocuted in park



officials, however, said they had received no prior complaints about the transformer. "We are waiting for the post-mortem report to know the exact cause of death. If it is because of electrocution, we will set up a committee to probe the incident," an official said.

Hours earlier, in Noida, 27-year-old Aryan died after falling into a drain while navigating waterlogged roads in Sector 58 while he was on way to work. Police suspect Aryan, a resident of Sector 22, may have also been electrocuted by coming in contact with a live electric pole.

"The road was inundated. He saw people walking on the roadside, where drains were covered with stone slabs. It seems he came across a live electric pole and got electrocuted before stepping onto a missing drain slab and falling into the drain," an officer said.

Police said the exact cause of death is yet to be established and that his viscera has been preserved. His body has been sent to his village in Farrukhabad, they added.



The Reinvention of India’s Business Schools in the Age of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence has not diminished the relevance of management education; it has redefined its intellectual purpose. As algorithms assume responsibility for computation, prediction, and information synthesis, the enduring advantage of future managers will lie in what may be termed Deep Sensing Capability—the ability to perceive weak signals, interpret complex organisational contexts, anticipate discontinuities, and exercise sound judgment amid ambiguity. Machines excel at pattern recognition; they remain incapable of contextual discernment and values-based leadership. The future of management education lies not in producing graduates who know more, but leaders who perceive more.

This is the most significant reinvention of Indian business schools since liberalisation. The earlier mandate was to disseminate business knowledge and prepare graduates for corporate careers. Today, knowledge is ubiquitous, and AI has democratised sophisticated analytical capability. The central purpose of the contemporary B-school is therefore no longer the transmission of information but the cultivation of discernment—the capacity to interpret and act responsibly upon knowledge generated by intelligent systems.

This is not a fringe view. HBS Dean Srikant Datar has argued that leaders must learn not only how to use and scale AI but also how to govern it and weigh its risks to privacy and security. At Wharton, Dean Erika James has been equally direct: the question is no longer whether AI will reshape business, but how.



The evidence for caution is as important as the evidence for adoption. Wharton researchers Steven Shaw and Gideon Nave have studied what they call “artificial cognition”—the tendency of people to default to AI-generated answers with little scrutiny, a risk they term cognitive surrender. Their research shows that while AI can improve reasoning when correct, it can also degrade judgment when users accept erroneous outputs uncritically. This is precisely the problem Deep Sensing Capability is meant to solve: a manager who defers to the algorithm without contextual judgment is more exposed to error, not less.

The World Economic Forum’s Future of Jobs Report 2025 reinforces this conclusion. Most skills assessed against generative AI show low or very low risk of substitution because nuanced judgment, complex problem-solving, and human interaction remain beyond AI’s reach. The report projects a net gain of 78 million jobs globally by 2030, provided organisations redesign work

transforming faculty’s intellectual practices demands sustained institutional commitment. The future competitiveness of Indian business schools will depend far more on investment in faculty development than on digital infrastructure. Faculty must evolve from transmitters of knowledge into architects of learning experiences—redesigning assessment, integrating AI responsibly into pedagogy, and mentoring students in judgment alongside intelligent systems.

This carries particular significance for India. Home to one of the world’s largest higher education systems, a rapidly expanding digital economy, a growing base of Global Capability Centres, and one of the world’s largest startup ecosystems, India needs managers who can navigate technological disruption, institutional complexity, and societal expectations simultaneously. Business schools must prepare graduates not merely for employment but for responsible leadership and organisational renewal in an AI-enabled economy.

The legitimacy of Indian management education will not rest on the sophistication of its technology but on the depth of human capability it cultivates. In an age of abundant artificial intelligence, the scarcest managerial resource will be Deep Sensing Capability—the distinctly human capacity to perceive meaning beyond information and possibility beyond prediction. Cultivating it is no longer an ancillary objective of the business school. It is its defining purpose.

Dr Prasoon M. Tripathi
Director, IMS Ghaziabad.

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DPG Degree College The Changing DNA of the MBA in the Age of AI



Dr Prahlad Singh
Director
DPG Degree College

We are living through one of the most consequential moments in the history of management thinking — a period in which artificial intelligence has ceased to be a technical curiosity and become the invisible hand shaping every boardroom decision, every market forecast, and every leadership choice worth making. The pace of this shift is remarkable. Its reach into the discipline of management is even more so.

As Director of DPG Degree College, I have watched this transformation unfold from close quarters — through the questions our MBA students ask, the case studies our faculty rewrite each year, and the expectations recruiters now walk in with. What strikes me most is not how quickly machines have learned to crunch numbers, but how completely that capability has changed what we expect of a manager. Data fluency is no longer a specialised skill reserved for analysts in a back office. It has become the common thread running through every management function — finance, marketing, operations, and leadership itself.

Not long ago, an MBA was built around a fairly settled idea: train articulate generalists who could read a balance sheet, motivate a team, and trust their judgment when the numbers ran out. That model produced excellent leaders for a slower, less instrumented world. Today, every decision leaves a data trail — customer clicks, supply chain delays, sentiment on social media, real-time cash flow. No human mind can process that volume unaided, and no manager can afford to lead by instinct alone anymore. The manager who thrives in this world must be capable of reading a dashboard as fluently as she reads a room.

At DPG Degree College, our MBA programmes in Business Analytics and Data Analytics form the analytical backbone from which every other specialisation now draws. We have never treated these as standalone electives bolted onto a traditional syllabus. They are woven into live projects, real datasets, and dashboards our students must build and defend — not to case-study panels alone, but to the same scrutiny they will face in

an actual boardroom. Our faculty, many drawn directly from industry, ensure that students learn not from textbooks alone, but from practitioners who are making data-backed decisions at scale today.

In our core General Management courses too, the conversation has shifted decisively toward this partnership between judgment and intelligence. Students are trained to move fluidly between quantitative models and qualitative reasoning — to trust a predictive model’s output, but also to know when to question it. This is, perhaps, the most profound change management education has undergone in decades. A machine can tell a manager what happened and even forecast what might happen next. It still cannot tell her why it matters, or what to do about it in a boardroom full of competing interests and human stakes.

Yet technical fluency alone is not enough. The managers who will lead this century must be curious enough to question the assumptions embedded in the models they rely on, creative enough to see opportunities a dashboard cannot surface, and grounded enough to ask not only what the data suggests, but whether acting on it is right. An algorithm recommending a pricing change can affect millions of customers; a churn model can quietly reshape a company’s relationship with its most loyal clients. Our students must understand that weight and carry it responsibly. At DPG Degree College, ethical reasoning and sound business judgment remain core commitments in every specialisation we offer — not optional add-ons to a technical skillset.

We are firmly convinced that the most competitive manager of tomorrow is not the one who defers entirely to the machine, nor the one who ignores it — but the one who knows how to work alongside it, drawing on data for evidence and on human judgment for wisdom.

“In the age of AI, management education is no longer about mastering one function in isolation — it is about learning to lead with both data and judgment, in equal and deliberate measure.”

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Ready For Race?

WITH THE high-stakes Bankipur bypoll in Bihar just two weeks away, the Congress state unit is still unsure if the party will field a candidate on the seat — also being contested by Jan Suraaj Party founder Prashant Kishor. The RJD, a Congress ally, has already fielded Rekha Kumari on the seat to take on BJP's Neeraj K Sinha, the party's new candidate after its first nominee, Abhishek Kumar, withdrew his nomination on Friday citing "family reasons". The Congress, meanwhile, is still considering whether to field a candidate or not. The state unit has sent a report on this matter to the party high command in Delhi and is awaiting a decision as the last day for filing nominations, July 13, approaches.

Musical Bond

A MUSICAL performance by popular Punjabi singer-actor and former Congress MP from Faridkot Mohd Sadiq became the highlight of what insiders said was an attempt at "dinner diplomacy" among some of the state's tallest Congress leaders on Thursday. Sadiq performed a rendition of one of his most famous songs, 'Meri Aisi Jhanjar Chhanki', at the dinner attended by Punjab Congress chief Amarinder Singh Raja Warring, Leader of Opposition in Punjab Assembly Partap Bajwa and state in-charge Bhupesh Baghel. Sadiq's tunes triggered rhythmic clapping as all in attendance joined in amid the party's bid to iron out alleged internal differences between Warring and former CM Charanjit Singh Channi in the poll-bound state.

Flagging church attacks, AAP's Sanjay Singh writes to PM

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 10

EXPRESSING DEEP concern over what he termed a "disturbing rise" in alleged attacks on churches, institutions, pastors and members of the Christian community across the country, Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh on Friday wrote to Prime Minister Narendra Modi seeking his intervention in the matter.

Singh urged the PM to "uphold the Constitution, ensure the protection of religious freedom and take immediate action" against those responsible for targeting religious minorities in several states.

"I write to express my deep concern over the disturbing and increasing attacks on churches, Christian institutions, pastors and members of the Christian community across the country," he said.

Citing incidents reported from West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Haryana and Delhi, among other states, Singh said these were not isolated acts of violence but revealed a "disturbing pattern of organised intimidation, vandalism, disruption of peaceful worship and misuse of allegations of religious conversion to target the minorities."

"The most recent incidents in West Bengal are deeply shocking. Reports indicate that churches and Christian gatherings have been repeatedly attacked in Sonarpur, Purba Bardhaman, Paschim Medinipur and Kharagpur," Singh stated.

EXPRESS special

Govt considers making certification mandatory for non-theatre films too

Proposal to amend IT rules comes amid row over *Satluj* pullout

Liz Mathew
New Delhi, July 10

THE CENTRE is contemplating amending the Information Technology Act to ensure that any movie which is available for public viewing on any platform has certification even if it's not meant for theatrical release, sources said.

The move, which has been under consideration for some time, has picked up momentum against the backdrop of the controversy over the abrupt removal of *Satluj* — a biopic on Punjab human rights activist Jaswant Singh Khalsa, being played by singer-actor Diljit Dosanjh — from OTT platform ZEE5 last weekend.

The makers of the film, earlier titled *Punjab '95*, waged a long battle with the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) over 127 suggested cuts, which they refused to accept. As



An SGPC delegation takes out a march in support of *Satluj*, in Amritsar on Friday. RANA SIMRANJIT SINGH

a result, the film never reached the cinemas and was released on ZEE5 without the cuts under the name *Satluj* on July 3.

However, two days after the OTT release, the movie was taken down by the OTT platform, citing "current developments".

The issue has become a political flashpoint in poll-bound Punjab with the ruling AAP and the Opposition Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) vehemently protesting the move.

While AAP has taken as-tong public stance against the removal of the film from the OTT platform, blaming the

BJP-led Central government, Akali Dal president Sukhbir Singh Badal has announced that his party will screen the film across villages and towns in Punjab to "educate the younger generation about the atrocities committed against the Sikh community during the Congress regime." Assembly polls are due in Punjab early next year.

With the issue gaining political colour, officials in the Information and Broadcasting Ministry said demand for change in the IT rules to make certification mandatory for movies that are available for

public viewing, even if they are not for release on traditional platforms, has grown stronger.

"Since viewership has shifted from the traditional to OTT and other platforms, there is a proposal for the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology to regulate the content that is for public viewing," said an official.

According to sources, *Satluj* had come before the film certification board in 2022. The makers had challenged the CBFC's objections before the Bombay High Court in 2023, but later withdrew the petition.

"A communication was sent (by CBFC) to them (filmmakers) in May 2023 prohibiting its release, citing reasons. They went to the court initially, but later, after seeing the reasons given by the Board, they decided to withdraw the case," said the official.

"This may be because the producer felt the court would stall the film forever, or the producers may have filed the petition as a pressure tactic against CBFC but realised the gravity of the concerns already expressed by CBFC," the official said.

The Bombay High Court disposed of the case on January

7, 2025. "Since withdrawing the petition from the court in January 2025, the film producers never attempted to resolve these matters with CBFC," the official said.

Sources in the ministry said that although the filmmakers had not made any changes to the original movie, just changed the title to *Satluj*, ZEE5 claimed it was not aware of these developments (in 2022 and 2023) when the ministry sought an explanation.

Officials argue that the government has several reasons to ban the film. According to them, the dominant narrative of the film is that the State was responsible for mass killings, disappearances and illegal cremations. This moves beyond criticism of specific excesses and converts counter-insurgency into an alleged machinery of State oppression, the officials said.

Sources in the government said the current security context of Punjab makes the risk live, not historical, as Punjab remains a sensitive border state with continuing Khalistan-related propaganda, foreign-based separatist mobilisation and hostile information operations.

BJP candidate quits Bankipur bypoll race, party fields new face

Santosh Singh
Patna, July 10

IN AN interesting turn of events ahead of the July 30 Bankipur bypoll, BJP candidate Abhishek Kumar Friday withdrew his nomination citing "family reasons", with the party soon declaring its Mandal adhyaksh Neeraj Kumar Sinha as the new candidate for a bypoll shaping up to be a triangular contest with the Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) and the Jan Suraj Party (JSP).

With JSP founder Prashant Kishor entering the fray, Bankipur is turning into a prestige battle for the BJP, especially since its national president Nitin Nabin has represented the seat five times since 2006. The constituency has been a BJP stronghold since 1995, when it was still called Patna West.

The new candidate, Neeraj Kumar Sinha, 32, is currently the Mandal adhyaksh of Narendra Bharti Mandal, named after his uncle, who was associated with the Bharatiya Jan Sangh. Sinha, serving a second term as Mandal president, was also vice-president of the Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha. A graduate from Patna, he has been a BJP member since the age of 12.



Neeraj Kumar Sinha is the new BJP candidate for Bankipur

An overwhelmed Sinha told reporters: "I had never imagined that a booth level worker like me could be given such an honour. I'm overwhelmed and confident of my victory by a huge margin."

Earlier in the day, Abhishek Kumar alias Abhishek Bunt, who had filed his nomination Thursday and later shared a public platform with senior leaders, said: "I would say with all humility that I would not be able to contest elections because of family issues. I will continue to work for the party. I'm thankful to the party for considering me for the Bankipur bypoll."

BJP sources said Abhishek Kumar, who had studied only up to Class 10, "looked a weak candidate as compared to RJD's Rekha Gupta, a graduate, and highly qualified JSP candidate Prashant Kishor".

CAG flags 'significant deficiencies' in budget, financial management of Ladki Bahin scheme

Vallabh Ozarkar
Mumbai, July 10

QUESTIONING THE financial management of the Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana, the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has said its implementation in 2024-25 was marked by "significant deficiencies in budget estimation, expenditure control and financial management", after finding that the Maharashtra government's Women and Child Development Department incurred an excess expenditure of about Rs 3,541 crore under the scheme without providing "any specific justification".

The CAG's State Finances Audit Report for the financial year of 2024-25 recommended that the government make a more realistic assessment of beneficiary coverage and fund requirements while framing budgets for large direct benefit transfer (DBT) schemes, and ensure that funds are drawn only when required for immediate expenditure instead of being parked in deposit accounts.

The audit also found that Rs 15,586 crore was transferred to Virtual Personal Deposit Accounts (VPDA), government-managed deposit accounts used to hold funds before disbursement, during the last quarter of the financial year despite there being no immediate utilisation requirement. The CAG said this indicated "parking of funds" and withdrawal without commensurate expenditure require-

ments. The report added that "such practices undermine the principles of budgetary discipline, financial propriety and legislative control over public finances."

The report also pointed to a sharp shift in the state's social sector spending during the year. Expenditure on women welfare jumped from Rs 261.78 crore in 2023-24 to Rs 33,554.36 crore in 2024-25, largely because of the Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana, which, it observed, "reflects a major push toward welfare-oriented transfers rather than capital formation."

At the same time, expenditure on housing fell by 54.69 per cent and spending on water supply and sanitation by 31.81 per cent compared with the previous financial year. The CAG said this reflected "a contraction in infrastructure-related investments within the social sector", which "could adversely affect the sustainability of service delivery".

Launched on June 28, 2024, ahead of the Assembly elections, the Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana was introduced by the Mahayuti government, comprising the BJP, the Shiv Sena led by then Chief Minister Eknath Shinde, and the NCP led by then Deputy Chief Minister Ajit Pawar. Under the scheme, eligible women aged 21 to 65 with an annual family income of less than Rs 2.5 lakh receive Rs 1,500 a month through direct benefit transfer (DBT).

Thaw in Punjab Cong: Channi camp agrees to meet Baghel but keeps up heat on Warring

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, July 10

DAYS AFTER the All India Congress Committee (AICC)'s general secretary in charge of Punjab, Bhupesh Baghel, ruled out a change in the state Congress leadership announced recently by the party high command, saying it was not a "gudda-guddi ka khel (child's play)", senior party leaders from the Charanjit Singh Channi camp will meet Baghel on Saturday at the residence of party MLA Rana Gurjit Singh.

The Channi camp's move signalled a thaw as it has been avoiding meeting Baghel who has been camping in Chandigarh since Monday to deal with the latest bout of factionalism and infighting besetting the state Congress.

Confirming about their participation in the Saturday meeting, the Channi group, however, emphasised that Punjab Pradesh Congress Committee (PPCC) president Amrinder Singh Raja Warring would not be a part of this huddle.

"We intend to inform Baghel that he has done much wrong to the party in Punjab by pushing for Warring's continuance as the PPCC president and will list evidence before him in this regard," said a senior state Congress leader.

On July 1, in a balancing act, the AICC leadership announced its decision to retain Warring in his post, which upset Channi, the Jalandhar MP and ex-CM, who was looking to replace him as the PPCC



Bhupesh Baghel with Congress's Patiala MP Dharamvira Gandhi in Chandigarh on Friday. X/INCPUNJAB

chief himself. Instead, Channi has been named the Congress's campaign committee chief for the state Assembly polls slated for February 2027.

At the Saturday meeting, besides Channi and Rana Gurjit, Gurdaspur MP Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa, Leader of the Opposition (LoP) Partap Singh Bajwa, Fatehgarh Churian MLA Tripti Rajinder Singh Bajwa, Gurdaspur MLA Barindermeet Singh Pahlra, Jalandhar MLA Pargat Singh and former minister Bharat Bhushan Ashu are likely to be in attendance.

Channi's supporters have dismissed Baghel's contention that the Ajay Maken-led AICC committee had not made any recommendation in favour of Channi as the PCC president.

"Despite the fact that a majority of people who appeared before the committee pushed for Channi to be made the state president, it was Baghel who intervened on Warring's behalf

and ensured that no change took place. Why he did so remains a mystery and we want to ask him about it," a party leader said.

The Channi camp says it had raised various concerns against Warring's leadership before the AICC leaders, warning them of the "damage" his continuance may have on the party's poll prospects. "Warring has failed to adopt a sufficiently adversarial stance against the ruling AAP and the BJP. He is known to be soft on AAP. He never reacts strongly when killings, extortion and dacoities take place. Now when Baghel in town, he has suddenly woken up about the Moga police station blast and is demanding the DGP's resignation," a leader alleged.

Asked about the Channi camp's reported insistence that he should not be a part of the meeting, Warring said: "I don't know about this condition. But what I know is that Baghel is meeting them separately."

In MP, a comeback bid fizzles out as BJP picks debutant for bypoll

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, July 10

AFTER MONTHS of positioning himself for a political comeback, former Madhya Pradesh minister Narottam Mishra was denied a ticket by the BJP for the Datia Assembly bypoll, scheduled for July 30, with the party springing a surprise by naming organisational leader Ashutosh Tiwari as its candidate.

The decision marks a dramatic setback for Mishra, who until days ago was widely regarded as a frontrunner for the seat. The six-time MLA had intensified his presence in the constituency in recent months, shutting between Bhopal and Datia, meeting local leaders, workers and community representatives in an effort to consolidate support.

The snub has sparked protests by Mishra's supporters, who took to the streets and raised slogans against Tiwari. His supporters claim development had come to halt in Datia since Mishra lost the 2023 election to the Congress.

Leaders close to Mishra said he routinely held marathon meetings lasting several hours, with hundreds of workers meeting him each day. Just days ago, he had also purchased a nomination form, a move interpreted as a strong signal that his candidature had the party leadership's backing.

Mishra's efforts came against the backdrop of a vacancy created after Congress MLA Rajendra Bharti was disqualified following his conviction in a decades-old bank fraud case.



Ex-minister Narottam Mishra was, until days ago, regarded as a frontrunner for the seat

The bypoll offered the BJP leader an opportunity to reclaim the constituency he had dominated for nearly two decades before suffering a shock defeat in the 2023 Assembly election.

That defeat fundamentally altered Mishra's political standing. Once considered among the BJP's most powerful leaders in MP, Mishra lost not only his Assembly seat in 2023, but also the aura of electoral invincibility that had defined his career.

Since then, he has sought to rebuild his position through organisational outreach, Hindutva politics and sustained engagement with party workers.

His comeback, however, encountered resistance in sections of the Datia BJP. The 2023 defeat emboldened leaders who argued the constituency required a generational reset. As the bypoll approached, the BJP found itself "balancing Mishra's stature and experience against concerns over organisational cohesion", a party functionary said.

The BJP ultimately chose Ashutosh Tiwari, signalling a preference for an organisational face over an electoral heavyweight.

32 lakh cases pending: Why court foresees 21 yrs of wait at Bengal tribunals

Tanusree Bose
Joka (Kolkata), July 10

38,000 CASES cleared, 32 lakh pending.

Since March end, when tribunals were set up in West Bengal to tackle cases of "logical discrepancies" after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise by the Election Commission was concluded, and long after the Assembly polls which the SIR was timed with got over in the state, the clearance rate continues to crawl, standing at 1.18% cases at the end of last month, as per sources.

On Wednesday, the Jalpaiguri Circuit Bench of the Calcutta High Court observed that at this rate it would take 21 years for the tribunals to clear the cases. The court was hearing an appeal from a person over his takat passport application being

stuck because of his case pending before a tribunal — at least the second case linked to passports and tribunal hearings to land in a court in Bengal.

At ground zero, the picture shows no change. There is still no official word on how many of the cases dealt with by the tribunals have ended in deletions, the promised dashboard on the number of cases pending and resolved is yet to materialise, and people whose cases are pending before tribunals remain in the dark, with a handful trooping daily to the government building in Joka on the outskirts of Kolkata, where the tribunals are operating, for news.

Last month, Congress MP from Malda South Isha Khan Chowdhury filed a PIL in the Calcutta High Court demanding that tribunals speed up work and that the number of judges head-



Outside the building near Kolkata where tribunals are sitting, people continue to troop in seeking updates. PARTHA PAUL

ing them be increased. The PIL is yet to get a hearing.

On a rainy Tuesday, some are hanging outside the building clutching papers dealing with their own cases, others are here on behalf of relatives who have received a call to appear before

the tribunals.

Nitu Hela, 34, who belongs to nearby Pailan, is at the building with her 1-year-old daughter. Her parents, originally from Durgapur but settled in Kolkata, are dead. While her husband and in-laws cleared the SIR, her

name was deleted as she could not provide her parents' birth certificate, she says. "I applied online... I do not know when they will call me."

Nitu also wonders how to prove her case. "I have all the other documents except my parents' death certificates."

Ispahan Sheikh 38, of Bishnupur Thana in South 24 Parganas, was also deleted from the voter list during the SIR. Sheikh says he moved to Qatar in 2009 for work, later shifting to Kuwait where he is employed as an AC mechanic. He came to his home town last year in order to renew his passport and to get some other documents to start up his own business, Sheikh says. But, this coincided with the SIR.

"I filled the form but my name got deleted. The BLO does not know anything. Now, until my issue is resolved, I cannot go

back to Kuwait," says Ispahan.

Subarna Mondol, 33, from Joka runs a salon. While her parents and brothers cleared the SIR, her name was deleted. Mondol says all her documents have her mother's name but she does not have papers linking her father's name with her grandfather. "Police told me that since our judge has resigned, work on cases of South 24 Parganas is not happening."

At least two judges heading respective tribunals have resigned, including former Calcutta High Court judge Justice Ranjit Bag, who was handling appeals from South 24 Parganas, and ex-Calcutta High Court Chief Justice T S Sivagnanam.

Syed Shah Mohammad Shamser Alam Alkadri, 61 and a teacher of Arabic, says he has come to the Joka institute on behalf of his niece Tuhina Bibi, who

received a notice to appear before the tribunals. His own name and that of his wife and all four daughters were also deleted, he says. "I am an Indian, my daughters were born here, their birth certificates record this, I have property papers dating back to the 1960s. How are the names of my family deleted?"

With Tuhina getting notice for a hearing, Alkadri says he has come to understand the procedure so that he and his family members are "prepared".

While state Chief Electoral Officer Neelam Meena could not be reached despite multiple attempts, Congress MP Isha Chowdhury, who has filed a case on the SIR tribunals in the High Court, said: "Elections are over, the entire procedure should have been completed by now... Everything is at a standstill... We want complete transparency."

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HEALTHCARE



The Unspoken Half Of A Woman's Life

Dr. Meenakshi Ahuja on Why India Needs to Start Talking About Menopause

EVERY woman who lives long enough will go through it, yet in India it remains one of the least discussed health transitions of a woman's life. Menopause — the natural end of a woman's reproductive years — is quietly reshaping the health of hundreds of millions of Indian women, most of whom are given little more than a shrug and the advice to "just live with it." Dr. Meenakshi Ahuja wants that to change.

Dr. Ahuja is Principal Director of Obstetrics & Gynaecology at Fortis La Femme, Greater Kailash-II, New Delhi, where she has practised for over three decades. She is currently Chairperson of the Website Committee of the Indian Menopause Society and was President of the Delhi Menopause Society for five years. In a candid conversation, she walked us through what menopause actually does to a woman's body, why Indian women hit it earlier than their Western counterparts, and why silence around it is costing women years they don't need to lose.

Menopause affects every woman, yet it's barely spoken about in India. What is that silence costing them?

Women in India have historically been treated as the least prioritised member of the family. Our social structure has, for generations, placed the earning male member first, then growing children, then the elderly — and a woman's own health rarely enters that hierarchy at all, whether she is a housewife or a working woman carrying the added guilt of splitting herself between career and family.

Second, menopause was simply assumed to be something you suffer through in silence — a natural part of ageing you accept and live with, without anyone telling you that remedies actually exist.

Third, consider how dramatically life expectancy has changed. India's average life expectancy was around 32 years at Independence in 1947; today, female life expectancy is close to 74 years, several years higher than men's. If menopause typically arrives between 40 and 55, and many women now live into their eighties or nineties, a woman spends nearly half her adult life — possibly half her entire life — in the menopausal and postmenopausal phase. That is not a small, forgettable segment. It may be the single biggest phase of her life, which is exactly why it needs attention, not silence.

Why do you think even women themselves don't know much about menopause, or stay silent about it?

Because women's health, historically, was addressed one life-stage at a time, and menopause was never on that list. We first began talking about women's health around anaemia, roughly forty to fifty years ago. Then the focus shifted to pregnancy care, because two lives were at stake, followed by adolescent health once we understood that PCOD and hormonal issues in young women affected their fertility for life.

It is only now, once those earlier stages have finally received attention, that menopause is entering the conversation — and we're realising women have been suffering unnecessarily, when better information could have spared them years of avoidable discomfort.

Walk us through what actually happens in the body during menopause, beyond the textbook definition.

Technically, menopause is diagnosed once a woman has gone without a period for a full year, because her ovaries

have stopped releasing eggs and producing estrogen and progesterone. In practical terms, her fertility is over — but far more significantly, the hormones that were protecting her bones, muscles, skin, vaginal health, and heart against diabetes and hypertension disappear too.

This sudden hormonal withdrawal puts women at a sharper, more sudden health risk than men face at a comparable age. Men tend to develop high blood pressure, heart attacks, or diabetes gradually, often from their thirties. Women are relatively protected until estrogen drops away — and then these same risks can arrive abruptly in their late forties and fifties. That estrogen deprivation also affects brain tissue, contributing to brain fog and sleep disturbance, and affects vaginal tissue, leading to dryness, painful sex, and recurrent urinary infections. These aren't simply signs of ageing — they're specific, addressable consequences of a sudden hormone deficit.

One point that matters specifically for Indian readers: the average age of menopause in India is 46.2 years — roughly half a decade earlier than in Europe. Indian women lose the protective effect of estrogen earlier in life, which is precisely why we urge women to plan childbearing before 40, and why taking menopause seriously matters even more here than in the West.

At what age should women start paying attention, and what are the earliest signs that get dismissed?

Any woman who is menstruating should be tracking her own pattern — a 25-day or 35-day cycle is fine, but it should be consistent. Any change in flow, unusual pain, or inter-menstrual bleeding deserves attention at any age, because cycles can start becoming irregular after 35 due to a condition called premature ovarian insufficiency.

Past 40, an annual gynaecological check-up should become non-negotiable — blood work, mammograms every two years, ultrasounds annually, and a risk assessment for diseases that become more likely after menopause. As for the earliest sign that gets waved away: skipped cycles. Women often ignore this because they've already had their children and assume it "doesn't matter" — and even doctors or family sometimes reinforce that dismissal. But a skipped cycle can be the first sign of early menopause and needs to be addressed, not shrugged off.

Most people associate menopause only with hot flashes. What are the symptoms nobody talks about?

Hot flashes and night sweats can disrupt sleep and daily life badly, but they don't wait for menopause itself — they typically begin during perimenopause, the transitional phase when cycles start turning irregular, which can start five to eight years earlier. Women also commonly experience severe fatigue, disinterest in everyday activities, and anxiety or low mood, all often written off as ordinary stress rather than linked to hormones.

Then there's "brain fog" — opening the fridge and forgetting why, blanking on a familiar name, or searching for glasses sitting on your own head. It's extremely common in a woman's forties, and often gets tangled up with other things happening in her life at the same time, like children leaving for college, making it easy to misattribute to circumstance rather than biology.

But the symptom nobody talks about at all is the quiet deterioration of a woman's sex life. As the vaginal lining thins and dries due to falling estrogen,



Dr. Meenakshi Ahuja is Principal Director, **Obstetrics & Gynaecology**, Fortis La Femme, Greater Kailash-II, New Delhi, Chairperson of the Website Committee of the Indian Menopause Society, and former President of the Delhi Menopause Society.

sex can become painful, so women simply start avoiding it without naming why. This is the single biggest unspoken issue in our clinics, along with the recurrent urinary infections that come with it. We often have to ask directly when a patient last had intercourse, and the moment we do, it's like opening a floodgate.

How much of what women experience in this phase gets misdiagnosed as anxiety, depression, or a thyroid issue before anyone considers menopause?

Quite a lot, historically. When doctors didn't have a clear solution to offer, the default was to dismiss symptoms as ageing or treat them as unrelated anxiety, depression, or thyroid problems — thyroid dysfunction does genuinely increase after menopause too, so it isn't always a misdiagnosis. The real issue was treating each symptom individually instead of recognising the underlying hormone deficiency, the way we'd read-

ily treat a thyroid or insulin deficiency with replacement therapy.

Part of the reason is a 2000 study, the Women's Health Initiative, which caused hormone therapy to fall into global disrepute. It took the medical community roughly fifteen years to realise the study had enrolled the wrong population — women in their sixties and seventies, many with a personal or family history of breast cancer or cardiovascular disease. It was a flawed cohort, and it cost a generation of women access to a genuinely useful treatment. Today's guidelines are far more precise about who benefits, when, and for how long.

What does modern menopause management actually look like today, and is hormone therapy still relevant?

Hormone therapy is more relevant today than ever, precisely because it's now given far more judiciously. It isn't offered to every woman who asks for it, nor withheld from every woman who

needs it; each patient is evaluated for her individual risk profile first.

Treatment starts with a complete evaluation of a woman's broader risk for conditions like hypertension and diabetes, not just her menopausal status. From there, we begin with lifestyle — exercise, dietary changes, sleep hygiene, and staying socially engaged if anxiety is present. Only after that do we look at supplementation — calcium and vitamin D, since calcium absorption into bone declines sharply after 35, along with multivitamins and correcting micronutrient deficiencies. Hormone therapy comes after all of this, not before it.

We use it for four clear indications: premature ovarian insufficiency, where menopause arrives before 40; moderate-to-severe hot flashes and night sweats, for which it remains first-line treatment; prevention of osteoporosis, since bone loss is directly linked to estrogen depletion; and genitourinary syndrome of menopause, typically treated with local rather than systemic therapy. And it isn't only tablets — it comes as gels, sprays, patches, and local creams, which is why treatment has to be personalised.

How aware are Indian women of these treatment options today, compared to when you started practising?

The change over thirty years has been substantial. Earlier, very few women even raised the subject. Social media has helped — women now feel comfortable to talk about it openly, and even women in their late thirties come in asking questions ahead of time. It's also generational: younger women who've watched their own mothers go through it are far more willing to ask on their behalf.

Awareness among gynaecologists has grown too — it's really only since around 2015 that hormone therapy and non-hormonal alternatives began being discussed as a structured area of management. When I speak to women's groups today, menopause is consistently one of the topics they're most eager to discuss. Awareness, I always say, is the first step toward proper management.

What role do diet, sleep, exercise, and stress actually play in managing symptoms?

All four matter enormously. Stress is part of everyone's life — what matters isn't the situation but how you respond to it. Some people carry enormous workloads without getting stressed, while others with far less on their plate are constantly anxious. Learning acceptance, of others and of yourself, is genuinely part of managing this phase well, and a strong support system from family and friends makes a measurable difference.

Diet needs real attention. A woman's calorie requirement drops after 40, typically to 1,500-2,000 calories a day depending on activity. The ICMR's reference plate suggests no more than roughly 250-270 calories from complex carbohydrates like whole grains and millets rather than simple ones, given India's high diabetes burden, alongside about 400 grams of vegetables, 100 grams of fruit, 400-500 grams of milk and curd combined, 25-40 grams of fibre, nuts and seeds for omega-3, and 60-70 grams of protein a day — roughly one gram per kilogram of body weight, since ageing affects muscle mass as much as bone density.

Sleep hygiene deserves more attention than it gets. Since night sweats disturb sleep, I recommend a cool room, loose cotton layers, a consistent sleep-wake time, a light dinner at least three hours before bed, and cutting tea, coffee, and fluids four to five hours before sleeping. Keeping phones and TVs out

of the bedroom matters more than people realise. For persistent issues, we sometimes suggest magnesium, warm milk with cinnamon and nutmeg, or melatonin — but only after basic sleep hygiene has genuinely been tried.

Exercise isn't just about burning calories. I recommend at least half an hour, five days a week, including strength training twice weekly, because sarcopenia — age-related muscle loss — is as much a silent threat as osteoporosis; weak muscles fail to support weakening bones, driving falls and hip fractures. I'd also flag yoga specifically: there's strong worldwide evidence that around twelve weeks of regular practice measurably reduces hot flashes, the most common perimenopausal symptom, while also calming the mind, improving sleep, and supporting balance. And finally: stop smoking completely — arguably the single biggest silent killer at this life stage — and cut alcohol down as much as possible, since even small amounts can worsen menopausal health over time.

Menopause is often an invisible conversation in Indian workplaces and homes. What should families and employers understand?

It's high time everyone understood that menopause isn't a conversation reserved for women's groups alone — it needs to be part of family life and workplace culture too. Just as we don't expect people in their twenties to fully grasp fertility struggles unless it's explained, we shouldn't expect younger colleagues to understand what a senior woman may be going through without basic awareness. Perimenopausal distress at the workplace is too often dismissed as a woman being "emotional" — and that needs to stop. I'm not asking for sympathy; I'm asking for empathy, and empathy only comes from awareness.

We're still at a stage where many women aren't visiting a doctor for this, though it's improving. I'd like every woman over 40 to feel comfortable going for a regular check-up, with her concerns discussed openly once she's there. We've become far more comfortable discussing pregnancy and even menstruation publicly. I don't understand why menopause remains the exception — the generation of women currently going through it never got the chance to have this conversation at any earlier stage of their lives. They deserve to have it now.

Any final message for our readers?

If you're over 40 and have spent your life looking after everyone else, learn to prioritise your own health — and everyone around you should learn to prioritise it too. We shouldn't take women over 40, 50, 60, or 70 for granted.

There's a phrase I share with my patients that captures exactly what I'd want for every woman: fit at 40, fabulous at 50, strong at 60, serene at 70, independent at 80.

Dr. Ahuja's message is, in the end, strikingly simple: a woman shouldn't lose the better part of her life to a condition medicine already knows how to manage. With India's female life expectancy now approaching 74 years and many women wanting to live their life healthy in the eighties and even nineties, over 140 million Indian women are estimated to be going through this transition today — a number set to climb further as the population ages. For a phase of life that can stretch across three or four decades, the silence around it was never inevitable, and it's one Indian women — and the people around them — can finally afford to break.



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‘Some scars can never be forgotten’: Vijay in Karur, 9 months after stampede

Arun Janardhanan
Karur, July 10

NINE MONTHS after the stampede that claimed 41 lives during his election campaign, Chief Minister C.Joseph Vijay returned to Karur Friday with government job orders for the victims’ families, a promise to build a memorial, and a speech that was part remembrance, part political prosecution and part stand-up performance.

If his Assembly speeches have largely been measured, administrative and restrained, the Karur address was unmistakably the old Vijay — colloquial, conversational and frequently funny, even while revisiting the darkest chapter of his political life. “No matter how high a person rises in life, there are some scars in the heart that can never be forgotten,” he began. “The deepest pain, the deepest wound for me is the Karur incident.”

In his speech, Vijay reconstructed the events leading to the September 2025 tragedy, repeatedly questioning the role of the police. Recalling how the Perambalur police had earlier requested him not to enter the district because crowds had exceeded expectations, he asked why Karur Police had not done the same.

“Couldn’t the Karur police have alerted us too? If the police wanted, they could have cancelled that meeting... They didn’t even have to ask us.” Instead, he said, “The police themselves escorted us from the high-



Tamil Nadu CM Vijay in Karur on Friday. PTI

way into that venue”. “There was a whole drama behind it,” he said. “I believed them. I trusted them completely.”

He repeatedly suggested that the tragedy was not merely an administrative failure but the consequence of deliberate political decisions, though he stopped short of directly naming individuals responsible. “Who’s responsible for all this? Who instructed all this?”

The emotional centre of the speech came not while discussing politics but while describing the children who died. “Those little children who... would smile at their mothers and say, ‘Amma, Vijay mama’. Run up to the TV screen, touch it and kiss it. We’ve lost those precious children. I’ve lost my sisters, my brothers, my family... And you mock me? You throw the blame on me?”

The speech was also about a full-scale political counter-attack.

Targeting the DMK, Vijay accused the previous government

of institutionalised corruption, claiming his administration had begun dismantling entrenched practices inside government offices. “What is the highlight comedy?” he asked, before launching into one of the lighter moments of the afternoon. “I only said ‘party fund.’ I never mentioned which party... The moment I said ‘party fund,’ look at them... they all took off running.”

The chief minister then made perhaps the boldest administrative claim of his tenure. “Go and visit any government office now,” he declared. “Not a single rupee in bribes... Not a single rupee in corruption. Work is getting done just like that -- tick... tick... tick.”

The speech mixed welfare announcements with characteristic theatrical exaggeration.

He joked that before his next Assembly speech he might request the Speaker to “lock all the doors” because Opposition members run away whenever he speaks.

HC restrains EC from notifying bypolls to 5 TN seats until July 31

Bench: Issues arising from pending poll petitions require closer judicial scrutiny

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, July 10

THE MADRAS High Court on Friday restrained the Election Commission from issuing any notification for by-elections to the Tiruchi (East), Perundurai, Ambasamudram, Viralmalai and Karur Assembly constituencies until July 31, holding that issues arising from pending election petitions required closer judicial scrutiny before any further electoral process could be initiated.

A Bench comprising Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dhar-madhikari and Justice G Arul Murugan passed the interim order on a Public Interest Litigation (PIL) filed by Tirunelveli-based advocate K Venkatachalapathy, who argued that the vacancies created by the resignation of the elected members could not automatically be treated as “clear vacancies” under Section 151-A of the Representation of the People Act, 1951 because the election of those members had already been challenged before the High Court.

The court directed all the respondents to file comprehensive counter affidavits within three weeks. “Till then, the first respondent/Election Commission of India is restrained from

issuing any notification for a by-election in respect of the constituencies where the returned candidates resigned, as asserted in the writ petition,” the court said.

According to the PIL, election petitions challenging the victories in all five constituencies seek not only to declare the returned candidates’ elections void but also seek a declaration that the respective election petitioners should themselves be declared elected.

The petitioner argued that conducting bypolls before those petitions are decided could create a constitutional anomaly by producing two individuals with competing claims to represent the same constituency.

The Bench found prima facie support for that contention in earlier Supreme Court precedents. Quoting from D Sanjeevayya Vs Election Tribunal, the High Court observed that if a bypoll is conducted while an election petition seeking a declaration in favour of another candidate remains pending, “there will be two candidates representing the same constituency at the same time... and an impossible situation would arise”. It further noted that the EC “is not bound... to hold a by-election

forthwith but may suspend taking action... till the result of the election petition... is known.”

The Bench also referred to subsequent Supreme Court rulings, including Election Commission vs Telangana Rashtra Samithi and Pramod Laxman Gudadhe v. Election Commission, which distinguished between vacancies where election petitions are pending and those where no such disputes exist. Summarising the legal position, the court observed that “a distinction must be drawn between two categories of vacancies” and that where an election petition seeking composite relief remains pending, “the vacancy cannot be treated as a ‘clear vacancy’ available for a bye-election.”

During the hearing, Advocate General Vijay Narayan, appearing for the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly Secretary, argued that the dates on which the resignations took effect were significant. He contended that at least some resignations had been accepted before the corresponding election petitions were filed and therefore the vacancies had arisen before any election dispute was pending. He sought time to file a detailed counter affidavit on that issue. Senior counsel G Masilamani, appearing for Chief Minister C.Joseph Vijay, questioned the maintainability of the PIL and the petitioner’s locus standi.

• BRIEFLY



The craft is practised in over 5,000 households in Jodhpur. EXPRESS

RAJASTHAN

Govt grants GI to Jodhpur’s Mojari, industry stakeholders hail move

The Centre has granted a Geographical Indication (GI) tag to Jodhpur’s nearly 200-year-old Mojari (Jooti) craft, giving the traditional footwear official recognition and a boost in global branding. The GI Registry handed over the GI certificate to the Jodhpur Handicraft Exporters Association and the Gram Vikas Seva Sansthan on Wednesday. According to the president of Jodhpur Handicraft Exporters Association, Bharat Dinesh, this tag is expected to give the industry a significant fillip. “There are around 400 manufacturers and over 35,000 artisans associated with this trade. Once patronised by the royals, the Mojari gradually evolved into a distinctive craft giving the city a unique identification. Today, artisans practice the craft in over 5,000 households in Jodhpur,” said Dinesh. ENS

Teacher held for sending student to buy liquor

A PRIMARY school teacher in Gujarat’s Gir Somnath district was placed under suspension and arrested for allegedly sending a student to purchase liquor during the school hours, a state minister said on Friday. The alleged incident occurred on June 20 in a primary school of a village in Una taluka, according to the police. The teacher is now under investigation and a three-member inquiry committee has been constituted to look into the incident. Manufacturing, sale and consumption of liquor are prohibited in Gujarat. PTI

Death sentence for trader who killed toddler

Stating that the case falls under the “rarest of rare” category, a court in UP’s Firozabad Friday sentenced a 28-year-old trader to death for killing an 18-month-old boy, whom he slammed to the ground eight times after the child’s mother rejected his marriage proposal. The verdict came within 40 days of the murder. Jitendra Pathak alias Viraj was convicted on Thursday. “The court found the case to fall within the ‘rarest of rare’ category and sentenced Pathak to death,” said Rajeev Kumar Upadhyay, District Government Counsel. ENS

Kerala birth rate has reached an all-time low: 7 takeaways

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, July 10

KERALA’S CRUDE birth rate (CBR) has dropped into single digits for the first time, according to the vital statistics report of 2024 published by the state economics and statistics department. The data also shows that 2023 and 2024 recorded the sharpest back-to-back annual declines in the CBR in recent decades. Here are the key numbers:

CBR FALLS BELOW 10 FOR THE FIRST TIME: The state’s CBR stood at 9.64 in 2024, down from 11.06 in 2023. CBR measures the total number of live births per 1,000 people in a population during a given year. For comparison, India’s CBR, according to the Sample Registration System Statistical Report 2024, is 18.3.

LIVE BIRTHS DROP SHARPLY: The number of live births registered fell to 344,766 in 2024, down from 393,231 in 2023.

TWO CONSECUTIVE YEARS OF THE STEEPEST DECLINES ON RECORD: The CBR fell by 1.42 during 2023-24, following a decline of 1.47 during 2022-23. An analysis of Kerala’s CBR since 1992 shows these are the sharpest annual declines in two consecutive years, indicating that the state’s demographic transition – and its looming population crisis – has accelerated significantly.

A BRIEF POST-PANDEMIC REVERSAL IN 2022: The downward trend temporarily reversed in 2022, the year after the COVID-19 pandemic and lockdown. CBR rose from 11.94 in 2021 to 12.53 in 2022, an annual increase of 0.59, before resuming its decline.

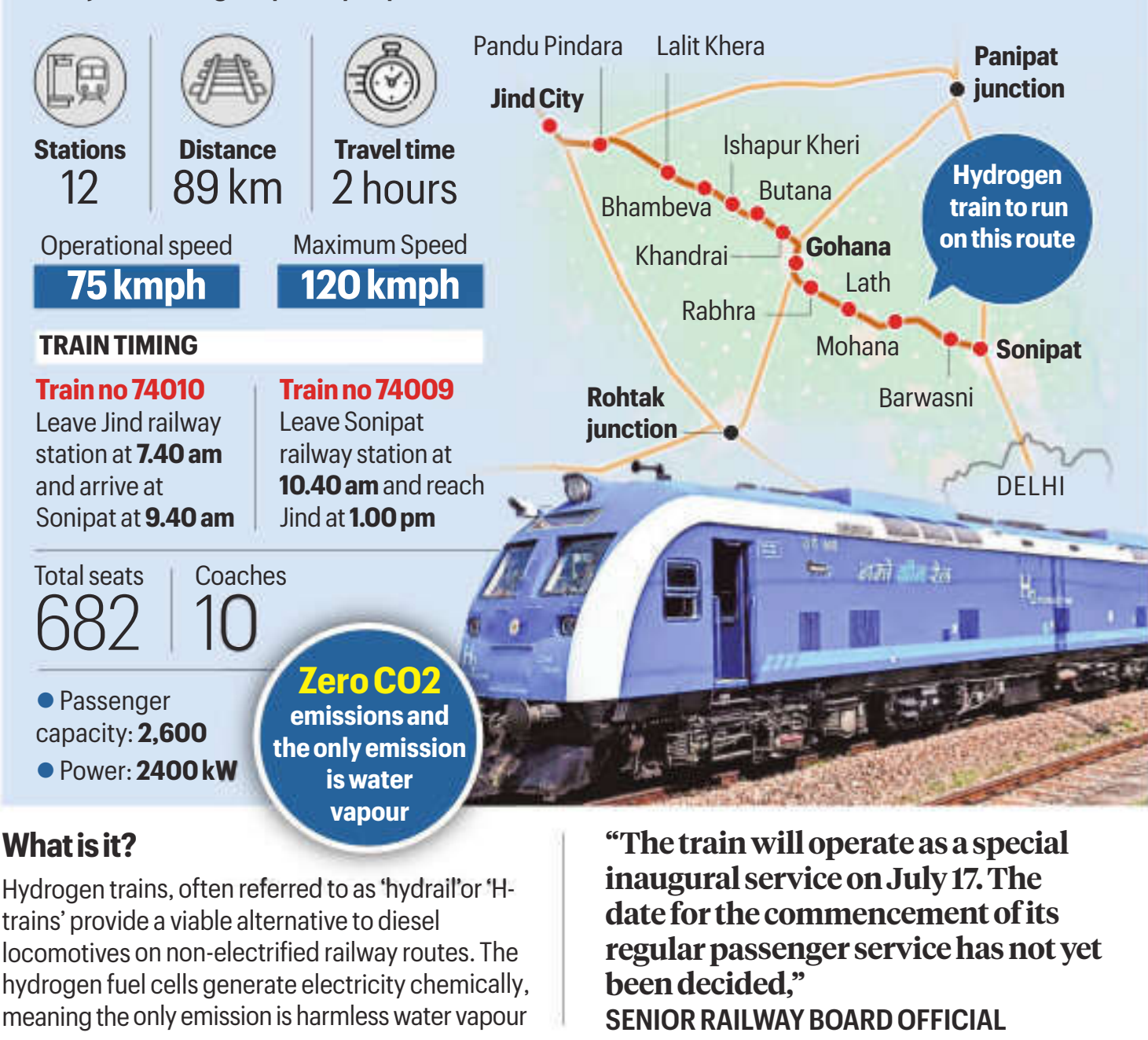
THE TREND SINCE 1992: Kerala’s CBR was 17.67 in 1992 and stayed around that level for several years. It slipped to 16.63 by 2006 and 15.75 by 2010. The rate fell below 15 for the first time in 2016, at 14.48, before dropping again to 13.79 in 2019. It then declined by 1.02 between 2019 and 2020, and by 0.83 between 2020 and 2021.

A NORTH-SOUTH DIVIDE IN DISTRICT-LEVEL BIRTH RATES: Alappuzha has the lowest CBR in the state at 5.28, followed by Kollam at 6.63. Central Kerala districts – Pathanamthitta, Idukki and Ernakulam – range between 9.30 and 7.69.

DEATH RATE STABILISES AFTER COVID-19 SPIKE: Kerala’s crude death rate (CDR), which rose to 9.66 in 2021 and 9.16 in 2022 due to the pandemic, has since eased. The CDR stood at 8.77 in 2024, up slightly from 8.59 in 2023.

• PM TO FLAG OFF HYDROGEN TRAIN ON JULY 17

India joins elite group, only Japan, South Korea, the US and Canada have H-trains



SC slams Maharashtra govt for delay in trial

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 10

THE SUPREME Court on Friday quizzed Maharashtra government for opposing the bail plea of an accused but being “found totally lacking” in conducting a trial “without undue delay”.

A Bench of Justices A Amanullah and Sheel Nagu made its displeasure evident in a matter in which only two of 45 witnesses in a 4-year-old murder case against a foreign national had been examined so far. Though it dismissed the bail plea by accused Kelvin Chindozie Okoro, it asked the Maharashtra government to come up

with a policy to address the situation “so that an accused is not deprived of his liberty for reasons beyond his control and only because (of) a lapse of the prosecution.”

Taking up the matter, Justice Amanullah quizzed the Maharashtra state counsel about the delay after he submitted that two witnesses had been examined so far. “Are you doing a favour? Chargesheet must have been filed in 90 days; otherwise, he would have been released on bail. So, three months out of four years plus... for four years after chargesheet, nothing? whose responsibility it is?” the Judge asked.

WRITER-DIRECTOR WAS JOINED BY EMMA THOMAS, MATT DAMON AND TOM HOLLAND

At Mumbai premiere of *The Odyssey*, Nolan calls Indian audiences ‘among world’s most enthusiastic’

Alaka Sahani
Mumbai, July 10

FILMMAKER CHRISTOPHER Nolan on Friday described Indian moviegoers as “among the most enthusiastic, knowledgeable cinematic audiences in the world” as he launched his latest film, *The Odyssey*, in Mumbai ahead of its global release on July 17.

This is the first time Nolan, who adapted Homer’s *The Odyssey* as a visually stunning IMAX movie, is launching his latest film in India.

Addressing the audience at the end of a special screening at PVR INOX, Lower Parel, the director said it was “a long-cherished wish” to premiere a project in India. “For many years, I wanted to come here and launch one of my films and experience it with Indian audiences, who are among the most enthusiastic and knowledgeable audiences in the world,” he said.

Nolan, who is visiting India for the third time, said, “Every time I come here, it is very



Nolan said he had long wanted to launch one of his films in the country. GANESH SHIRSEKAR

special.” In 2019, the director visited India during the making of *Tenet*. He shot some key sequences in India during a 10-day schedule.

Prior to that, he visited India in 2011 to shoot for *The Dark Knight Rises* at Jodhpur’s Mehrangarh Fort.

For *The Odysseys* India premiere, Nolan is accompanied

by his longtime producing partner and wife Emma Thomas, and actors Matt Damon and Tom Holland.

Damon said the Mumbai screening had the film’s first public viewers since an earlier premiere was attended largely by family and friends. “You are the first real audience who have watched the movie. It means

the world to us that you liked it,” the actor said.

“We worked very hard on it. It’s the result of thousands of people pushing themselves and each other to make this film so that you could watch it this way — filmed entirely on IMAX.”

Holland praised the enthusiasm of Indian movie-

goers, saying: “Thank you from the bottom of my heart for always welcoming us with open arms, happiness, excitement and love. No one brings energy to a movie theatre the way you do in India.”

Emma Thomas called the reception overwhelming and described the event as the culmination of the filmmaking journey.

India is hosting a two-day premiere of the film. Following Friday’s screening, a special show for Indian film personalities and others is scheduled for Saturday.

The Odyssey features Matt Damon as Odysseus, the legendary king whose decade-long arduous journey home after the Trojan War is chronicled in the epic. The film also features Holland, Anne Hathaway, Zendaya, Charlize Theron, Robert Pattinson, Lupita Nyong’o and Samantha Morton in pivotal roles.

Shot across multiple countries, it is the first feature film to be photographed entirely with IMAX cameras.

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, July 10

PARENTS OF a nine-year-old girl, who died by suicide at Jaipur’s Neerja Modi School last year, have released new CCTV footage of the child’s classroom with her child’s father saying that his daughter was “visibly distressed” and that the same can be seen in the video.

The student had allegedly died by suicide on November 1 last year after jumping from school’s fourth floor following bullying by her classmates while the class teacher allegedly paid no heed to her complaints.

In the video, as per the parents, she was allegedly subjected to repeated bullying by her classmates. She then also approaches the class teacher multiple times but allegedly, there is no resolution and she then storms outside the classroom, climbs the stairs, and died by suicide from the fourth floor.

Speaking on the recently filed chargesheet and the class-

The student had allegedly died by suicide on Nov 1 last year after jumping from school’s fourth floor following bullying by her classmates

room CCTV video, her father Vijay Meena said that, “We believe that the chargesheet is incomplete because the CCTV footage clearly shows that she was visibly distressed in the classroom and was repeatedly approaching the class teacher to make her understand... but she wasn’t provided with any protection or counselling.”

He said that the police filed a chargesheet over 8 months on and that the school owner Saurabh Modi, principal Indu Dubey and class teacher Puneeta Sharma have been charged under BNS section 106 (causing death by negligence) and 238 (causing disappear-

ance of evidence of offence, or giving false information to screen offender). The class teacher Sharma has also been charged under section 75 (punishment for cruelty to child) of the Juvenile Justice (JJ) Act, Meena said.

“So, our demand is that the class teacher be also charged with abetment to suicide, while both the school owner and principal should be charged with section 75 of the JJ Act as a child’s safety, supervision, protection and well-being within school premises is the responsibility of school management and principal,” he said, adding that three Investigating Officers (IO) have already been changed in the case in the last eight months and they don’t want the IO to be changed once again.

“Our demand is straightforward, the court should seriously consider the shortcomings in the chargesheet and that the accused be arrested,” he said. The owner and the principal could not be reached for comments.



30 years after Srinagar violence, Shabir Shah, five Hurriyat leaders chargesheeted by NIA

Arun Sharma
Jammu, July 10

THE NATIONAL Investigation Agency (NIA) on Friday filed a chargesheet against six senior leaders of the separatist Hurriyat Conference, including Shabir Ahmed Shah and Syed Ali Shah Geelani, in connection with a 1996 case of mob violence and indiscriminate firing on police personnel in Srinagar.



Shabir Ahmed Shah

Others named in the chargesheet, filed before the NIA Special Court in Jammu, are Abdul Gani Lone, Mohammad Yaqoob Wakeel, Javid Ahmad Mir, and Shakeel Ahmad Bakshi.

All six have been charged under provisions of the Ranbir Penal Code, 1989 (the primary criminal code of the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir), with criminal conspiracy, attempt to murder, rioting and assault on public servants, along with section 13 of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967.

The charges against Syed Ali Shah Geelani, Abdul Gani Lone and Yaqoob Wakeel stand abated as they died during the pendency of the proceedings.

During its investigation, the NIA ascertained that all six accused had allegedly led an unlawful assembly and instigated large-scale violence against police personnel during a funeral procession of slain terrorist Hilal Ahmad Beigh at Naaz Crossing in Srinagar on July 17, 1996.

According to the investigators, armed terrorists blended in with the procession, which was jointly led by the accused Hurriyat leaders, and fired indiscriminately at police personnel during the violence, in which several police personnel

AS WATER RECEDES, TOLL RISES TO 34; BODIES OF MANY MISSING FOUND ON BANKS OF CREEKS

Lost in Surat flood, a 17-year-old walking home, a school van driver

Kamal Saiyed
Surat, July 10

ONE OF them used to be the driver of a van ferrying school-children; another was the owner of a garage. A third had taken loans to start an embroidery business; the fourth was a teenage powerloom worker.

All of them had been missing for the past few days. As floodwaters in Surat continued to recede, the worst fears of their families and the administration were confirmed on Thursday.

By late evening on Thursday, the Surat police and fire department had recovered another 22 bodies, many of people who had been missing since Tuesday (July 7), when the city saw unprecedented rainfall. The death toll for the week had risen to 34 on Friday.

Darshak Chovatiya watched his 27-year-old brother Sandeep Mansukh Chovatiya, the owner of a garage, being swept away by the water on Tuesday afternoon. The brothers were returning to their home in Swastik Residency in Pasodara in a customer's car when both the vehicle and Sandeep were lost in a swollen rivulet.

"We were crossing the rivulet in the Amroli area, and Sandeep was driving slowly. Suddenly, there was a gush of water and the car began to be swept away. I managed to open the door on the passenger side and get out. My brother too struggled out, but he lost his balance and fell. I held on to the branch of a tree and shouted for help, and was ultimately rescued by local people," Darshak told *The Indian Express*.

Sandeep's body was found on Thursday on the banks of the Tapi River in the Amroli area, around 35 metres from the spot



Locals move through a garbage-strewn road as municipal workers carry out a clean-up operation after rainwater receded in Surat's Limbayat area on Friday. PTI

where he was last seen. "Police informed us after they found some documents in his wallet," Darshak said.

Surat has received 30% of the average rainfall for the entire southwest monsoon season in just a week. It rained more than 14 inches on Tuesday, leading to the creeks spilling over and flooding the eastern parts of the city, Municipal Commissioner M Nagarajan told this paper.

Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel reviewed the situation on the ground on Thursday and announced a Rs-500-crore creek development project to arrest the flooding.

Forty-year-old Alpeshbhai Desai, a resident of Shagun Residency in Mota Varachha, Surat, was trying to walk home from his embroidery unit in Kamrej on Tuesday. The overflowing Varachha creek had swallowed the road, and Alpesh lost his footing and fell, police said.

Alpesh's older brother Bha-

vesh Desai (43), who is a diamond polisher by profession, informed the Sarthana police station after failing to reach Alpesh's mobile phone.

His body was found on Thursday near Adarsh School in Sarthana after the level of the creek fell. State Health Minister Praful Pansheriya met the family afterward.

"There was neck-deep water in the entire area," Sarthana Police Inspector D K Patel said. "Very few people dared to venture out. After getting a tip-off, we reached Adarsh School and discovered the decomposed body. Bhavesh, the elder brother of the deceased, identified the body," Patel said.

Bhavesh said Alpesh had left his job in a diamond factory to start the textile embroidery business a year ago. "The loan that he took to buy the machines is yet to be repaid. How will his wife repay the amount? Alpesh's business partner Kishan Patel

too is not in a sound position financially," Bhavesh said.

Shabana Patel informed the Limbayat police station after her 17-year-old son Kamran Sadik Patel did not return home in Khanpura in Limbayat after his day's work in a powerloom factory. The teen's body was found near Bethi Colony on the banks of the Mithi Creek in Limbayat on Thursday.

"After my son had left for work on July 7, the overflowing creek entered our home in heavy rain," Shabana told *The Indian Express*. "We moved to a relative's home on an upper floor nearby."

Shabana said Kamran had called in the afternoon to say that water had entered the powerloom factory, and employees had been told to go home. "My son left his bike at the factory and was walking home. He was swept away by the Mithi Creek. We got on to boats and searched for him...

Police found his body in the evening of July 9."

"We had only one son. We have lost everything in life," Shabana said.

Also on Tuesday, school van driver Ajay Gavit (41), parked his vehicle by the side of the road near Ukhadiya Creek in Dharampur taluka of Valsad district. Leaving some children in the van, he waded through knee-deep water to cross the street to pick up a 9-year-old child. He put her on his shoulders and was walking back when the water swept him away.

Local resident Balubhai Chaudhary saw what happened, and managed to rescue the child. But Gavit could not be found. Dharampur police called in divers who searched for him on Tuesday and Wednesday.

"We finally found Gavit's body around five kilometres away at Tumbi village on the bank of the creek on Thursday evening," Inspector N Z Bhoya of Dharampur police station told *The Indian Express*.

Surat Chief Fire Officer Basant Pareek said, "In two days, our teams have fished out 15 bodies from different parts of Surat city. We found five bodies on July 8, and 10 on Thursday. Some were found on the banks, some were caught in tree branches. Some, which had been in the water for 48 hours, had decomposed."

Municipal Commissioner Nagarajan said, "Surat witnessed rainfall of more than 14.5 inches on July 7... From Thursday, the water started receding, and by evening there was no water in the city. We will now carry out cleaning activities and remove garbage from the roads. Medical teams are in the field to carry out health check-ups."

Maharashtra eases another farm loan waiver rider, farmers now eligible for up to Rs 2 lakh

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, July 10

CONTINUING TO relax the eligibility conditions attached to the Punyashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar farm loan waiver scheme after facing sustained criticism over its exclusions, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis on Friday announced that farmers who had benefited under the earlier Mahatma Jyotirao Phule Shetkari Karj Mukti Yojana would now be eligible for a loan waiver of up to Rs 2 lakh instead of the Rs 50,000 announced earlier.

Under the scheme announced in June, farmers who had benefited from the 2019 Mahatma Jyotirao Phule Shetkari Karj Mukti Yojana and subsequently fell into debt, were eligible only for an incentive of up to Rs 50,000, provided they had availed crop loans between 2022-23 and 2024-25 and repaid them on time. Friday's decision raises that benefit to a loan waiver of up to Rs 2 lakh.

The latest relaxation comes after Opposition parties argued that several eligibility conditions attached to the scheme would leave out a large number of distressed farmers. On June 8, *The Indian Express* reported that the state government's own Cabinet note said the eligibility restrictions were among the reasons the government's eventual expenditure was expected to be lower than the projected outlay of Rs 36,585 crore.

Following the criticism, Agriculture Minister Dattatraya Bharné had said the government was willing to modify the scheme's norms. Friday's announcement marks the first major relaxation of one of the scheme's key conditions.

Couple arrested over hostage killings that shook Manipur

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 10

POLICE IN Manipur said Friday that they arrested a couple from Kangpokpi district for their alleged involvement in the killing of six Naga men earlier in May.

A joint operation was launched by a team of Manipur Police, NIA and CRPF to apprehend the accused in the early hours of Friday, "on the basis of credible inputs," police said.

The arrested couple were identified as Pradip and his wife Ayingbi, residents of Leilon Vaiphei village of the district.

Later, in a separate statement, police said the two had been "identified by witnesses when the abduction took place". "Efforts are on to arrest the other accomplices involved in the crime," police said.

Bodies of the six Naga men, who were from a village in Kangpokpi district, were recovered by security forces on June 10, nearly a month after they were among more than 20 Nagas abducted

Tensions between Manipur's Naga and Kuki-Zo communities have been on edge, particularly since May 13, when three Kuki-Zo church leaders were killed in an ambush in Kangpokpi district

by Kuki groups on May 13. Their mutilated bodies had been recovered from the vicinity of Leilon Vaiphei, a Kuki-Zo village close to their native village.

These arrests were made nearly two months after the abductions and a month after the bodies were recovered. The investigation of the killing of the six men has been handed over to the NIA.

Tensions between Manipur's Naga and Kuki-Zo communities have been on edge, particularly

since May 13, when three Kuki-Zo church leaders were killed in an ambush in Kangpokpi district. This was swiftly followed by the mass abduction of Naga villagers in Kangpokpi district, and by the abduction of over two dozen Kuki-Zo villagers in Senapati district. This had resulted in a hostage stand-off between the two communities, and while both sides had released 14 hostages each, Naga groups had continued to hold 14 Kuki-Zos captive, demanding the release of the six Naga men, who Kuki-Zo groups claimed they did not have information about. Ultimately, the Naga groups released the 14 hostages on June 9, and the bodies of the six Naga men were recovered the next day by security forces.

Since the hostage stand-off and after the recovery of their bodies, Naga groups have maintained a blockade on the movement of goods and supplies into Kuki-Zo-majority areas, demanding the arrest of those responsible for the killings.

EXPRESS special

Pune Army institute revives aspiring pilot's dream after neck injury

Anuradha Mascarenhas
Pune, July 10

AKIREDDY SAI Vedansh had only one dream — to be a pilot in the Indian Air Force. That dream came to an abrupt halt last year when a severe cervical vertebra fracture left the young cadet medically unfit to continue training at Pune's National Defence Academy (NDA).

In a first-of-its-kind initiative, the Army Institute of Technology (AIT), Pune, offered him a fresh start by admitting him directly into the second year of its BTech programme. Now, a year after the injury, with his neck brace removed and recovery progressing well, the 21-year-old is once again pursuing his ambition with renewed determination.

"I hope to appear for the Combined Defence Services examination after my gradu-



Akireddy Sai Vedansh suffered the neck injury during a routine training in March last year

ation and secure a direct entry," Vedansh said, refusing to let the setback define his future.

Coming from an armed forces family — his father is an officer — Vedansh grew up inspired by military life. "I had se-

cured admission at NDA in 2024 and was pursuing a BTech in Applied Electronics and Communication," he said.

A fracture and the end of a dream

The accident occurred in March last year. "It was a routine training. In the process, I fractured my neck," he said. While he did not require surgical intervention, he had to wear a Philadelphia collar that severely restricted his cervical spine movement.

The injury made him medically unfit for the rigours of military training, and he was discharged from the Academy. It was a challenging time for the family, but the AIT stepped in, admitting him to their second-year BTech programme.

The AIT is an engineering college affiliated to the Savitribai Phule Pune University and functions under the aegis of the

Army Welfare Education Society. It admitted Vedansh under the 'over and above' seats provision in line with All India Council for Technical Education guidelines for genuine cases, after receiving approvals from various Army institutions.

Major General Uday Shankar Sengupta (ret'd), Director of AIT, Pune, told *The Indian Express* that the initiative was a first for the institute. "AIT takes pride in being more than an academic institution — it is a community that values compassion and determination," he said.

Despite the severity of his injury and prolonged hospitalisation, Vedansh completed all academic requirements for the second semester. "AIT not only gained a top-scoring student, but his admission and successful completion of one year is a proud milestone for the institute," Sengupta added.

17-year-old NDA cadet dies after routine training

Express News Service
Pune, July 10

A 17-YEAR-OLD first-term cadet at the National Defence Academy (NDA) died in Pune on Friday morning following a medical emergency during routine physical training, defence officials said. It is the third NDA cadet death since October last year.

The cadet, Abhinav Bajpai, from Kanpur, Uttar Pradesh, had joined the NDA on June 24, a press statement issued by the Defence Public Relations Office in Pune said.

"The cadet was immediately evacuated to the Military Hospital, Khadakwasla, where intensive resuscitative efforts were undertaken by the medical team. Despite the best possible medical care and sustained efforts to revive him, he could not be saved and was declared deceased. A Court of Inquiry has been ordered to ascertain the facts and circumstances leading to the incident," it said.

'My father haunted system since 1995 and, clearly, he still does'

[FROM PAGE 1]

Disappearances in Punjab. He showed me photographs of bodies being taken out of trucks for cremation. Foreign journalists, researchers and activists were frequent visitors to our home. As children, we did not understand the scale of what he was documenting, but we knew it involved people who had disappeared and families searching for answers.

Whenever we travelled through villages, people would stop him and narrate what had happened to their sons or brothers. We could see their grief even if we could not fully understand it.

Like any child, I believed the police existed to catch criminals. That belief ended on September 6, 1995. We came home from school and were told Papa had been taken away by the police. Soon after midnight, policemen began visiting our house repeatedly, pressuring my mother to withdraw the case and not name those involved.

When we shifted to our Amritsar house in 1994, my father said something that seemed

strange at the time. During a small gathering with neighbours, he remarked, "I am an ordinary man from village Khallra. If any police officer comes asking where Khallra lives, just show him my house." Only later did we realise he knew the risks he was taking.

After his abduction, hundreds of families began arriving at our doorstep. Many had approached the courts on my father's advice to trace relatives who had disappeared. That was when we realised his work was much larger than our own family.

Within three days, my mother decided she could not sit at home waiting. She moved the Supreme Court. Importantly, she did not seek relief only for my father's disappearance. She also placed before the court his entire investigation into alleged fake encounters and illegal cremations. That became the basis for the CBI investigation. His case ultimately opened the door for many other victims to seek justice.

How did your father's case change Punjab and the system?

My father never ran away from the system; he chose to challenge it through the law. Once, when my grandfather worried that his activism would drag the family into endless court cases, my father replied, "*Main kite ni bhajjeya* (I am not running anywhere)".

When my father was abducted and killed in 1995, such cases were happening everywhere in Punjab. No one questioned the State and the police, but my father's case changed that. *Ohna nu eh nahisi pata ki inne hor maarke, ikki laashi inni bhaari pai jungi* (They probably did not know that after killing so many others, one body will prove to be so heavy for them). From the US to Canada, everyone questioned Indian authorities about Khallra.

Despite warnings, my mother refused security or any change in our routine. We continued living in the same house and studying in the same schools. She believed fear could not become our way of life.

For nearly three years, we did not know what had happened to my father. We suspected the worst but had no proof. It was only after former

policeman Kuldeep Singh Bachra disclosed in 1998 how my father had been killed that we accepted he was gone.

My father's death, painful as it was, probably saved many others from suffering the same fate.

More than three decades later, Satlu has brought your father's story back into public discussion, but the film has also been taken off the OTT platform. How do you view the controversy?

We were never surprised. We had anticipated resistance from the beginning. We had even told director Honey Trehan that making this film would not be easy.

One *laash* (corpse) proved too heavy for the State to forget. My father has haunted the system since 1995 and, clearly, he still does.

Ironically, the attempt to stop the film has only drawn more attention to it. People are now reading about that period, discussing it and asking questions. That, in itself, is significant.

Honey Trehan based his work on court records and

documented evidence. Nothing in the film has been imagined. In fact, we had made our position clear: if the film had to be released, it should be released in its entirety. We would not support a heavily diluted version.

People often question my father's estimate of 25,000 disappeared persons. We continue to stand by that figure unless someone can prove otherwise.

Some politicians and critics continue to portray your father as sympathetic to the Khalistan movement. The Centre has justified the ban by citing security concerns and the possibility of fuelling radical sentiment. How do you respond?

My father was a law-abiding citizen. Ironically, even the Punjab police never claimed he had committed any offence. During the trial, their position was that there was not a single criminal case registered against him. So the obvious question is: if he had committed no crime, why was he abducted and killed?

He believed that justice had to be pursued through institu-

tions established by law. That is exactly what my mother did after his abduction by approaching the Supreme Court.

Yes, my father was a devout Sikh. He deeply identified and sympathised with the struggle and suffering of Sikhs during that period. There is nothing to deny about that. But he never reduced his work to religion. He documented every victim he came across. Hindu names were never excluded from his records. His concern was human rights, not the religion of the victim.

He believed every movement had to remain rooted in justice and should never harm innocent people, irrespective of religion or caste. Many of his closest friends were Hindus who stood with our family and grieved with us after his death.

What I find striking is that people who have actually watched the film are talking about disappearances, illegal cremations and human rights. The Khalistan debate is largely being pushed by those who want attention diverted from those uncomfortable questions.

The attempt to revive a Hindu-Sikh binary only dis-

tracts from the central issue.

Punjab is heading towards another election. Political parties have already begun taking positions on the film. Do you expect any support from them?

We have learnt not to expect much from political parties. For us, all parties — BJP, Congress, SAD or now AAP — are the same. The BJP has proved this by banning the movie now.

My father worked with the Shiromani Akali Dal, yet after his abduction, my mother was advised by its leadership to move on with her life and focus on raising her children. We have therefore never viewed this as a fight that belonged to one political party or another.

For us, this was always about the State and the way it exercised power. Governments changed, parties changed, but our legal battle continued for sixteen years before convictions finally came in my father's case.

If political leaders are genuinely concerned today, they should support an honest accounting of everyone who died in Punjab during those years. Why not conduct an independent "death census" so that the truth is established on the basis of evidence rather than com-

peting narratives?

Critics say the film presents only one side of Punjab's tragedy and does not adequately portray the killings of Hindus by militants or others who suffered during the insurgency.

For nearly forty years, the State's version of events dominated public discourse. Only now are Sikhs and Punjabis beginning to tell their own stories. That should not be seen as erasing anyone else's suffering.

Every innocent life lost matters. Hindus, Sikhs and people from other communities all suffered during those years. My father never excluded Hindu victims from his documentation. But we also have to acknowledge that a very large number of those allegedly killed in fake encounters and secret cremations were Sikhs.

Recognising one set of victims does not diminish another. The real challenge is to build a complete and honest historical record.

Khallra has haunted the system for three decades because the issues he raised have never been fully addressed. Until the truth is confronted honestly, his story will continue to return.

The IndianEXPRESS

~ FOUNDED BY ~

RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Easing on China is right move at right time

IN 2019, India decided against joining RCEP, a trade agreement spanning 15 Asia-Pacific countries. A few months later, in April 2020, the Centre amended the FDI policy via Press Note 3, making government approval mandatory for investments from countries that share a land border with India. Both decisions were, in part, driven by concerns over China. But despite the ambiguity since then over the relationship with Beijing, trade ties between the two countries have deepened considerably. Imports from China touched \$131 billion in 2025-26 and the country now accounts for roughly half of India's non-oil goods trade deficit. However, FDI from China has been minuscule. Since 2000, investment flows to India have added up to just \$2.5 billion. The government has now approved a joint venture between Dixon Technologies and Vivo Mobile for manufacturing electronic devices and smartphones in the country. This is a step in the right direction.

In recent years, there has been a concerted attempt by multinationals to diversify away from China. India has, however, not been a significant beneficiary of the China+1 play, with countries like Vietnam benefiting more. The Economic Survey 2023-24 put forth two choices to benefit from the trade diversion away from China — either integrate more deeply with its supply chains or encourage greater FDI from the country. The Survey veered towards the latter option. In line with this thinking, in March this year, the Union cabinet approved changes to the FDI policy for investment from countries that share a land border with India in order to facilitate greater inflows. The approval of the joint venture between Dixon Technologies and Vivo Mobile and the waiver of customs duty on 85 goods used in manufacturing batteries, display assemblies and others comes only days after four Chinese power equipment manufacturing companies were reportedly allowed to take part in government tenders for critical power projects.

China is inextricably linked to the global manufacturing supply chain. That reality cannot be wished away. China is also a large source of FDI. As per the World Investment Report by UNCTAD, its outward investment "has become more targeted, with greater emphasis on greenfield projects, manufacturing, energy, infrastructure and critical raw materials, often in developing economies and along South-South investment corridors". While India has legitimate strategic and security concerns, there are also economic imperatives. A balance must be struck. The domestic manufacturing ecosystem must be deepened, and efforts stepped up to increase value addition and pursue closer integration with global supply chains. A careful and calibrated approach is needed.

In Bengal, a crime, the mob & state abdication

THIRTY KILOMETRES away from Kolkata, a story of serial state failures plays out. First, there was a heinous crime, the assault and murder of an 11-year-old, allegedly by four men, which sparked protests and demands for justice. The brutalising of a child can shake faith in the government's ability to protect the most vulnerable. Then, a man was lynched by a mob in Baruipur in South 24 Parganas district for the murder — it turned out that he, reportedly, was not responsible for it. Chief Minister Suvenudra Adhikari asked the police to identify lapses and an SIT was constituted. That, however, cannot mask the third failure: The "encounter" of an accused and the ruling party's defence of that action.

The framing of the lynching by Chief Minister Adhikari is deeply problematic. He has sought to let his government's law enforcement off the hook, and spoken of the mob violence as a "political conspiracy" with a "communal connection". State BJP president Dilip Ghosh has labelled those questioning the encounter and the subversion of due process as "anti-social". "The criminal and those who support criminals should receive equal treatment," he said. These statements from the highest political quarters are unseemly. They can even be read as signalling a tolerance of, or impunity for, extra-judicial action and state vigilantism. They are especially jarring coming from a ruling party that has made big promises on law and order and women's safety.

As part of *poriborton*, the BJP promised the West Bengal voter relief from a ruling dispensation whose politics crept into all institutions and cramped all spaces, from the economy to crime and justice. By looking for fall guys for its lapses, the Adhikari government is not getting off to a good start. It must, going forward, underline its respect for institutions, due process and fundamental rights, of victims and also the accused. The first step to that end must be a delinking of law and order and partisan politics.

Now showing: Mr Brexit vs Count Binface

WILLIAM PITT the Younger was, appropriately, Britain's youngest-ever prime minister, taking office at the age of 24. The sitcom *Blackadder* made a gag out of it, showing an election in which the PM's brother, a child ("Pitt the Even Younger") is a candidate. But election-watchers might remember this episode for another reason: The candidate of the fictitious Standing at the Back Dressed Stupidly and Looking Stupid Party, doing just that. It was funny because it was real — satirical parties and candidates have long been a feature of British elections. Recall the Official Monster Raving Loony Party. Or, the Landless Peasant Party candidate standing with his fist raised behind Gordon Brown in 2010. But now, things have turned deadly serious: Nigel Farage's principal opponent in the upcoming Clacton by-election will be Count Binface.

The Reform UK leader resigned from Parliament and triggered the by-election in a bid to vindicate himself amid a controversy over his finances, and all other major parties are boycotting the poll — leaving Farage, in the words of Chancellor Rachel Reeves, to "spend the summer arguing with a bin". Binface does wear a bin-shaped helmet; underneath it is comedian Jon Harvey. His policies include nationalising Adele and building at least one affordable house. One might twig from all this that the point is satire. Reform supporters, however, have been attacking Binface as an Oxford-educated member of the elite. Well, he is a count after all.

Few expect Binface to win on August 13, although he may benefit from protest votes. There's a discussion to be had about whether the other parties' boycott deprives voters of serious alternatives or if participating would merely be playing into Reform's hands. Beyond this contest, though, in a country that bins prime ministers faster than a lettuce can rot, the count may just embody the zeitgeist.

Next leap will come from bringing AI and digital public infrastructure together



MANISH SABHARWAL AND RAVI BAPNA

THE FAILURE of multiple visits by the Japanese government to 111-year-old Sogen Kato's house to honour him — he was never home — had a simple explanation. He had been dead for 30 years while his family collected his pension. This triggered a national investigation that identified 3 lakh people who were assumed to be "living" but were dead. India's Aadhaar programme has reduced such pension scandals, improved the efficiency of government spending (up 117 times since 1991), and catalysed digital payments (42 per cent of the world's transactions). The next orbit for digital public infrastructure (DPI) lies in AI integration — it will raise state capacity and empower the new tone from the top on Jan Vishwas.

The last few years have been tough for Indian tech. We don't have a credible horse in the AI generation race, DeepSeek came out of China, and automated code generation has blunted the employment outlook for software services. But a recent conference at the National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER) suggested optimism about this digital revolution of AI for three reasons. India is the world's largest natural data laboratory. Integrating DPI with AI could be the biggest reimagination of the

Indian state since 1947. And AI deployment may be more employment-generative than AI generation. Let's look at all three in detail.

First, India has gone from data poor to data rich in just 10 years because of three bold acts of entrepreneurship in 2016: Jio, UPI, and GST. For decades, India's economic policy relied on periodic surveys and delayed, uneven and incomplete administrative data. But now, DPI's digital exhaust makes us the world's largest natural data laboratory for financial inclusion, welfare targeting, enterprise formalisation, platform economics and digital governance. UPI's monthly 23 billion transactions create one of the world's largest behavioural datasets. GST's 20 crore payments create real-time visibility into supply chains, invoicing, production and consumption. FASTag's 4.5 billion payment transactions create mobility and logistics datasets at scale. And, more than 27 billion annual Aadhaar authentications enabled a 16-fold expansion in direct benefit transfer beneficiaries. For the first time, a developing country is using population-scale digital data to accelerate development rather than waiting for conventional statistical systems to catch up. The job is hardly done — rigorous academic research, well-funded think tanks to bridge theory and practice, and open public data commons are just emerging — but the future seems very different from the past.

Second, India's political reimagination since 1947 has created the world's largest democracy on the infertile soil of the world's most hierarchical society. But why didn't we create the world's largest economy? Besides the delusional 1956 Second Five-Year Plan, weak state capacity

DPI without AI is infrastructure, and AI without DPI is intelligence. AI plus DPI is enhanced state capacity

The earth under a Teejan sky



RAJEEV SETHI

TEEJAN BAI, who lived to demolish many boundaries, is now free to go wherever and do whatever she wants. As a girl child, she was told not to perform — she did. She was told to settle down — she didn't. She was asked not to improvise with the Pandavani *parampara*; she created her own form with her unique blend of narrating the mythos, punctuated with personal anecdotes.

I met her five decades ago with Habib Tanveer, who tried to "stage" her. She found her own sky, mentors, and audiences, creating her own Mahabharata with her favourite acts strung together as personal narratives. Who can forget her rising up, expanding her frame, becoming a challenged Bhima, holding her tambura like the mace of Bhima? Or becoming Draupadi, forced to surrender her dignity in a patriarchal court?

In every region in India, villagers claim that the Pandavas, during their *agyatvas*, stayed there. In Chhattisgarh, several local popular stories have been woven into the epic over the years. The stories of the Mahabharata, here, are called Pandavani, the stories of the Pandavas.

Originally, the Pandavani was strictly restricted to men. Teejan became the first Pandavani woman storyteller. She drew inspiration from folk tales and rituals and from the local understanding of the *shashtra*. With her defiance of community norms, Teejan had also opened the doors for young female *kathakars* to battle against the customs of a conservative rural society.

I had the fortune of "directing" Teejan ji in three separate productions over the years: *The Hidden River* for the NCPA in Mumbai (1995), *Mother Daughter-Father Son* for Ariane Mnouchkine of Theatre de Soleil in Paris (1994), and *Sangram Aur Azadi* for the sesquicentennial of 1857 at the Red Fort in Delhi (2007).

We had gathered in Mumbai to unravel a series of powerfully enacted vignettes that would reveal the delicate story of union and balance struggling to survive in a polarised world. Teejan, known for demolishing male bastions, decided to play the invincible Bhishma, demolished by Shikhandi, without whose help even Bhima couldn't succeed. Great gurus in-

vited as part of my *Hidden River* workshops had watched for the first time Teejan making gender fluid.

Everyone was exceptionally moved by Teejan's simultaneous tenacity and vulnerability and was inspired to follow her act with their unique artistry highlighting female-centric representations. Today, few artists across genres see each other perform.

My second reference is the play we created in Paris on an idea given by Ariane Mnouchkine to explore the vulnerable world of *parivarik parampara* in this age of mass and multiple transmissions. Ariane and Teejan loved each other, and we all bonded over being together in Paris to create a totally new theatrical production on traditional transmission. This was the link I needed for Teejan to tell us how she would choose someone to hand over her legacy to.

She found Rambha, a tenacious young relative, who took on the challenge, and every night of the performance we all watched spellbound as the magic of transmission went beyond the call of duty of student-teacher.

Teejan never had a child of her own, but the mother and father in her made her look after a whole "*kumbha*" of accompanists and their families.

The third anecdote related to my last unrecorded foray in theatre. When the offer to create an inter-medial manifestation came up to celebrate 150 years of 1857, I jumped on the idea of celebrating the courage of sepoys, retelling their stories. I could only think of Teejan amidst 2,000 artists. Teejan chose to narrate the tale of bravery and defiance implicit and explicit in the story of Abhimanyu in the *chakravayuh*.

Teejan Bai often espoused the magic of reaching out to breathing audiences, "*saans leti janta*", under the open sky she yearned for. Working for the Bhilai Steel Plant for 30 years, she could create an audience. In the end, paralysed and unable to speak, she did regret that artists can never take on the "*maidan-e-jung*" as a "*khulla manch*" of their own lives. For her, nurturing emotions and needs meant more than "*chahaks*" and "*jajmans*" (fans and patrons).

The writer is the founder-trustee and chairman of Asian Heritage Foundation

40 YEARS AGO

July 11, 1986



Another panel on transfer likely

THE MUCH-awaited transfer of Chandigarh to Punjab and areas in lieu of the city to Haryana on July 15 is once again being deferred at the request of the Punjab Chief Minister, Surjit Singh Barnala. The Centre may appoint another commission to identify the areas to be transferred from Punjab to Haryana.

Pakistan to make Chinese F-7s

PAKISTAN HAS decided to produce three prototypes of the Chinese F-7 interceptor aircraft upgraded with US engines, avionics

and weaponry systems. This decision is understood to have been taken simultaneously with a \$2 million contract to an American firm for the design study of the modified fighter. The three prototype fighter jets when completed will function like an upgraded MiG-21.

Ahmedabad death toll at 19

MORE AREAS of the walled city were brought under curfew and vigil by the security forces stepped up as the death toll in communal violence during the annual *rath yatra* procession rose to 19. Four bodies were recovered and four others suc-

human capital than AI generation itself does. You don't have to build a car to drive it; let's build the roads (AI applications) that get people to extract economic and social value. The deployment of AI in DPI could make India the use-case capital of the world, not unlike the American state that used defence spending during the Cold War to catalyse Silicon Valley. India's enterprise DPI, currently under implementation (universal enterprise number, entity digilocker, API Setu, single source of truth for regulation), could potentially combine with a Universal Lifetime Social Security Account for every citizen (Aadhaar *punji*) to unleash a revolution in formalisation similar to what NPCI did in payments (private innovation on a non-profit layer). This would reduce information asymmetry, lower transaction costs, improve credit allocation and worker-job matching, enhance supply chain and logistics efficiency, and accelerate the creation of high-wage, private, non-farm jobs.

The *Arthashastra* suggests that strategy is most powerful when choices in strength, timing, and place are mutually reinforcing. Combining our strengths in DPI with the new tone from the top about Jan Vishwas (NCAER research suggests 66 per cent of connected Indians use the internet for entertainment but only 11 per cent for online government services), could deliver our new tryst with destiny: Higher state capacity, citizen satisfaction, and mass prosperity. And this is an appointment we shall keep.

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A funeral in Iran as a performance of power



SUJATA ASHWARYA

IRAN BURIED Ayatollah Ali Khamenei this week in a funeral designed to be read. His casket travelled from Tehran to Qom, across the border to Najaf and Karbala, and finally to Mashhad for burial beside the eighth Shia imam. The casket was draped in the red Ya Hussein flag flown from the Karbala shrine itself. A giant clenched fist rose in Enghelab Square, framed by images of ballistic missiles; banners in three languages carried the funeral's motto: We must rise. The ceremonies were timed to coincide with Muharram, the month of mourning for Imam Hussain's martyrdom, and also the 250th anniversary of American independence.

As scholar Lisa Wedeen observed of Assad's Syria, authoritarian states demand that citizens act as if they believe, because the public performance of belief is itself a form of control. The regime does not need every mourner to grieve. It needs every mourner to be seen grieving. Khamenei was killed in the opening strikes of a war that shattered Iran's deterrent architecture. The funeral recasts this defeat as Karbala, the seventh-century martyrdom that anchors Shia identity. In this telling, a leader who could not be protected becomes one who chose sacrifice, and failure acquires the dignity of sacred continuity. The state is drawing on the deepest reservoir of meaning in Shia culture to transform a death it could not prevent into a sacrifice it can claim. Hundreds of thousands have indeed filled the Imam Khomeini Grand Mosalla and the processional routes, their grief genuine and, for many, profound. But the mourning is not universal. Many buried their own dead in the crackdowns of 2009, 2022, and 2026. The regime's answer is transport, food, and an infrastructure of mourning designed to show unanimity. Grief organised with the logistics of a military operation is grief doing political work.

The most eloquent symbol of the week, however, is an absence. Mojtaba Khamenei, who succeeded his father as Supreme Leader, did not attend the funeral. Iranian officials say he was kept away for fear of an Israeli assassination. Consider what this means. The new leader cannot stand at his own father's grave, and his voice reaches his people through an intermediary. A state that cannot secure its leader during a ritual of such consequence is performing strength precisely because it cannot demonstrate it. The same logic now extends to the Strait of Hormuz. Under the MoU signed with the US, Iran has guaranteed toll-free passage for 60 days. Yet its newly created Persian Gulf Strait Authority has made Iranian-approved insurance mandatory for every transiting vessel, free for now, while reserving the right to charge fees when the window closes. The revenue at stake is marginal beside the cost of reconstruction. The fee's true function is symbolic.

But there is a difference between symbols that express power and symbols that substitute for it. The Islamic Republic governs a wounded country: An economy in ruins, deepening isolation, a population whose suffering the ceremonies are designed to re-frame rather than relieve. Modernity plays by modern rules, written in production figures, investment flows, and legitimacy, none of which can be conjured by a flag from Karbala. The funeral ended in Mashhad. The symbols have done their work, and they have revealed exactly what they were deployed to conceal.

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The state is drawing on the deepest reservoir of meaning in Shia culture to transform a death it could not prevent into a sacrifice it can claim

cumbed to their injuries in city hospitals.

PM to meet Northeast CMs

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, has convened a meeting of chief ministers of all northeastern states to assess the impact of the Mizo peace accord in the region and to consider measures for tackling insurgent groups operating in some parts of the region. The meeting, called at short notice, is expected to be attended by chief ministers and chief secretaries of Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Arunachal Pradesh and Tripura besides Mizoram, to review developmental programmes.



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You vote therefore you are: The hidden consequences of electoral deletion



SY QURAISHI

THE RECENT experience of R Rajagopal, former editor of *The Telegraph*, should worry every Indian citizen. Rajagopal has publicly stated that the renewal of his passport was held up after police verification because his name had been deleted from the electoral roll during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR). He received his renewed passport subsequently, but the fact remains: A distinguished journalist who had voted for decades suddenly found himself unable to obtain a passport because he no longer existed on the voters' list.

When reports of large-scale deletions from electoral rolls first began to emerge, the reaction of many citizens was surprisingly indifferent. "I never voted anyway," some remarked. "What difference does it make if my name is deleted?" Having spent years combating precisely this voter apathy through the Election Commission's SVEEP programme, I recognised the sentiment immediately. It reflected the widespread belief that deletion from the electoral roll meant nothing more than losing an opportunity that many had never exercised.

The Rajagopal episode exposes how mistaken that assumption may be.

The Election Commission has consistently assured the Supreme Court that the SIR is confined to preparing electoral rolls and that deletion carries no consequences beyond the right to vote. The Supreme Court, too, has reiterated that deletion from the electoral roll does not determine citizenship. The developments on the ground, however, suggest that this constitutional separation is beginning to erode.

An early cautionary lesson came from Assam. The National Register of Citizens was an exercise directly concerned with citizenship. Yet even there, exclusion from the NRC did not by itself result in loss of citizenship; any such determination could follow only after due process before the Foreigners' Tribunals. Even so, many families whose records became entangled in the NRC process found access to Aadhaar-linked services disrupted for years.

What, incidentally, are the welfare

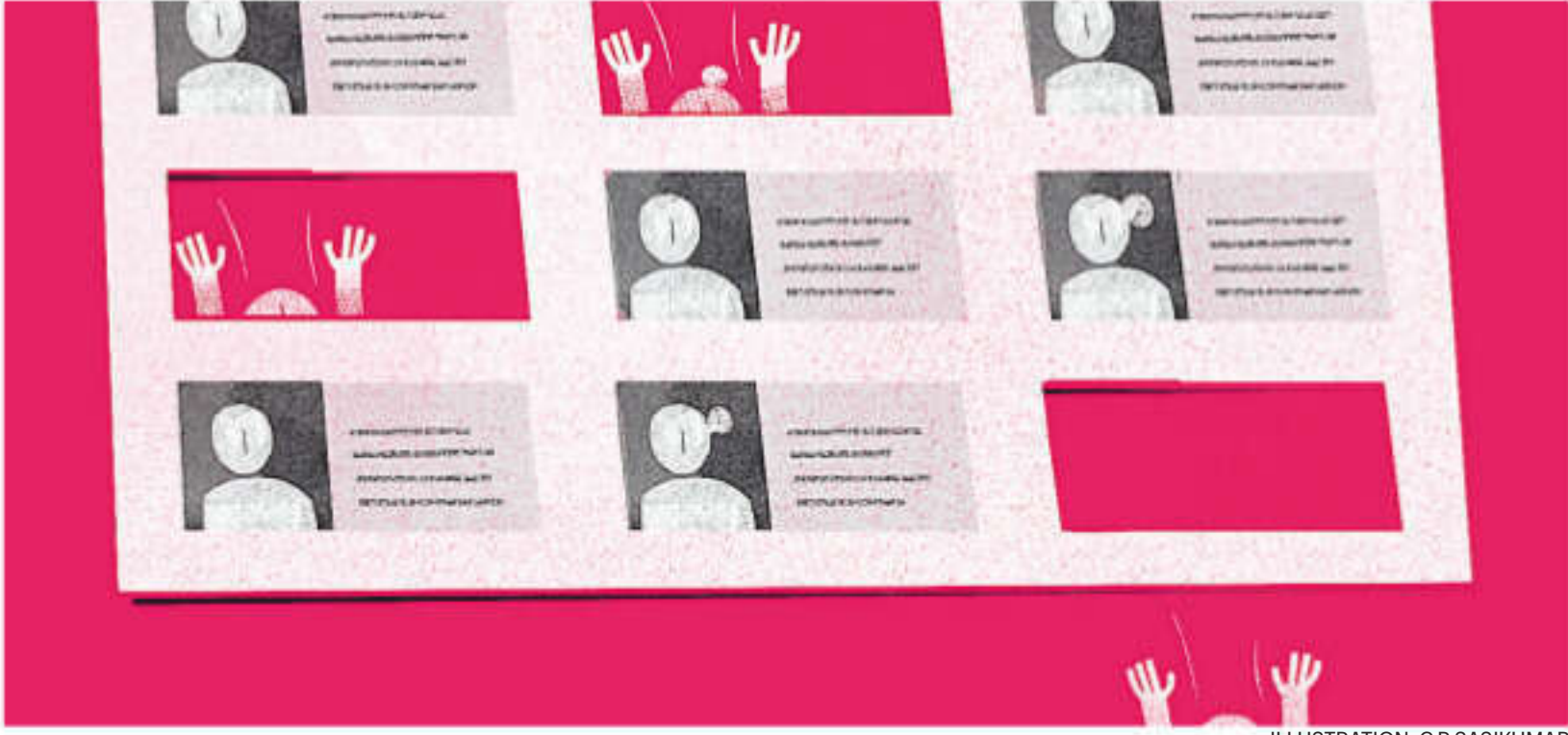


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

schemes? Subsidised food grain under the public distribution system, scholarships for students, old-age, widow and disability pensions, maternity benefits, LPG subsidies, housing assistance, health insurance, direct benefit transfers and even routine banking services. The lesson was simple: Although one government database was never intended to determine rights under another, administrative consequences often travelled far beyond the original purpose of the exercise.

That possibility has now become a harsher reality.

In Bihar, the consequences of electoral deletion have been stated with brazen candour. Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary said that persons deleted from the electoral roll "will not be entitled to any government benefits, including ration and other welfare schemes", and that "their bank passbooks will also be cancelled in due course of time." For the first time in independent India, deletion from the electoral roll has been publicly linked with exclusion from welfare benefits and even banking services.

West Bengal has moved in a similar direction. Chief Minister Suvenendu Adhikari

declared that "no deceased person, illegal infiltrator or non-Indian individual will be allowed to avail government schemes". Food and Supplies Minister Ashok Kirtania stated that "those whose names have been deleted through the SIR cannot avail government schemes". Another minister added that persons deleted "are not citizens of the country or are dead... They cannot get the bene-

The Supreme Court, too, has reiterated that deletion from the electoral roll does not determine citizenship. The developments on the ground, however, suggest that this constitutional separation is beginning to erode

fit of government schemes."

The Election Commission had assured the Supreme Court that the constitutional wall separating the electoral roll from other civic entitlements would remain intact. It is precisely that assurance which now appears to be under threat.

Assam, though not covered by the SIR, offers a different but equally instructive example — one that reveals the political purpose that electoral roll revision can come to serve. During the recent revision of electoral rolls, CM Himanta Biswa Sarma declared publicly: "My job is to make the Miya people suffer." He urged that Bengali-speaking Muslims be "troubled" "in any way" possible, adding: "Only if they face troubles will they leave Assam... We are saying it openly; we are not hiding it." He also announced that 4 to 5 lakh "Miya" voters would be deleted from Assam's electoral rolls and later explained: "I won't be able to deport them in my lifetime. That's why I keep pressuring them, so that they leave by themselves." It is the language not of an administrator updating electoral rolls but of a constitutional functionary presenting electoral deletion as an instrument of exclusion.

If Bihar and West Bengal illustrate the expanding administrative consequences of electoral deletion, Assam illustrates something even more disturbing — the political purpose that, in some quarters, is now openly attached to it.

Taken together, these developments reveal a pattern that should concern every constitutional democracy. A list prepared for the

limited purpose of determining who may vote is quietly beginning to influence who may receive welfare benefits, banking services and travel documents. A clerical mistake, an absent migrant worker, a missed visit by a booth-level officer, or the inability to produce an old document can now trigger a chain of consequences extending far beyond the polling booth.

This is no longer merely about the right to vote. It is about the citizen's relationship with the state.

The electoral roll serves one constitutional purpose: Identifying those entitled to vote under Article 326. Welfare benefits flow from separate statutes. Banking relationships are governed by different laws. Passports are issued under an entirely different legal framework. Citizenship is determined under the Citizenship Act, not the Representation of the People Act. These legal boundaries exist to ensure that an administrative exercise designed for one objective does not become a mechanism for exclusion in entirely unrelated spheres of public life.

Once those boundaries begin to dissolve, the consequences become grave. A citizen deleted from one database may gradually discover that he has disappeared in many others. The case of R Rajagopal is therefore not merely the story of one journalist encountering bureaucratic difficulty. It is a warning to the republic. Those who once dismissed electoral deletion with a shrug — "I never voted anyway" — now have reason to think again. Their indifference rested on the belief that only the vote was at stake. That assumption no longer appears safe.

Electoral rolls are indispensable to free and fair elections. They must never become proxies for determining a citizen's entitlement to rights, services or benefits beyond the electoral process. The republic has always recognised a vital constitutional distinction between the right to vote and the broader rights of citizenship. That distinction now deserves to be reaffirmed — with clarity and without delay.

For, if deletion from the electoral roll is allowed to acquire consequences far beyond the franchise, the hidden cost of losing one's name from the voters' list may prove to be not merely the loss of a vote, but the beginning of a citizen's gradual disappearance from official existence.

The writer is former Chief Election Commissioner of India and author of An Undocumented Wonder: The Making of the Great Indian Election

Our universities need a reset, not China playbook



ABHAY JERE

LAST MONTH, China conducted a surgical strike on its education system and scrapped over 12,000 undergraduate degree programmes that it deemed obsolete and irrelevant. Effectively, it declared one in three of its university courses unfit for the future job market. In their place, 10,200 new programmes in AI, robotics, semiconductors, quantum applications and advanced manufacturing were introduced. Even newer disciplines like "embodied intelligence" are now receiving an institutional push. These reforms were triggered by numbers China could no longer ignore. Its urban youth unemployment is around 16 per cent, even as AI companies complained they could not find qualified people to hire.

Aren't we facing a similar problem? By 2047, India aspires to become a \$20-trillion economy. Education remains the primary ladder for social and financial mobility. Building globally competitive human capital should be our foremost national priority. We say that we are now bigger than China, and younger, more diverse and governed by democratic structures. None of that changes the number staring back at us: According to the latest India Skills Report, only 56 per cent of graduates are employable.

The India Graduate Skill Index

China rewrote a third of its university system because it ran out of patience. India still has a choice

found that employability in AI and machine-learning roles climbed by 46 per cent, while employability in HR, digital marketing and administration is falling. Some US universities have slashed fees by 50 per cent for conventional MBA programmes, considering declining demand in an AI-dominated world. The market is not confused. Our education policies need to catch up. BBA, BA and BCom programmes are struggling because they prepare students for work that software now performs for free, like data entry, translation, and first-draft analysis. A student beginning a three- or four-year degree today may graduate into a job description that will no longer exist. With over 4 crore students enrolled across 50,000-plus colleges, and roughly 55-58 per cent studying Arts, Humanities or Commerce, the scale of potential displacement is huge.

India cannot and should not run China's playbook. For millions of first-generation learners, education is the most powerful instrument of upward mobility. But "we can't copy China" must not become an excuse for inaction. What we need is not the death of disciplines — it is their rebirth. Humanities programmes must evolve into digital humanities or cultural analytics. Linguistics must effectively merge with computational se-

mantics. Engineering syllabi must be rebuilt around "systems thinking" and "energy transition", not legacy techniques.

Industry 5.0 is no longer a distant reality. Now, humans and intelligent machines will work alongside each other. This has already reshaped factory floors, finance teams and design studios. Skill augmentation must become as integral to higher education as earning a degree itself. The NEP 2020, though visionary, is a pre-AI document. We may now need a focussed AI addendum that formally pivots our approach. Our Union Budget has set aside Rs 500 crore for a Centre of Excellence in AI for Education, in tandem with the IndiaAI Mission. However, pilots are not systems, and intent is not infrastructure.

If we are serious about Viksit Bharat, then we need to build a framework of viksit vishwavidyalaya — not as another pilot project to be announced and quietly shelved, but as a national standard for a future-ready Indian university where every degree holder sits alongside genuine AI and data fluency. China rewrote a third of its university system because it ran out of patience. India still has a choice. The question is whether we make it — before the decision is made for us.

The writer is MD & CEO, Dexit Global and former vice-chairman of AICTE

Brazil's power is not its five Cups, but its dancing feet

self performing the same ritual in Noida, only with less urgency. Intoxicated by a concoction of corporate and capital, seldom does this city pause to breathe for football. I am spared the jeers that inevitably follow when a Brazil exit coincides with an Argentina triumph. Except, there is an invisible thread that connects the two cities — the hurt feels exactly as unendurable.

Where I grew up, football teams were not chosen. They were inherited as family heirlooms. The generation before ours witnessed two revolutions in quick succession. First came globalisation. Then came Brazil. Before Arun Govil taught divinity, Zico and Sócrates had already cast their spells. Before Shaktimaan, Romário was the closest personification of a superhero. Brazil were not loved because they won. They were loved be-

cause they brought joy.

Unfortunately, the Brazil we grew up venerating bears little resemblance to the one that arrived in the US. The flamboyance has made way for the formulaic.

For the Indian working class, who grew up far removed from Rio's beaches and São Paulo's streets, Brazil represented something much larger than merely football. Nothing paralysed us quite like the tyranny of "what if". What if we fail at the impending examinations looming large? What if we cannot articulate ourselves in the job in-

For generations, they played football as though failure was an acceptable price for beauty

terview? What if we don't live up to the societal expectations we had very little control over? What if the letter that we wrote to express our love, with trembling hands, is met with soul-crushing rejection?

Brazil asked a different question. Not what if we fail, but, so what if we do?

For generations, they played football as though failure was an acceptable price for beauty. They taught us that life need not be negotiated in binaries of victory and defeat. Lose, if you must, but lose on your terms. Brazil's greatest export was not the footballers, but the spirit of *foie de vivre*.

For perhaps the first time in living memory, Brazil leave a World Cup having surrendered not merely a match, but the very idea that made the world fall in love with them. They were timid. Predictable. Forgettable.

The magic is waning.

And yet, four years from now, another June will arrive. Another father will climb onto a porch to fasten a Brazil flag. Another child will be curious to hear stories about Neymar. Not what he won — of which there is very little — but his rainbow flicks. The rabonas. The paradinhas. The elásticos. The flashiness. The dancing feet that made millions fall in love with the team representing a nation they would never visit.

That is Brazil's true inheritance. Not the five stars stitched on the shirt, but a brand of football so unapologetically different that we grew up believing nobody else had the right to play football that way.

The writer is deputy copy editor, The Indian Express. shuvaditya.bose@expressindia.com

LETTERS To The Editor

Apply law equally

SHIV SENA leaders and cadres have a history of taking the law into their own hands. Their corporator, Ramesh Mhatre, followed that practice ('Don't let the rowdy politician get away', *IE*, July 10). No one gave him the right to assault two doctors. No public official should be above the law. The authorities must conduct an impartial investigation and ensure that justice is served in accordance with the law. The doctors' association is right in seeking stronger legal protection against violence in hospitals.

Bal Govind, Noida

THE ARREST of Ramesh Mhatre is a welcome first step. But let us be honest: One arrest does not fix a systemic problem ('Don't let the rowdy politician get away', *IE*, July 10). When a politician attacks a doctor or a government official, it is not just an assault; it is a display of power over the public. The real test now is whether the law will be allowed to take its course without political interference.

Ananya Mishra, Kanpur

Safeguard diaspora

THE RECENT multinational operation against crime syndicates is good news ('A global crackdown and a chance for India', *IE*, July 10), but we must not waste this momentum. India should focus on breaking the local links that feed these global networks — tightening financial trails, countering the glorification of gangsters on social media, and protecting vulnerable students who get trapped as pawns. Canada's new willingness to cooperate is welcome, but we also need stronger domestic systems: a dedicated cell to safeguard our diaspora, faster extradition processes, and awareness campaigns in states like Punjab, where young people are often lured by false promises.

Babu Crishna, Bengaluru



SHUVADITYA BOSE

KOLKATA IS doing its best annual impersonation of Venice. The man has waited for the rain to relent. It doesn't. He steps out anyway. The antiquated raincoat is perfectly at home with the city's anachronism. With the obeisance of a pallbearer performing one final duty, he unties the knots. The flag — hoisted with pride four weeks ago — feels heavier than usual, drenched as much by monsoon as by another unrealised dream. The quadrennial tradition reaches its melancholy conclusion. Brazil are out of the FIFA World Cup.

Nearly a thousand miles away, I find my-



EXPRESSspecial

Crackdown on cybercrime: Rs 25,000 cr saved, Rs 323 cr refunded, e-Zero FIR rolled out

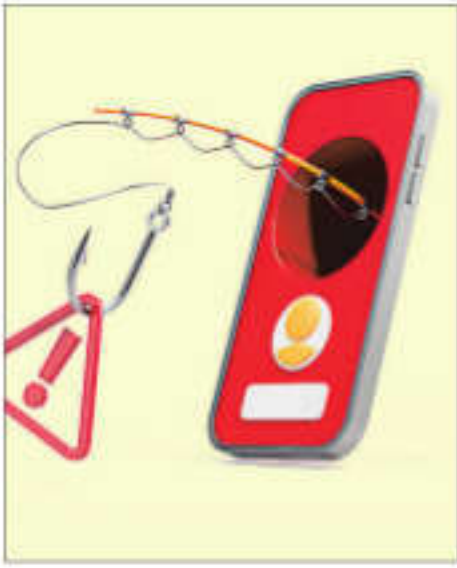
2.75 lakh URLs, 233 apps, 3,691 websites blocked in 5 years, MHA officials brief PM

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, July 10

CYBERFRAUD PREVENTION worth more than Rs 25,000 crore, a money restoration module to give refunds to victims and the rollout of an e-Zero FIR initiative were among the key points presented for the first time before Prime Minister Narendra Modi during his meeting with the secretaries of Central ministries last week, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

At the meeting, which lasted around four hours, PM Modi was informed that the union Ministry of Home Affairs had launched a new e-Zero FIR system last year. Under this system, cyber financial crime complaints lodged through the National Cybercrime Reporting Portal or the cyberhelpline number 1930 are automatically converted into e-Zero FIRs if the reported loss exceeds Rs 10 lakh.

India recorded 98 lakh cybercrime complaints between



GETTY IMAGES

August 2019 and May 2026, while only 2.3 lakh FIRs were registered during the same period. This translates into an FIR conversion rate of 2.36%.

Currently, the e-Zero FIR initiative has been launched in Delhi, Haryana, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Goa, Chandigarh, West Bengal, Rajasthan and Assam. "PM Modi was informed that the process of implementing the e-Zero FIR initiative in at least 19 more states and union Territories is underway," a source said.

This was PM Modi's second major institutional interaction with top bureaucrats in less than two months. On May 21, he chaired a joint meeting of the union Council of Ministers and Central Secretaries to develop regulatory roadmaps to realise the vision of 'Viksit Bharat'.

At the meeting, the Home

Ministry officials also briefed PM Modi that the Centre had blocked around 2.75 lakh URLs, 233 apps and 3,691 websites in the last five years for allegedly containing "material prejudicial to the sovereignty and integrity of India" under the Information Technology Act.

Between 2021 and May 2026, people reported cybercrime losses of Rs 64,447 crore. Of this, Rs 10,718 crore was frozen as lien. Only Rs 323 crore has been refunded to victims, a source said.

"Immediate interventions by the Centre have helped prevent fraud worth Rs 25,095 crore. Also, Rs 2.27 crore transactions were declined, around 12.1 lakh mule accounts were debit-frozen, and 31.6 lakh suspect identifiers were flagged with the help of the suspect registry," the source said.

The Home Ministry officials also informed the PM that 1,596 banks and financial institutions have been onboarded on the National Cybercrime Reporting Portal's Citizen Financial Cyber Frauds Reporting and Management System.

They briefed PM Modi on the ministry's plans, including setting up state and regional cybercrime coordination centres, and training police personnel to make them cyber commandos, a source said.

El Niño strengthens, could develop into strongest since 1950, says US agency

Anjali Marar
Bengaluru, July 10

THE PREVAILING El Niño in the Pacific Ocean could turn into one of the largest events in history, US-based National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) said on Thursday.

"There is an 81 per cent chance of a very strong El Niño during October-December that would rank among the largest El Niño events in the historical record, going back to 1950," NOAA said in its monthly bulletin.

El Niño and La Niña are two phases of the El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO), an ocean-atmosphere interaction. They can trigger extreme weather, droughts, and heatwaves across the globe. Over the Indian region, it can adversely affect rain. India is expected to see below-normal monsoon this year due to this. The ENSO phase and intensity of the El Niño and La Niña are decided by surface temperatures of a

E. EXPLAINED

El Niño and India

El Niño and La Niña are two phases of the El Niño Southern Oscillation, an ocean-atmosphere interaction. These events can trigger extreme weather, droughts, and heatwaves. Over the Indian region, it can adversely affect rain.

specific region of the Pacific Ocean, called the Niño 3.4 region. El Niño is declared only when the average sea surface temperature anomaly in this region surpasses 0.50°C.

The Niño 3.4 index has already crossed 1.2°C, stated the NOAA bulletin, but called it moderate. An El Niño is usually considered strong when the Niño 3.4 index crosses 1.5°C, and very strong when beyond 2°C. The strength of an El Niño phase

also depends on its duration.

The strongest recent El Niño in was in the 2015-2016 period. Termed Godzilla, it persisted for almost two years (2014 to 2016) and broke several climate records. The Niño 3.4 index had remained above 2°C Celsius for well over four months. In India, that period had the top four driest years with monsoon rains fell below 90% of normal. Other very strong El Niño phases occurred in 1991-92, 1997-98, and 1982-83.

Even though El Niño events usually mature near winter, this year it has been intensifying since April-May, said Roxy Mathew Koll, climate scientist at Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology, Pune.

"The rapid strengthening of the current El Niño appears to be linked to a combination of oceanic and atmospheric conditions. Ocean dynamics increased subsurface temperatures in the eastern Pacific... provides the heat reservoir that

can sustain and amplify surface warming.... weakened trade winds help push warm water eastward, further reinforcing... through ocean-atmosphere feedback," he said.

According to Mrutyunjay Mohapatra, director general, India Meteorological Department (IMD), strong El Niño can have a more adverse impact on rainfall. "In the past, 60 per cent of the El Niño years saw either below normal or deficient seasonal rainfall..." he said.

On July 9, IMD forecast a slightly below-normal rainfall over the country till July 22.

"With the monsoon trough shifting towards Himalayan foothills, rainfall over western India will reduce significantly," said IMD chief. Till July 22, normal rain is forecast for Rajasthan, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra, and interior parts of north Karnataka. The current El Niño event began in June and is predicted to intensify and trickle into 2027.

HC stays 2 govt notifications on diversion of funds for orphans

Press Trust of India
Shimla, July 10

THE HIMACHAL Pradesh High Court has granted an interim stay on two notifications issued by state government about diversion of a portion of Local Area Development Fund for providing financial assistance to orphans.

A division bench of Chief Justice GS Sandhawalia and Justice Bipin Chander Negi

granted the stay on Thursday on a petition filed by BJP MLA from Bharmour constituency Janak Rai.

The notifications issued on September 23, 2025, and March 18, 2026, earmarked diversion of 10 per cent and subsequently 40 per cent of the total LADF collected respectively to the Social Justice and Empowerment Department for providing assistance to orphans.

In Ayodhya, CM Yogi's latest jab at Opposition: 'Namaz offered at temple'

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, June 10

IN HIS first visit to Ayodhya since the Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the Ram Mandir 'donation' theft was set up, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath Friday launched a sharp attack on the Samajwadi Party (SP) and Congress once again, alleging that during previous governments, namaz was offered on the steps of the Hanumangarhi temple.

Addressing a public meeting in Bikanpur after inaugurating and laying the foundation stone of 217 development projects worth over Rs 432 crore, Adityanath said, "They had namaz offered on the steps of the sacred Hanumangarhi. Imagine, can anyone have the Hanuman Chalisa recited inside Jama Masjid? Can the Samajwadi Party or the Congress make that happen?"

The CM was apparently referring to claims of attempts made during the Mulayam Singh Yadav-led government in 2003 to facilitate offering of namaz near Hanumangarhi, a temple dedicated to Lord Hanuman. He did not address the temple controversy.

During his visit on June 19, before the SIT submitted its preliminary report and arrests were made, the CM had alleged that attempts were being made to cast doubts on the functioning of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra, but the SIT constituted by the UP government "would bring out the truth".

He also spoke of the city's "unprecedented transformation" under the BJP's "double-engine government". He said that Ayodhya had achieved in recent years what had been unrealised for nearly 500 years, crediting BJP government with ensuring construction of the Ram Temple and undertaking infrastructure development while preserving the city's religious and cultural identity.

Contrasting the present with what he described as the situation pre-2017, Adityanath said, "Today, Ayodhya is unlike any other place in the three worlds. It is prosperous. The chain of ghats, Ram Path, Bhakti Path, and the international airport gave Ayodhya a new identity."

He said lakhs of devotees visit the city every year and leave "overwhelmed" by its transformation. He said the Opposition was uncomfortable with these developments "because they themselves could never accomplish this".

Petitioner removed from courtroom as he shouts at judges, hurls papers

Ananthkrishnan G
New Delhi, July 10

THE SUPREME Court witnessed unruly scenes on Friday when a litigant shouted at the judges and hurled papers before security personnel removed him. The incident happened before a bench of Justices K V Viswanathan and Alok Aradhe, which decided not to initiate any action against the petitioner, Prabal Pratap.

As soon as he appeared before the bench, the judges asked, "Are you the party in person? Mr Prabal Pratap?"

Answering in the affirmative, the petitioner addressed the bench aggressively. "Mr judicial servant, I order you to order an FIR against the ACP, Vikasnagar, Lucknow."

Justice Viswanathan asked, "You are ordering me? You are ordering us?"

"That's all from my side," he continued, naming a company, alleging it was running a nationwide cybercrime syndicate.

He said, "Everything is on record in the 155 pages of the file (he was carrying), and that's all from my side."

The petitioner pulled out a bunch of papers from the file.

"These are a few papers I have," he said and flung them, shouting that they be given to the CJI. He also used expletive language.

The security personnel intervened and removed him from the courtroom to restore order.

The bench, did not take any action against him and dismissed the petition.

"When this matter was taken up, Mr Prabal Pratap, who appeared as petitioner-in-person on behalf of both petitioners in this matter, instead of presenting the case, made incoherent and unparliamentary utterances. We, however, considering the condition of the petitioner above named, do not propose to take any action against him," the bench said in its order.

"As far as the merit of this case is concerned, we have perused the records. We find no good ground to interfere with the impugned judgment/order(s). The Special Leave Petition is, accordingly, dismissed. All pending applications, including applications for permission to appear and argue in person and permission to file petition(s), shall also stand disposed of," it said.

Sources at the SC said Pratap is from Etawah, Uttar Pradesh.

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EXTENSION OF LAST DATE OF RECEIPT OF APPLICATIONS
This has reference to the Advt. No. P&A/II/16/DIR/SC/TIMST/2026 dated 11.06.2026 for recruitment to the post of Director, SCTIMST, Trivandrum. The last date of receipt of applications has now been extended to 10.08.2026 at 05.00 PM. For more details please visit our website: www.sctimst.ac.in

Sd/-, DIRECTOR

Unique Identification Authority of India
4th Floor Bangla Sahib Road, Behind Kali Mandir,
Gole Market, New Delhi - 110 001

Vacancy circular for filling up one post of Assistant Account Officer, on deputation basis (on Foreign Service terms) in Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI), Regional Office, Delhi

The Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) invites applications on deputation basis (on Foreign Service terms) for one post of Assistant Account Officer, at the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI), Regional Office, Delhi.

The application may be furnished in the prescribed proforma and forwarded to the Director (HR), Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI), Regional Office, Ground Floor, Supreme Court Metro Station, Pragati Maidan, New Delhi 110 001. The last date for receipt of applications complete in all respects is **27.07.2026**. Since this vacancy is to be filled up on deputation basis, private candidates are not eligible.

Applications received after the last date or otherwise found incomplete shall not be considered. Further details, including the terms and conditions of application procedure, are available on the Authority's website at https://uidai.gov.in/images/V_C_61_2026.pdf.
CBC-54103/11/0057/2627 **Director (HR)**

Now Aadhaar Enrolment & Update Facilities can also be availed at Aadhaar Seva Kendra (ASK). To locate one near you, visit uidai.gov.in or call 1947

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Date of Admission Test : 19.07.2026

Please Contact Between
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SHOUKAT ALI SECRETARY
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ICAR-INDIAN VETERINARY RESEARCH INSTITUTE
IZATNAGAR- 243 122

Walk-in-interview
Application are invited at ICAR-Indian Veterinary Research Institute, Izatnagar for engagement of one Senior Research Fellow (SRF) purely on temporary and contractual basis under Kisan Sarathi 2.0: Enhancement, Operations, Maintenance and Support.
Essential Qualification: Master degree in relevant subject with 4 years/ 5 years of Bachelor's Degree.
or
Candidates having Post-graduate degree in Basic Sciences with 3 years Bachelor's degree and 2 years Master's Degree should have NET qualification and 2 years of research experience.
Emoluments: Rs. 37,000.00 per month plus HRA as per specified ICAR guidelines.
Age limit: Maximum 35 years as on the date of interview. Relaxation for SC/ST/OBC/Women as per the rules.

Candidates eligible and interested for the above position are advised to report on 04th August, 2026 at 10.00 AM at ATIC Building, IVRI, Izatnagar with original testimonials along with original certificates and attend the Walk-in-Interview. No TA/DA will be paid to the candidates. For details candidates may also log on to: www.ivri.nic.in.

(Rupasi Tiwari)
Joint Director (EE) & Centre PI, Kisan Sarathi

Employees' Provident Fund Organisation
(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of INDIA)
Regional Office, Gurugram (East): Plot No.43 , Sector -44, Gurugram – 122003 (Haryana)

PUBLIC NOTICE

Whereas, NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN TO PUBLIC AT LARGE THAT the following establishments covered under the Employees' Provident Fund & Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952 has failed to remit the contribution payable under the Act in respect of employees engaged by the establishment for the period mentioned therein and inquiry under the provisions of Section 14B(Damages) & 7Q (Interest) of the EPF & MP Act, 1952 is in progress for determination of dues.

Sl. No	Establishment Code	Name of Establishment	Period of enquiry From	to	E-Proceedings Case No.	Initiated u/s	Next date of hearing
1	GNNGN2013336000	M/s Sentsortec Innovation India Private Limited	07.11.2019	13.06.2024	421/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
2	GNNGN0026062000	M/s MLS Company	07.01.2003	13.06.2024	80/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
3	GNNGN1532459000	M/s B S Hospitality	01.03.2018	13.06.2024	13/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
4	GNNGN3069649000	M/s MCO Mycompliance India Private Limited	01.06.2023	13.06.2024	92/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
5	GNNGN1746242000	M/s M R S Smart Travels	01.07.2018	13.06.2024	426/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
6	GNNGN2907726000	M/s Schnell Builders Private Limited	01.01.2022	13.06.2024	207/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
7	GNNGN147775000	M/s Food craft	07.11.2017	13.06.2024	16/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
8	GNNGN232410000	M/s Rise & Shine India	01.03.2021	16.01.2024	124/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
9	GNNGN025557000	M/s J. M.D. Ltd	03.01.2002	13.06.2024	82/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
10	GNNGN025615000	M/s SMV Asset Management Group	25.02.2020	13.06.2024	20/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
11	GNNGN148026000	M/s Manbe Enterprises	01.06.2016	29.12.2023	18/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
12	GNNGN173198000	M/s Insights Techhub International Private Limited	01.08.2018	13.06.2024	95/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
13	GNNGN2056814000	M/s Biocube Matrics Private Limited	01.12.2019	13.05.2024	200/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
14	GNNGN157971000	M/s Green Tourist Services Private Limited	01.03.2017	13.06.2024	85/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
15	GNNGN3096247000	M/s Insight Direct India Private Limited	06.10.2023	13.06.2024	93/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
16	GNNGN0033625000	M/s Eagle Hunters Facility Management Services (P) Ltd	31.01.2020	13.06.2024	22/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
17	GNNGN1947182000	M/s B Y Enterprises	25.03.2019	13.06.2024	86/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
18	GNNGN1390265000	M/s Arslan India	22.03.2022	13.06.2024	02/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
19	GNNGN286956000	M/s Ank Hotels P Ltd	01.03.2023	13.06.2024	96/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
20	GNNGN1039150000	M/s Lakelorest wines Private Limited	01.08.2014	13.05.2024	204/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
21	GNNGN1892575000	M/s Multi Touch Services	31.05.2022	13.06.2024	90/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
22	GNNGN1960231000	M/s Chikai Global Pvt Limited	01.01.2019	29.12.2023	19/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
23	GNNGN1979087000	M/s Merkletree Technologies Private Limited	01.07.2019	29.12.2023	17/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
24	GNNGN0010576000	M/s SKC Infra Tech Private Limited	22.09.1997	13.06.2024	76/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
25	GNNGN0027770000	M/s Mirror Touch Service	08.02.2016	13.06.2024	89/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
26	GNNGN1041630000	M/s Adacell Technologies Pvt Ltd	01.09.2014	13.06.2024	334/2024	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
27	GNNGN1956650000	M/s Odin System Private Limited	02.04.2019	04.08.2023	55/2023	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026
28	GNNGN2008338000	M/s Valuecoders Services LLP	03.10.2019	13.06.2024	91/2025	14B & 7Q	23.07.2026

Nobody has been appearing in the inquiry since long even after ample opportunities have been given. It is informed to all that: 1. Any person who has information about the employer / establishment and has any information about the whereabouts of employer / establishment, he should provide the same either by appearing in the processing or by post or through email on g.rurgan@epfindia.gov.in. Any person can visit the office in relation to above in person on any day before the next date of hearing and submit the written information to the Penal damage/ Compliance Account officer / Section Supervisor or the concerned Social Security assistant. 2. The employer / AR of the establishment is given a final opportunity to attend the proceedings on next date of hearing to represent the case.

In case of non appearance of establishment / stake holders / employees or non-receipt of any information from any stakeholders, further proceedings will be carried out presuming that there is no complaint against the establishment and the establishment has nothing to submit to defend the case and the case / matter shall be decided ex- parte on the basis of available records / information / deposition.

Sd/-
Apurv Gautam
Regional PF Commissioner-II
Regional office, Gurugram (East)

HC upholds Rajpal Yadav's conviction in cheque-bounce cases: 3 month jail

Press Trust of India
New Delhi July 10

THE DELHI High Court on Friday upheld actor Rajpal Yadav's conviction in cheque-bounce cases and awarded him three months' imprisonment. Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma directed Yadav to pay more than Rs 1 crore to complainant in each of the seven complaints. The judge said around Rs 2 crore already paid by Yadav shall be adjusted. It granted two months' time to Yadav to approach the appellate court against the decision.

The court's proceedings came on revision petitions filed by Yadav and his wife challenging his conviction in cheque-bounce cases in April 2018. The magisterial court sentenced him to six months' imprisonment.

On February 16, the court suspended his sentence for the time being and permitted him to be released from jail after he deposited Rs 1.5 crore in the bank.

HELPFUL. COMMITTED. Those are the words that come up as people try to describe Jaswant Singh Khalsa. They also explain why he would one day embark on a mission to trace those who disappeared during Punjab's years of militancy, only to himself disappear in September 1995.

Now, all these years later, with *Satluj*, a biopic on Khalsa, abruptly pulled off streaming service Zee5, the man has reappeared — as a reminder of what Punjab once went through as it endured militancy and the might of the State, and, as his daughter Navkiran Kaur Khalsa described in an interview to *The Indian Express*, as someone who “haunted the system” even in his death.

“When he was abducted, fake encounters and disappearances were happening across Punjab. Few questioned the police. His case changed that. For the first time, the Punjab Police found itself defending its actions before courts, the media and the international community. They probably never imagined that after so many killings, *ikk laash inni bhaari pai jungi* (one corpse would become their undoing),” said Navkiran Khalsa, now an engineer in the United States.

The withdrawal of the film has reignited a decades-old debate over how, or whether, Punjab should remember the insurgency years. For some, revisiting that period risks reopening open old wounds. For others, silence is the greater danger.

No name sits closer to that history than Khalsa's. The Amritsar-based activist spent the early 1990s doing what the State would not: counting the unclaimed dead at a time when militancy fuelled by the Khalistan movement and the establishment's fight-back meant thousands of people were killed or disappeared without a trace.

Then, on September 6, 1995, Khalsa was abducted from outside his home in Amritsar while washing his car. He was never seen again. All these decades later, his work shapes every conversation on human rights in Punjab and courts continue to hold those responsible to account, purely on the strength of the evidence he gathered.

Jas, the activist

Long before he became a symbol, he was simply “Jas” to those who knew him. Growing up with four older siblings and four younger ones in Khalsa village, in Punjab's border district of Tarn Taran, he was the one everyone turned to for errands and difficult tasks.

Born in 1952 into a family steeped in the freedom movement, public service came almost as an inheritance. His grandfather had been associated with the Ghadar movement, the early 20th-century revolutionary campaign launched by Indian expatriates to overthrow British rule, and died in Shanghai, while his father spent months in prison during the Quit India Movement. After Independence, the family established a school in the village, later taken over by the government. Though born a Sandhu, a Jat Sikh surname, Jaswant chose to call himself ‘Khalsa’, after his village, partly as a quiet rejection of Punjab's rigid caste hierarchies.

His nephew, Hamandeep Singh, who was 16 when Khalsa disappeared and now heads the Khalsa Mission Organisation in Amritsar, laughs as he recalls that his uncle simply could not refuse anyone seeking help. “I remember he once went on a fast in support of a *palledar* (labourers') union demanding better wages. It did not matter who asked for help. If he believed the cause was just, he was there.”

Growing up on revolutionary literature, Sahir Ludhianvi's songs and Satyajit Ray's films, Khalsa was fresh out of college when he revived the Naujawan Bharat Sabha, the organisation founded by Bhagat Singh in 1926. By then, he had already spent time in jail for leading the “bus *kiraya*” agitation, demanding concessional travel for students, a campaign that eventually prompted the government to introduce student bus passes.

The late 1960s were turbulent in Punjab. The Naxalite movement had begun attracting idealistic youngsters while student politics had acquired a distinctly Leftward tilt. Khalsa painstakingly documented the names of young men killed in alleged encounters, producing what friends describe as his first major human rights report in 1973.

It was activism that brought him his life partner. Rajiv Singh Randhawa, then a young activist who would go on to become one of the key witnesses in Khalsa's abduction case, recalls how Khalsa met Paramjit Kaur through her brother Gurbhajan Singh, then a student leader at Amritsar's Khalsa College.

Paramjit knew exactly the kind of man she was marrying. A librarian at Guru Nanak Dev University, she had heard enough about Khalsa's activism to know that public life would always come before personal comfort. They married in 1981 and settled in Amritsar, first in Chheharta and later, in 1994, in a modest house in Kabir Park, opposite the university so that she could simply walk to work.

All along, Khalsa stuck to his causes. When fencing along the Indo-Pak border left many farmers cut off from their land in 1986, he travelled to New Delhi seeking compensation. Randhawa, then a recent graduate drawn to Khalsa's work, accompanied him to meetings with senior officials. The Centre expressed its inability to compensate only Punjab farmers but promised to ask the state government to do so.

That ability to move effortlessly between villages, protest sites and government offices was what made Khalsa unusual.

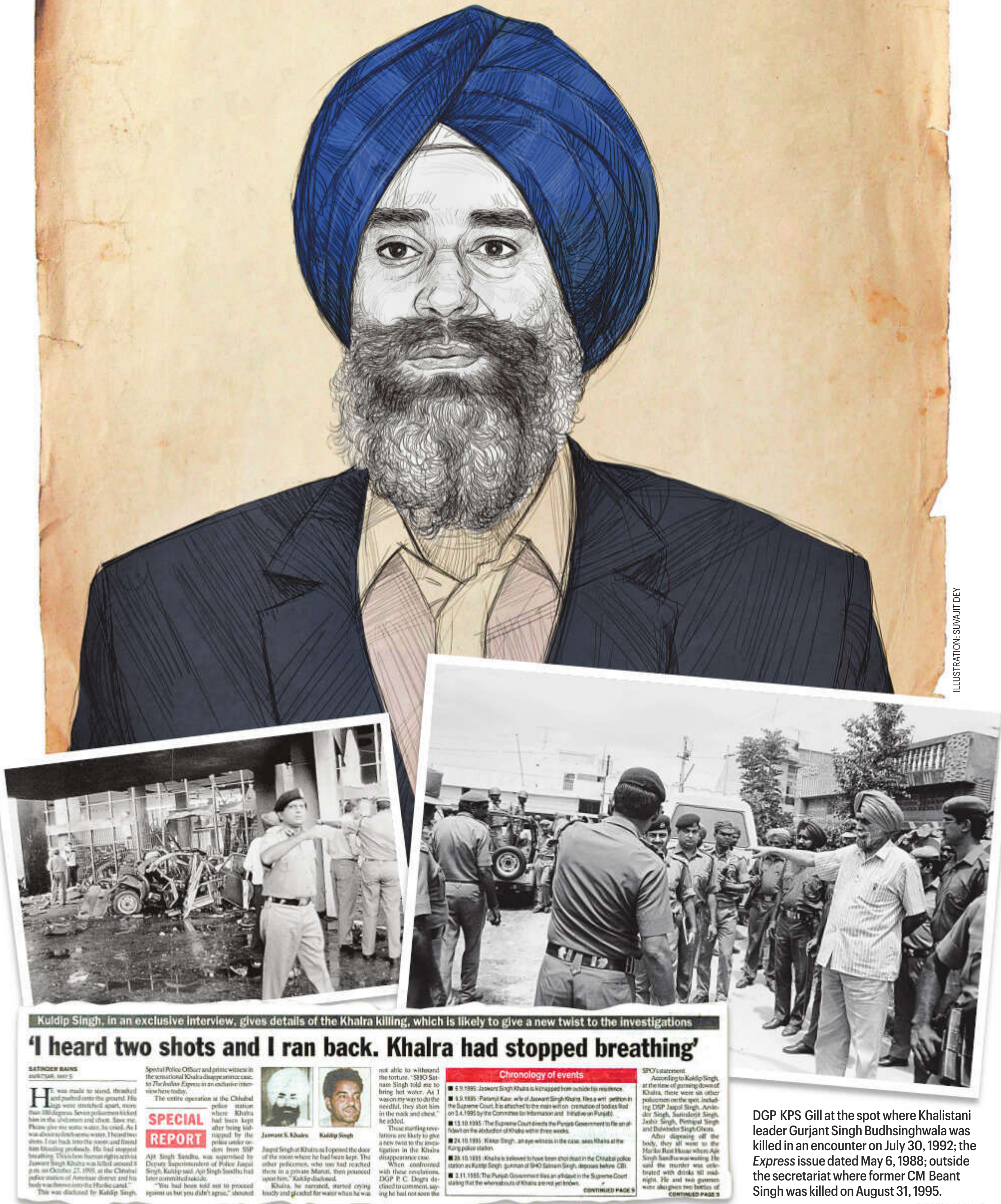
Rise of militancy in Punjab

Operation Blue Star in June 1984 changed many things for many people. For Khalsa, it would prove to define his activism. He was at his in-laws' home when the Army entered the Golden Temple in Amritsar. Curfew had paralysed Punjab, but he found a motorcycle and headed for his village.

JASWANT SINGH KHALSA

The man who counted the missing

In Punjab's dark days of militancy, when thousands of people were killed or disappeared without a trace, one man meticulously kept count. MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA traces Jaswant Singh Khalsa's journey — from a border village to his life of activism, until his disappearance in September 1995



dent. One morning in November 1994, Dhillon dropped by Khalsa's house after returning from Nepal, where he had served as an election observer. “We were discussing how meticulously the Nepalis maintained public records,” Dhillon recalls. “Suddenly, Khalsa said, ‘Let’s see what records our own institutions keep.’” The two drove to the Durgiana Mandir cremation ground in Amritsar. Posing as officials, they struck up a conversation with the caretaker. While he stepped away for a glass of water, one of their companions photocopied the cremation register. What they found was chilling. Page after page recorded the cremation of “unclaimed” bodies brought in by the Punjab Police.

A month later, they visited the cremation ground at Patti. This time, they were accompanied by rights activist Ram Narayan Kumar. “The caretaker told us there were days when three bodies would be cremated together because there wasn’t enough firewood,” Dhillon recalls.

Khalsa cross-checked the registers with municipal records that documented the supply of firewood for unclaimed bodies. Together, they revealed not just the number of bodies but also the police officials who had brought them for cremation.

On January 1995, Khalsa released a press note that named people, cited dates, and produced the paper trail of firewood purchase registers, municipal logbooks and cremation-ground records. His central claim: that between 1984 and 1994, Punjab Police had secretly cremated over 2,000 bodies as “unidentified” or “unclaimed” across just three Amritsar district crematoriums of Durgiana Mandir, Tarn Taran and Patti. The Central Bureau of Investigation would later confirm his findings.

When Khalsa first called the press conference, policemen allegedly barged in and seized his notes. Undeterred, the group travelled to Chandigarh and addressed the media there instead.

Their first public interest petition before the Punjab and Haryana High Court failed. The court questioned their locus standi. They regrouped. A fresh petition reached the Supreme Court through lawyer couple Ashok Aggarwal and Nithya Ramakrishnan, along with Ram Narayan Kumar and filmmaker Tapan Bose of the Committee for Information and Initiative on Punjab. This time, the court agreed to hear them.

As Khalsa's work gained attention, so did the hostility towards him. Ajit Singh Sandhu, then Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP) of Tarn Taran, frequently slammed him and his allegations in public. Khalsa replied with equal force.

A long fight for justice

On the morning of September 6, 1995, soon after his daughter Navkiran and son Janmeet had left for school, Khalsa was outside his Kabir Park home, washing his white Tata Mobile. Inside, Randhawa was waiting for *The Indian Express's* reporter Mandeep Singh to turn up for an interview. A blue Maruti van pulled up and men in plain clothes jumped out. “I ran outside when I heard the commotion,” Randhawa recalls. “By then, they had bundled Bhaaji into the van.”

He and Paramjit rushed from one police station to another. No one admitted having him. Two days later, the police filed an FIR that said militants dressed in civilian clothes had abducted him. “I knew then that he was in grave danger,” Randhawa says.

When Dhillon heard the news, he drove straight to Amritsar, where DIG, Border Range, D R Bhatti told him to speak to SSP Sandhu. Dhillon tracked Sandhu down to his Chandigarh residence. “There, I told him, ‘If you’re angry with us, we can resolve it. Just return our man,’” Sandhu, he says, denied any knowledge. When Dhillon persisted, Sandhu lost his temper. “*Oh hatda hinhahnsi* (He simply wouldn’t stop),” I left, saying, “I will extract him from your bones.”

Dhillon then turned to SGPC president Gurcharan Singh Tohra, who secured him a meeting with Chief Minister Harcharan Singh Brar. According to Dhillon, when Tohra asked about Khalsa, the Chief Minister quietly replied, “Pradhanji, you are too late. The damage has been done.”

For Paramjit Kaur, the days that followed blurred into a desperate search as she knocked on the doors of several politicians.

Months later came the breakthrough. One evening in May 1996, *The Indian Express's* correspondent, Satinder Bains, answered a knock on his door. A policeman, Kuldeep Singh, had come with a Punjabi journalist. He said he could no longer live with what he had witnessed. Kuldeep claimed he had seen Khalsa being tortured and killed and had driven the vehicle used to dispose of his body near Harike, about 40 km southwest of Amritsar. He later repeated those allegations before the CBI court. *The Indian Express* reported the story on May 6.

The case had changed forever. It was no longer only about an abduction. It had become a murder investigation. Kuldeep Singh was later found dead near his village. His murder was never solved.

Years of legal battles followed. The Supreme Court ordered a CBI investigation following telegrams by Paramjit and SGPC president Tohra in September 1995. The probe concluded that Khalsa had been abducted by personnel of the Punjab Police, murdered, and his body disposed of. Though his remains were never recovered, the investigation led to the prosecution of several police officers. In 1997, SSP Sandhu committed suicide while out on parole. In 2011, the Supreme Court upheld life imprisonment for five policemen.

His wife Paramjit Kaur and their children live in the quiet knowledge that the registers Khalsa unearthed continue to stir the nation's conscience, ensuring that the thousands who disappeared anonymously did not vanish from history.

ILLUSTRATION: SUVAJIT DEY

EXPRESS ARCHIVE

“There were rumours that Pakistan would attack, and he was worried about his parents,” Paramjit said in an earlier interview.

The violence that followed transformed Punjab, with the state becoming a war zone. As civil liberties groups and fact-finding teams descended on the state, Khalsa became their go-to guide. Justice V M Tarkunde, founding president of People's Union for Civil Liberties who conducted a fact-finding mission on state excesses, took him through villages around Amritsar to document testimonies. Khalsa also began writing extensively for the Kolkata-based *Frontier* on the lives of ordinary people caught between militants and the police.

The militancy strengthened Khalsa's belief that violence could never be justified. When Hindu passengers were pulled off a bus and killed by militants in 1986, Khalsa went on a hunger strike in protest. “He believed militants had no right to take innocent lives,” recalls Randhawa.

Veteran Punjabi journalist Mota Singh remembers him arriving at newspaper offices, carrying press releases. “Almost every journalist knew him,” he recalls. “With his trademark dark blue turban and that smile, he made friends wherever he went.”

By 1994, his life appeared settled. His

brothers had established themselves abroad. His sisters were doing well. He had been elected a director of the Amritsar Central Cooperative Bank. His new home in Amritsar's Kabir Park overlooked Guru Nanak Dev University, where Paramjit continued working as a librarian.

It should have been the beginning of a quieter life. Instead, it would mark the beginning of a mission.

A series of disappearances

By the early 1990s, under Director General of Police KPS Gill, whose “bullet for bullet” strategy was widely credited with breaking the back of militancy, Punjab had all but quashed the insurgency. But the victory was accompanied by mounting allegations.

Randhawa talks about a woman named Kanso, who would stand outside the police station at Chahal near Amritsar every day, hurling abuses at policemen. Her husband and three sons had all been killed in fake encounters. “We visited her house,” Randhawa recalls. “It was in ruins. *Bhaaji* (brother, as he called Khalsa) came back saying, ‘We have to do something.’”

Then, tragedy struck closer home. Piara Singh, a fellow director of the Amritsar Central Cooperative Bank, disappeared without

a trace in 1992. “He belonged to a prosperous family,” says Randhawa. Khalsa kept going to the local police station and asking the officer, “*Ki assi bhog pa daiye* (Should the family perform his last rites)?” There was no response. Soon, Khalsa would begin searching for those answers himself. He began counting the dead.

It was around this time that Khalsa met Jaspal Singh Dhillon, chairman of the Punjab Human Rights Organisation, in Chandigarh. Human rights activists were themselves under siege — Justice Ajit Singh Bains and Col Partap Singh were arrested in 1992.

A small group took shape: Khalsa, Dhillon, Amrik Singh Muksar, a social activist, lawyers Navkiran Singh and Baljinder Sodhi, and a rights activist from Andhra Pradesh, Ram Narayan Kumar. They were united by a single question. “*Hun ki kariye* (What do we do now)?”

To give themselves some political cover, they persuaded the Shiromani Akali Dal, then the main Opposition party, to set up a Human Rights Wing. Dhillon became its chairman and Khalsa its general secretary. The title mattered less than the space it created to investigate what few dared even whisper about.

The breakthrough came almost by acci-

Kuldip Singh, in an exclusive interview, gives details of the Khalsa killing, which is likely to give a new twist to the investigations

'I heard two shots and I ran back. Khalsa had stopped breathing'

SATINDER BAINS

Amritsar, July 5

He was made to stand, headfirst and pushed onto the ground. His legs were stretched apart, more than 180 degrees. Seven policemen kicked him in the abdomen and chest. Some ran. Some gave me some water. He cried. As I was about to drink some water, I heard two shots. I ran back into the room and found him bleeding profusely. He had stopped breathing. This is how human rights activist Jaswant Singh Khalsa was killed around 8 pm on October 27, 1995, at the Chahal police station in Amritsar district and his body was thrown into the Beas canal.

This was disclosed by Kuldip Singh.

SPECIAL REPORT

The entire operation in the Chahal police station where Khalsa had been kept after being tortured by the police under orders from SSP

Ajit Singh Sandhu, was supervised by Deputy Superintendent of Police Jaspal Singh Kuldip Singh. Kuldip Singh, then posted as SSP, P. C. Dagar, declined to comment, saying he had not seen the

Jaswant S. Khalsa

Kuldip Singh

Jaspal Singh at Khalsa's house exposed the door of the room where he had been kept. The other policemen, who had reached there in a private Maruti, then pointed weapons, "Kuldip Singh said.

Khalsa, he narrated, started crying loudly and pleaded for water which he was

not able to withstand the torture. "SPD Jaswant Singh told me to bring hot water. As I was trying to do the needful, they shot him in the neck and chest," he added.

Those startling revelations are likely to give a new twist to the investigation in the Khalsa disappearance case.

When confronted with these revelations, DGP P. C. Dagar declined to comment, saying he had not seen the

Chronology of events

■ 6.9.1995: Jaswant Singh Khalsa is kidnapped from outside his residence.

■ 6.9.1995: Paramjit Kaur, wife of Jaswant Singh Khalsa, files a writ petition in the Supreme Court. It is attached to the main writ on cremation of bodies filed on 3.4.1995 by the Committee for Information and Initiative on Punjab.

■ 10.10.1995: The Supreme Court directs the Punjab Government to file an affidavit on the abduction of Khalsa within three weeks.

■ 24.10.1995: Khalsa Singh, an eye witness in the case, sees Khalsa at the Punjab police station.

■ 24.10.1995: Khalsa is believed to have been shot dead in the Chahal police station as Kuldip Singh, gunman of SPD Jaswant Singh, departs before CBI.

■ 2.11.1995: The Punjab Government files an affidavit in the Supreme Court stating that the whereabouts of Khalsa are not yet known.

SPO statement

According to Kuldip Singh, at the time of getting down of Khalsa, there were six other policemen on the spot including DSP Jaspal Singh, Anwarul Singh, Satinder Singh, Jaspal Singh, Prakash Singh and Bhinder Singh Chahal.

After getting off the bus, they all went to the Harbaj Road Bazaar where Ajit Singh had been waiting. He said the number was celebrated with drinks and music. He and two gunmen were assigned two bottles of

Continued Page 5

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

HEALTH

Why weekly diabetes shot could reshape treatment



ANONNA DUTT

DANISH PHARMACEUTICAL giant Novo Nordisk Thursday launched its once-a-week insulin shot in India that promises to make blood sugar control more convenient in one of the world's largest diabetes populations. Called icodect, the drug will be sold under the brand name Awikli ("a weekly") for just Rs 261 per week. This is the world's first long-acting insulin shot that reduces injections from 365 days a year to 52 days.

How does it work?

For long-lasting effects, two key modifications were made to human insulin to develop insulin icodect.

FIRST, a fatty acid chain was added to increase its affinity to a protein in the blood called albumin. When a week's dose of insulin is delivered under the skin, this bonding with albumin creates an inactive depot of the drug. This bond is reversible and the drug is slowly released into the bloodstream throughout the week.

SECOND, three amino acid substitutions were made to lower the molecule's affinity to insulin receptors. Even after the molecule gets out of the albumin bond, the reduced affinity for insulin receptors means the drug gets used slowly. The reduced affinity does not reduce the potency of the drug.

"The impact of this drug is similar to that of any other insulin. The advantage for the patients, however, is that it would reduce the number of shots they have to take. This is likely to improve compliance as well," said Dr SV Madhu, professor of endocrinology at GTB Hospital, New Delhi.

Is icodect different from insulin?

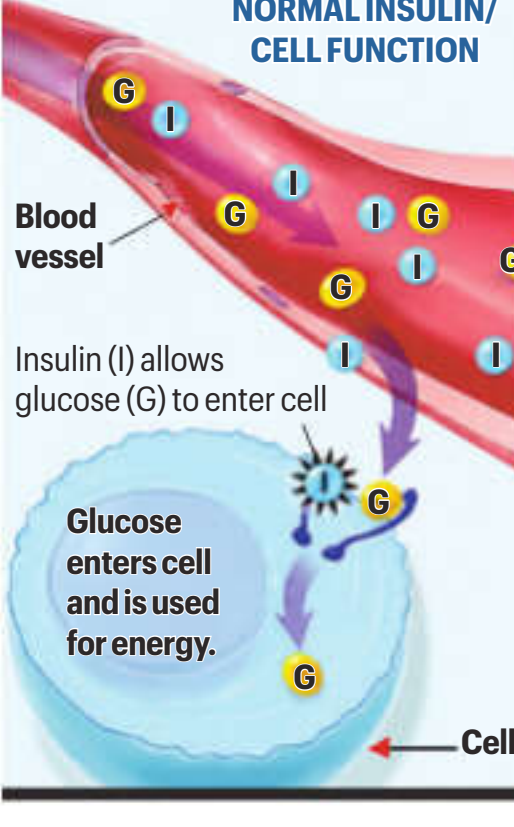
Icodect is an insulin analogue — a genetically engineered version of human insulin — that increases its life within the body.

Before the discovery of insulin in 1921, a childhood diabetes diagnosis was fatal. Physicians prescribed starvation treatment — low-calorie diets with periods of fasting. "Patients with T1D [type 1 diabetes] were often kept in hospital for weeks or months at a time, while their calorie intake and glucose excretion were meticulously recorded," ac-

HOW DIABETES TYPES 1 AND 2 AFFECT THE BODY

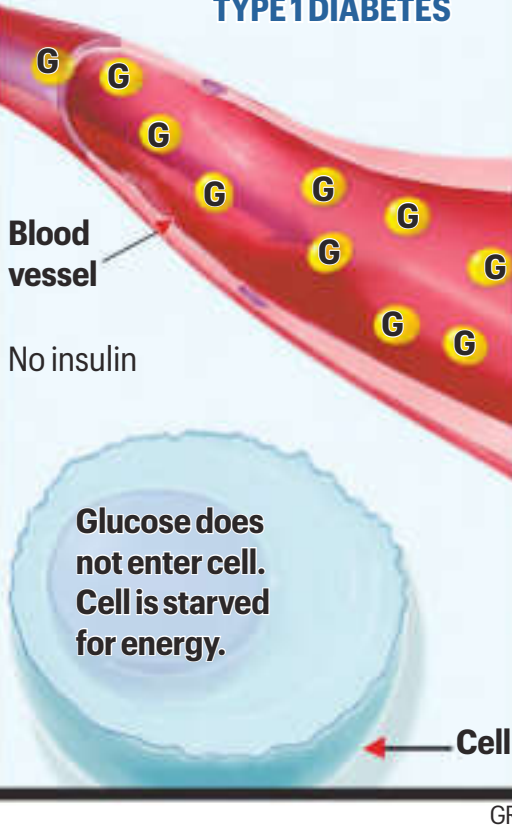
TYPE 1 DIABETES

A condition where the pancreas completely stops producing insulin, the hormone responsible for controlling the level of glucose in blood.



TYPE 2 DIABETES

Body's insulin production either goes down or the cells become resistant to the insulin. It accounts for more than 90% of all diabetes cases in the country.



101 million INDIANS ARE LIVING WITH DIABETES
136 million INDIANS HAVE PRE-DIABETES

GRAPHIC SOURCE: OREGON HEALTH & SCIENCE UNIVERSITY

ording to the BMJ. Initially, the insulin given to these patients came from extracts of mashed-up pig and cow pancreas. It was only in the 1960s, when the structure of insulin was discovered, that it could be manufactured. It became more widely available after recombinant technology — which can be used to alter the genetic code of a protein — was developed in the 1970s. Now, most insulin is commercially manufactured and altered to increase the duration it stays in the body or improve the way it is absorbed. Insulin icodect is one such development.

While everyone with type 1 diabetes needs insulin injections because their body does not produce the hormone, when it comes to the more common type 2, many can manage with pills. Yet, 25 to 30% of the people end up requiring insulin eventually.

Who is the drug meant for?

The drug is meant for two categories of diabetics:

FIRST, type 2 diabetics who have failed to achieve blood glucose control even with the highest doses of oral medicines

"Those living with diabetes for eight to ten years, with pills being unable to control

Weight-loss drugs

Icodect, which lowers blood glucose levels, becomes more effective when combined with GLP-1 drugs.

•

This is because abdominal obesity, which GLP-1 tackles, reduces insulin sensitivity. Meaning, more insulin is needed to process same amount of sugar.

the blood glucose levels, need to take insulin injections to prevent further complications. Yet, most of them are unwilling to switch to the shots. Initiating insulin early can prevent damage to the organs, nerve endings, and the eye," said Dr S K Wangnoo, head of endocrinology at Indraprastha Apollo Hospital, New Delhi. Even doctors show reluctance to start their patients on insulin treatments.

Dr Madhu said once patients do not meet blood glucose targets despite the maximum dose and combination of oral medications, they should immediately be moved to insulin, initially at a lower dose with oral pills before transitioning completely to insulin.

Vikrant Shrotriya, managing director of Novo Nordisk India, said: "Currently, there are six million people on insulin in India, but this number should at least be double. Insulin is a drug that is never abused and is very effective for the treatment of diabetes, yet people stay away from it. We are hoping that the convenience of using this drug would mean more and more people who are recommended insulin start using it."

SECOND, as background insulin for type 1 diabetics

Those with type 1 diabetes need a long-

acting dose known as the basal dose, along with shots around the meal times known as the bolus dose, based on how many calories they consume. "People with type 2 diabetes would be the best fit for this drug. This is because people with type 1 diabetes already need to take the three doses a day; a fourth dose doesn't add too much burden. Plus, they typically see more fluctuations in their blood glucose levels and need to adjust their insulin doses accordingly. When I put out a survey two years ago, some women reached out to me and said that they needed to adjust the dose during menstruation. This type of flexibility is not possible with a weekly dose," said Dr V Mohan, chairman of Dr Mohan's Diabetes Specialities Centre, Chennai.

What about side effects?

The most common side effect of the medicine is hypoglycemia — a condition where the blood glucose levels fall too much — that can affect one in ten people. Dr Wangnoo, however, says this is the same level as seen with other daily insulin shots.

Dr Madhu says: "The reason people notice these episodes of hypoglycemia with insulin is that blood glucose levels are controlled for the first time with it. Even pills can cause episodes of hypoglycaemia, but when blood glucose levels are through the roof, the question of hypoglycaemia does not arise."

How much does it cost?

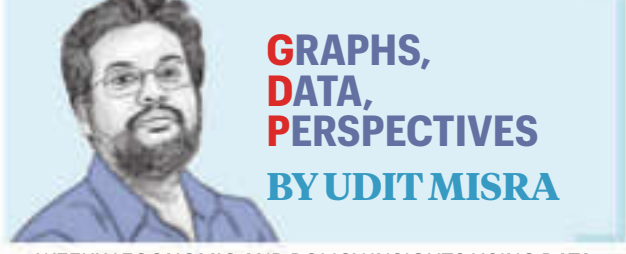
The drug will cost Rs 261 per week. It will be available in two doses of pre-filled pens — a 700 ml unit costing Rs 2,611 and a 2,100 ml unit costing Rs 7,883. A patient usually needs around 70 units per week, which may need to be scaled up depending on need. "The Rs 261 per week cost is cheaper than the current price of other insulin analogues, which can cost anywhere between Rs 345 and 453 a week. This drug will essentially cost around Rs 50 a day," said Shrotriya.

How many people in India need it?

Currently, 101 million people are living with diabetes and 136 million with pre-diabetes. "While initially most of them would be managed with pills, after five years, say, 5% to 10% would need insulin shots. And, after 10 years, maybe 20% to 30%. Even if we consider that only 20% need it, the number would still stand at around 20 million. There would definitely be more use for the drug in type 2 diabetics because of the convenience of taking one shot and cost similar to other products in the market," said Dr Mohan.

ECONOMY

June inflation may breach RBI 4% target: Transport is driving this



GRAPHS, DATA, PERSPECTIVES
BY UDIT MISRA

WEEKLY ECONOMIC AND POLICY INSIGHTS USING DATA

THE RETAIL inflation rate is set to breach the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) target level of 4%, according to an analysis by the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE). The next set of inflation data, covering June, will be released Monday.

Retail inflation fell sharply from more than 6% in October 2024 to zero in October 2025. Since then the figure has started edging up — a trend exacerbated by supply constraints in the wake of the West Asia war. Even so, retail inflation stayed below the RBI's target rate of 4% for the past 16 months. In May, the retail inflation was 3.93%. According to CMIE's estimates, the overall retail inflation in June is likely to be 4.25%.

Reasons for higher inflation

There are two main triggers for the anticipated jump in headline inflation rate,

according to CMIE.

One, is the sub-category of "transport" inflation. In the overall index used to calculate inflation, this sub-category has a weight of around 9%. According to CMIE's estimates, transport inflation, which had largely been close to zero for most of this year, is likely to have grown by 4.6% in June.

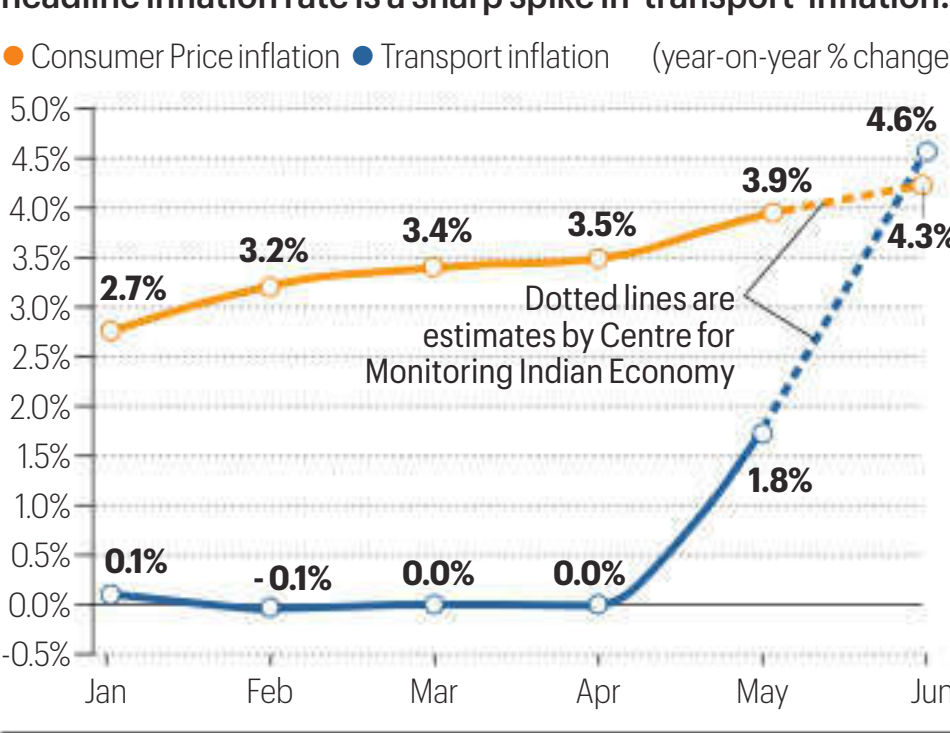
This sharp spike in transport-related inflation (see chart) in June shows the full impact of the petrol and diesel price hike that were first implemented in May.

There are other factors that have likely pushed up transport costs. "...travel fares would have continued to rise, reflecting the higher fuel costs... Maruti raised vehicle prices from June to offset rising input costs. Inflation firmed across all components of the transport division, with the fuel price hike remaining the principal driver," notes CMIE's analysis.

The second sub-category that has experienced higher inflation in June has to do with different types of fuels. The government increased domestic LPG prices in early June, marking the second hike since March. LPG prices in June averaged Rs 947 per 14.2 kg cylinder across major cities, up from Rs 923 in May. Prices have cumulatively in-

A key inflation trigger: Transport

Among the main triggers for the anticipated jump in the headline inflation rate is a sharp spike in 'transport' inflation.



creased by more than Rs 80 since March.

"Higher LPG prices are also expected to have lifted the cost of substitute fuels such as firewood and dung cakes. Consequently, inflation in the electricity, gas, and other

fuels category is estimated to have risen to 1.9 per cent from 0.8 per cent in May," says the CMIE analysis.

Impact on growth

Higher inflation is bad news for economic growth. Fast-rising prices drag down the real economic growth rate because they reduce a consumer's power to purchase goods and services with the same level of income. Things get worse when the RBI's policy action is taken into consideration. At 4.25%, retail inflation would still be within the RBI's comfort band of 2% to 6%. If it stays within this zone, the RBI is unlikely to sharply calibrate its monetary policy.

But if inflation goes above 6%, for instance, the RBI will need to raise interest rates in the economy. This makes all kinds of loans costlier and, thus, makes it expensive for anyone to undertake any economic activity. Reduced economic activity reduces demand for goods and services in the economy, thereby cooling down price rise.

Given the renewed hostilities between US and Iran, the RBI will likely be cautious in the coming months if inflation keeps inching up. If the trend sustains, expect it to hike rates at some point during the year.

LEGAL

Behind Satluj takedown, the parallel regimes for theatrical and OTT releases

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, July 10

AFTER BEING stuck for nearly three years over certification issues, the movie *Satluj*, based on the life of rights activist Jaswant Singh Khalsa, premiered on ZEE5 on July 3. Just two days later, however, it was taken off the platform. While the film remains available internationally on ZEE5 Global, it is unavailable in India "until further notice".

Government sources have cited "security concerns" over the film. An Inter-Departmental Committee, constituted by the government under the Information Technology Rules 2021, is set to take up the matter.

The takedown of a film that was never allowed a theatrical release has put the spotlight on the parallel regulatory regimes in India — the Cinematograph Act for theatrical releases and the Information Technology (IT) Rules, 2021 for streaming platforms.

Why was *Satluj* banned?

The film chronicles Khalsa, the Amrit-

sar-based activist, who investigated the alleged illegal cremation of "thousands of unidentified bodies" by police during Punjab's militancy years. He was abducted and killed in 1995, a case in which several police officials were convicted.

The project, originally titled *Ghullughara*, changed its name to *Punjab '95* after the first round of scrutiny by the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC). The CBFC sought 127 cuts before it would clear a theatrical release, which the makers refused.

The film, therefore, never reached the cinemas and eventually landed on the over-the-top (OTT) platform — without the cuts — under the name *Satluj*. Parallely, the makers challenged the CBFC's objections before the Bombay High Court in 2023, but later withdrew the petition.

How does CBFC certification work?

Theatre releases are governed by the Cinematograph Act, 1952. Under Section 4 of the Act, any person wishing to exhibit a film publicly must apply to the CBFC, a statutory

body under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. Screening uncertified films in a cinema is a criminal offence.

The CBFC certifies films into categories: U (unrestricted); UA (unrestricted with parental guidance); A (adults only), and S (restricted to specialised audiences).

The Cinematograph (Amendment) Act, 2023, further split the UA category into age-based sub-categories and made certificates perpetually valid, removing the earlier 10-year limit. The Act also empowers the board to refuse certifications or to grant them subject to excisions and modifications if a film is against the interests of the sovereignty and integrity of India; the security of the state; friendly relations with foreign states; public order, decency or morality; or involves defamation or contempt of court. These are the "reasonable restrictions" on free speech under Article 19(2) of the Constitution.

Filmmakers have long criticised the wide discretion given to the examining and revising committee within the CBFC. Until 2021,

a filmmaker, by a CBFC order in the form of a refusal or grant of a certificate or demands of cuts, could appeal to a dedicated tribunal under the act. A tribunal rationalisation reform abolished FCAT, transferring its functions to the High Courts, which is a slow and expensive process for time-sensitive releases. Critics also say that judges may lack the specialised engagement with cinema that a specialised tribunal would bring.

This is perhaps why the makers of *Satluj* withdrew the plea before the Bombay High Court and turned to streaming services where the CBFC has no jurisdiction.

How are OTT platforms regulated?

OTT platforms typically operated with minimal oversight. But as their influence and reach grow, the government has made attempts to regulate these platforms.

In 2019, the Karnataka High Court dismissed a writ petition seeking the regulation of content on OTT platforms also under the Cinematograph Act. The HC reiterated the distinction between public exhibition

of films, which is governed under the Cinematograph Act, to a private viewing of content on an OTT platform by individuals in the privacy of their personal spaces.

The government had also opposed the plea, arguing that the provisions of the IT Act take care of the apprehensions expressed by the petitioner.

OTT content is regulated under part III of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, which prescribe a code of ethics requiring publishers to exercise caution over content that may fall under the grounds for "reasonable restrictions" mentioned above.

The rules set up a three-tier grievance structure — self-regulation by the publisher, self-regulatory bodies and government oversight through the Information and Broadcasting Ministry. This framework is also under challenge. The Bombay and Madras High Courts have stayed this provision.

In the 2023 Broadcasting Services (Regulation) Bill, which was subsequently withdrawn, the government attempted to

define OTT platforms as a broadcasting service to bring them under its ambit.

In the case of *Satluj*'s takedown, the government has reportedly used its powers under Section 69A of the IT Act.

What is Section 69A?

Section 69A involves the power to issue orders to block content. These orders are issued under the Information Technology (Procedure and Safeguards for Blocking Access of Information by Public) Rules, 2009. The government must record the reasons for blocking in writing, and then a designated review committee examines these directions and can set aside orders if they do not comply with Section 69A.

The Information & Broadcasting Ministry has formed an Inter-Departmental Committee under Rule 14 of the IT Rules to look into *Satluj*'s content and make recommendations to the government. It can recommend warnings, an apology or disclaimer, reclassification or modification of content, or deletion and blocking under Section 69A.

‘In Andhra, Namo means Naidu ji and Modi ji ki jodi’



TASHI TOBGYAL

(Right) Nara Lokesh, National Working President, TDP, and Minister for Human Resources Development, IT Electronics & Communication and Real-time Governance, Government of Andhra Pradesh, with Vandita Mishra, National Opinion Editor, *The Indian Express*

You are the minister of HRD, IT and real-time governance. What is a minister of real-time governance? There is no such minister in any other state.

In Andhra Pradesh, we have started collecting data sets from across ministries and integrating them into one department to take decisions. Now, our Chief Minister, Chandrababu Naidu, has taken it one step further, where it is about the ease of living because the intersection of a citizen and the government has friction. The idea is to use technology to eliminate that friction. For example, we bring each and every government service onto a single WhatsApp number. Almost 1,000 services are available to citizens today.

Of your three portfolios, what takes up most of your time?

Honestly, everything. But what I'm most passionate about is education. Apart from the fact that I love kids, I truly believe real change can happen through education. For example, we all talk about gender parity. When I became minister, I asked my department why first- and second-grade textbooks had photos of only women doing household chores. If that is the stereotype we are teaching a child, what change are we going to bring when they are in college or join work? So we changed that. We said household chores — 50 per cent men, 50 per cent women. It might seem trivial but it's the power of value-based education.

The NEET re-test took place recently. This was an issue that touched not just students but entire families. When the NEET leak happened, did you speak to the education minister at the Centre? Did you give suggestions? What were your takeaways?

Should further reforms happen in testing? Absolutely. All of us accept that. As a State we have our own APSET and other examinations. Andhra has moved to computer-based testing. I want to go further and say exams shouldn't happen only once a year. When children are aspiring for higher education, one bad day can destroy their career for a year. In my department I tell everyone: Think from your child's perspective. I have an 11-year-old boy. When I look at reforms, I put him at the centre.

Regional parties seem to be falling like ninepins. Your grandfather NT Rama Rao brought regional parties together to challenge Congress dominance. Today, your party is crucially holding up BJP dominance. From inside the ruling coalition, how do you look at the implosion of regional parties?

As a regional party, we should stand for our ideology and our cadre. Parties that have lost their ideology after winning elections have faced challenges multiple times. The TDP has won and lost elections but after 44 years, we stand strong. Our support to the NDA has been unconditional because our leader and the Telugu Desam fundamentally believe India needs stable leadership. We walked back into NDA in 2024 unconditionally. But on policies, do we have opinions? Absolutely.

Nara Lokesh on real-time governance, delimitation, TDP's voice within the NDA and the potential benefits of bringing data centres to the state. He was in conversation with Vandita Mishra, National Opinion Editor, *The Indian Express*



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DATA IS THE NEW OIL AND DATA CENTRES ARE THE NEW REFINERIES. THE QUICKER WE ACCEPT THIS, THE CLOSER WE ARE TO REALITY

You say you voice your opinion within the four walls of the coalition. But the coalition arrangement has changed from the time your father lent outside support to the AB Vajpayee government. At that time, there were coordination mechanisms, institutionalised ways of interaction with allies. Today, there are no such mechanisms. The interaction is leader-centric, one-on-one with parties, which puts regional allies at a disadvantage.

I disagree. Whenever we have wanted reforms in sectors that are in the interest of the State, our opinion has been heard and things have changed.

If I have an issue, I pick up the phone, call the minister concerned. Either they answer or call back within the hour. That's how we work.

In your own trajectory, there have been 'aha' moments. You have spoken about entering a room full of 5,000 people when you were 20-21 and seeing everybody clap for your father when he was out of power. That made you want to join politics. But the moment you talk about most is your padyatra. You are interested in AI hubs, quantum computing and digital governance, how does the padyatra sit with them?

I have always chosen the road less travelled. I contested from a constituency

my party had not won since 1985. I lost in 2019. For five years, I didn't leave my constituency and won with a 91,000 majority, the third-highest in Andhra's history. I chose HRD. Not many people choose education, but I was passionate about it.

The *padyatra* helped me understand people. Earlier, when an MLA came and explained an issue to me, my ability to connect with it was limited. After the *padyatra*, because I walked in that constituency, heard people and spent nights there, my ability to relate to issues became much stronger. The IQ bit I got from Stanford. The EQ bit I got from the *padyatra*. It taught me that if an issue comes to me through WhatsApp or any mechanism, it has already boiled over. My response has to be much faster. Whenever I feel tired after sitting in an AC room all day doing presentations, I look back and say I have no reason to be tired. I walked. There were days when I walked 24 km in the Andhra heat. That connection is what the *padyatra* created.

During the padyatra, you held up a little red book, in which you said you had names of police officials, YSRCP leaders and administrators who allegedly committed excesses against TDP and its cadre. Recently, there were custodial deaths and the Opposition has said this is an example of red book governance, vendetta politics. You are young, why carry this bitterness with you?

I have no bitterness. I was born soon after NTR ji became Chief Minister. I have seen how cadre works, how offices work, how IPS officers work. Between 2019 and 2024, I saw an institutional collapse. They forced 23 cases against me, including an attempted murder case and an SC/ST atrocities case. If I don't put a stop to this and don't take people to task who broke the law, where is the end? Isn't that why we are elected — to uphold the Constitution? Between 2019 and 2024, there were days when Mr Naidu was not allowed to leave his house because police tied ropes to his gate. Today, Jagan is travelling wherever he wants. Was there a custodial death? Yes. We have taken action. There is a murder case against the person responsible and he will face the law. Did Jagan do the same when he was in power? No. When our cadre was killed, there was no action.

You are the face of Andhra Pradesh's investment push. You brought Google, which has committed one of

its largest investments outside the US. But there are questions around land acquisition, environment, energy and water requirements of data centres and subsidies.

Data is the new oil and data centres are the new refineries. The quicker we accept this, the closer we are to reality. All our phones are powered by data centres. Do we stop using them? The question is: Will data centres alone create jobs? Data centres are catalysts but it is not just about attracting data centres. I want the entire ecosystem in Andhra. We are building it — servers, racks, power electronics, everything around it.

Between Andhra and Karnataka, the competition for investment has been edgy. Recently, a CEO tweeted about traffic jams and potholes in Bengaluru and you invited him to Andhra Pradesh, saying you would provide better infrastructure and safer cities for women. But many point out that you have an advantage because the Centre is on your side and this could deepen the industrial skew between states.

If you don't lay roads, what will the Government of India do? If you don't provide 24-hour power, if you charge industrial customers Rs 15 per unit, and I as a State say I will compete and do better, how can you blame me? The Prime Minister came up with a data centre policy that applies to India. There are no special terms and conditions only for Andhra Pradesh. When States compete, India wins. Is there an advantage of having a double-engine government? Absolutely. We have a voice at the table. In Andhra, we call it a double-engine bullet train government because in Andhra Namo means Naidu ji and Modi ji ki jodi.

At one time, Mr Naidu was seen as a prime ministerial candidate. Nitish Kumar, too, was seen as someone who could lead at the Centre. Today, both are under the Modi umbrella in the NDA. Does the 'Namo' image also evoke a sense of loss?

If Naidu ji wanted to be PM, he would have become during the United Front period. He was offered the post twice, he chose not to take it. His agenda was his State. Today, our work is cut out in Andhra Pradesh. Naidu ji played an important role in telecom deregulation and public-private partnerships in airports. He was a catalyst because he wanted to build a greenfield private airport in Hyderabad. That is how

THE ONLY CHALLENGE FOR A REGIONAL PARTY IS COMPLACENCY



I GOT THE IQ FROM STANFORD AND THE EQ FROM PADYATRA



WHEN STATES COMPETE, INDIA WINS

GMR built a world-class airport. Today, we are doing the same with data centres and other policies. But Mr Naidu never aspired for higher office.

In your family, there are two models of governance. NTR laid the foundations of the social welfare model — Rs 2 rice, property rights for women. Your father became identified with the IT revolution, building Hyderabad as a global hub. How do you balance the two?

Both go hand in hand. If you look at agriculture in the West, it is highly subsidised by governments. The farmer is protected. Here, we say farmers should not be given anything. I disagree with that. But we also have to invest in education, healthcare, infrastructure and lower-cost energy. Governments have to find that balance.

On delimitation, Chandrababu Naidu supported the government's proposal. But concerns have been raised that southern states may be at a disadvantage even if the ratio is maintained.

Article 81 says the number of seats will not increase and based on the 2026 Census, delimitation will happen. The Amendment was meant to safeguard southern states. Today, we are 1.5 billion people. Some Assembly constituencies have close to 3,00,000 voters. Even Pranab Mukherjee ji said India needs around 1,000 MPs to effectively represent such a large population. But the proportion of distribution has to be maintained.

Andhra Pradesh is considering a law for a social media ban for those under 13 and age-appropriate content between 13 and 16 years.

We have held consultations with all platforms. According to their own terms, children under 13 are not allowed on platforms. But children find ways around it. As parents, we want safeguards. We need a framework to regulate content. It is challenging for a State because of boundaries, VPNs and platform cooperation. We are working with Ashwini Vaishnav ji to see how this can be done nationally.

Many Andhra students and professionals are vulnerable to changing US immigration policies. What are you doing for them?

We are opening new avenues. While there is a debate about three languages, we are saying if children want to learn Japanese, here is an ITI or degree college. If they want German, here is the opportunity. Learning languages opens new boundaries. The US was built on immigration. While a crisis exists, there is also an opportunity.

Does the BJP's 'one nation' idea worry you as a regional party in a federal structure?

Andhra Pradesh's Assembly and Parliament elections are already synchronised. It does put more power in the federal system but the idea that the Centre will hold back money is not the reality. BJP also understands that southern states are part of India and Bharat. The only challenge for a regional party is complacency.

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Srikanta K Panigrahi, Director General, Indian Institute of Sustainable Development



Nara Lokesh with Anant Goenka, Executive Director, The Indian Express Group



Venkata Sivarao Cherukupalli, Director (Strategic Systems), Ananth Technologies Limited



Lokesh interacting with the audience at Express Adda



Lokesh with Munagala Mohan Shyam Prasad, Chairman and Managing Director, Tenali Double Horse group



(From left) TDP MPs Chintakayala Vijay (Rajya Sabha); Daggumalla Prasada Rao (Lok Sabha); Beeda Masthan Rao (Rajya Sabha)



Akhil Chauhan, Managing Director, Starkey Laboratories India



Anil Somani, Chairman, Fostiima Business School



(From left) Dilip K Banthiya, CFO, Radico Khaitan; Sudhir Upadhyay, Chief Sales Officer, Radico Khaitan; Kunal Madan, CMO, Radico Khaitan



K P Fabian, former Indian Ambassador, author and political commentator



Prasoon M Tripathi, Director, IMS Ghaziabad



MUNAGALA MOHAN SHYAM PRASAD
CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR, TENALI DOUBLE HORSE GROUP



ANANYA MUKHERJEE
VICE CHANCELLOR, SHIV NADAR INSTITUTE OF EMINENCE

Middle-class families in Andhra Pradesh struggle to afford education for their children. What is your vision for them?

WE SHOULD build an ecosystem like the Nordic countries, where everyone is happy to send their children to government schools. I want that a day should come when government schools have to say, 'Sorry, admissions are full.' We are already seeing signs of that. In my own constituency, a parent asked me for a recommendation to get her child into a government school. I told her I couldn't interfere because the headmistress had introduced an entrance test. That kind of demand is possible only when people trust the system. Infrastructure matters, but hardware without software is useless. The operating system of a school is its teachers. We have focused on restoring teachers' pride and confidence. We are among the few states with a Teacher Transfer Act that eliminates political interference in transfers. We also celebrated government-school students who performed well. They were given a front-page newspaper advertisement without photos of the CM or any politician. Students themselves became ambassadors for their schools.



SHIKHA SALARIA
JOURNALIST, NEW INDIA ABROAD

You compared power consumption of data centres with thermal plants but they also produce electricity. Isn't comparing consumption with production unfair?

YOU'RE SAYING it is acceptable to have 1 GW of thermal power capacity, but not 1 GW of data-centre capacity. A thermal plant uses roughly seven times more water than a data centre and emits carbon, whereas our data centres will run on renewable energy. Technology is also evolving. Air-cooled data centres can dramatically reduce water use, and energy efficiency is improving every year. If we are going to reject data centres because they consume power, then we should also stop using AI tools or even our mobile phones. Interestingly, nobody questions data centres in Hyderabad, Chennai, Navi Mumbai or NCR. Yet, there seems to be a campaign specifically against investments in Vizag. More broadly, data sovereignty will become one of India's biggest strategic challenges. Countries are already restricting access to advanced AI models. If India doesn't build compute capacity, cable landing stations, renewable power and server manufacturing domestically, we will become dependent on others. Imagine, if one day India could no longer access ChatGPT or Gemini. That's why this is a strategic priority for both the Centre and the state. Our policy caps data-centre capacity at 6 GW because that's the right balance. Unlike the US, where many data centres rely on gas-fired power, we are using solar, wind, pumped-storage and battery storage through a unified national grid. That's what makes our approach fundamentally different.

Beyond attracting universities, what are the qualitative changes you are focusing on to better higher education in the State?

MY FOCUS is on research. We have adopted a model, where each cluster focuses on a specific sector — glass, space, drones, medical devices, quantum technologies and more. We have around 20-22 such clusters. We are now connecting higher education institutions with industry. Companies are setting up labs, centres of excellence, rapid prototyping and research facilities, funding academic chairs and working directly with universities. That's how we strengthen higher education. The second is governance. We now have a Commissioner of Higher Education to handle administration, allowing vice-chancellors to focus on academics. We are introducing courses in quantum computing, AI, data science, medical devices and material sciences. As new industries come up, universities must evolve. The key is integration between universities, industry and government so that education aligns with future opportunities. We are also using technology to improve outcomes. Vocational education is also a priority.



POONAM DABAS
FOUNDING TRUSTEE, CENTRE FOR MEDIA & STRATEGIC STUDIES

What are the jobs you are creating? Also, we have long spoken about India's demographic bulge becoming a demographic dividend. What has changed?

AFTER BIFURCATION, we became a long coastal state with India's second-longest coastline, so we are building a port-led economy. We have identified 22 industrial clusters, focusing on sectors such as shipbuilding, data centres, horticulture, aquaculture, quantum technologies, electronics and manufacturing. The investments we have signed are expected to generate around 25 lakh jobs over the next five to eight years. So far, we have created about 5.3-5.4 lakh jobs. Manufacturing is a major driver. Andhra Pradesh already produces 60 per cent of India's air conditioners, and we expect that to rise to 85 per cent by 2028. We are also attracting investments in wafer manufacturing, automotive, EV batteries and steel. On the services side, companies like Cognizant have already created around 3,000 jobs, while Infosys is expanding in Visakhapatnam. Agriculture remains another major focus through horticulture, sustainable aquaculture and zero-budget natural farming. On the demographic dividend, we shouldn't look at India as one homogeneous economy. There is one India with incomes comparable to middle-income countries, another that's highly aspirational, and nearly a billion people still living on less than \$1,000 per capita. That's the real challenge. Our response is targeted intervention through the P4 mission — a public-private-people partnership that helps families break out of intergenerational poverty.



Kartik Seth, Managing Partner, Chambers of Kartik Seth



Shivani Thapar, Chief Innovation Officer, Thapar Institute of Engineering and Technology

RAPID FIRE WITH ANANT GOENKA

● **With the benefit of hindsight, one mistake you think your father has made that you have learned from.**
Spend more time with my son.

● **One political heir of your generation you think has played his or her cards right.**
I'm the one.

● **One political lesson you would like to offer or like to learn from the following people:**
■ **Udhayanidhi Stalin**
Always be closing.
■ **Himanta Biswa Sarma**
I would love to get some energy from him.
■ **C. Joseph Vijay**
His ability to capture the imagination of youth through social media.

■ **Is there anything common between Tamil Nadu, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Bangladesh?**
It's important to understand the aspirations of the youth and not take them for granted.

■ **Prashant Kishore**
What I have learnt is to not take elections for granted till the last vote is pulled. One advice I would give him? Keep at it.

■ **Nishant Kumar.**
I don't know him so it will be unfair to pass a judgment.

■ **Rahul Gandhi.**
I appreciate that he walked during the padyatra. I know the kind of impact it has on a politician. My advice? That you can't just walk and forget.

■ **Abhishek Banerjee.**
I have learned that we should not steer away from the core ideology you

stand for. Advice: You can never take your electorate for granted.

● **100 years of RSS made a lot of news a few months ago. What is the one thing you think will change and one that will remain the same in the RSS for the next 100 years?**
Nation first will remain. As an institution they continue to reform themselves and bring in newer charters based on how India is going to transform.

● **The one thing young politicians should learn from Donald Trump.**

Take a private jet from Qatar then have the government spend public money and paint it and take it back after you lose an election (*laughs*). One thing you can definitely learn is creating a sense of pride for your nation.

● **In 2024, the buzz in Andhra Pradesh was that it was the most expensive state to fight an election in. Is that true? Also, as a third-generation politician, do you see this inflation rate of election financing ever stopping?**

Are elections expensive? Absolutely. This is a global phenomenon, and reforms are required. As a third-generation politician, at times, even I get disillusioned. I don't know whether I'm right or wrong that large denominations should be removed but Mr Naidu has also been saying this since 2012-13. But there is also a contrarian view that you will have to start giving gold ornaments soon. But it's also important that the electorate matures and understands who is right and who is wrong. You have one benchmark for the politician, another for the electorate. Is that fair? As a third-generation politician, it is important that we have this conversation and take it to the grassroots.

● **We have heard about a meeting that apparently happened between your father, a corporate leader and a former vice president... the story keeps popping up.**

I don't know why the story keeps repeating. And TDP always has to prove that we are with NDA. Every three-six months, I hear a story that TDP is upset and may go its own way. But there's no reason to be upset because the doors are always open. I met Modi *ji* because in that rumour Lokesh was also evidently there. And I told him the context in which I met the person. The PM laughed and said, 'Just because there is a rumour, it doesn't mean you stop meeting people. You're a politician. Go meet everyone.'

● **But the rumor was that there were two people — a former VP and a corporate leader.**
I only met one person that time.



Pritha Dutt, Chairperson, Centre For Gender Equality & Inclusive Leadership, XLRI



Preeti Reddy, Advisor (Strategy and Growth), Centre for Gender Equality & Inclusive Leadership, XLRI



Dilip Cherian, Political Campaign Advisor



Pallavi Shroff, Managing Partner, Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas



Prof J S Rajput, former Director, NCERT



R Chandra Sekhar, Publisher, Bloomsbury Publishing

“When it’s Kylian, there’s no problem, he never hesitates – even though he’d already missed a chance. Many people say that Kylian is a dictator, that he only thinks of himself. But he’s the captain and he’s exemplary.” DIDIER DESCHAMPS

Mbappe’s world

Mbappe atones for missed penalty with a rasping strike and an assist as France beat Morocco in the quarterfinals



Kylian Mbappe celebrates after scoring the opener. Ousmane Dembele (below) scored his 5th in the tournament. AP



SOMETIMES, TIME is a player’s biggest enemy. Too much time, he broods, he doubts and misses. Hard-pressed for time, the instincts take over and the muscle memory kicks in.

The tantrums of time don’t spare the most luminescent footballers in the world. In a day’s time, Lionel Messi and Kylian Mbappe both failed to beat the goalkeeper from 12 yards. Yet, with guilt gnawing like mites, time running out, legs tiring, they produced goals from more improbable directions in open play. Mbappe’s goal that soothed the French nerves and broke Morocco’s belief was a stunning blend of timing and precision, ruthlessness and opportunism. France would win 2-0 to be in the semi-final.

For his goal, Mbappe had just two seconds to decide. His back was facing the goal, but he manufactured a pocket of space for him to take a sharp U-turn, took a velcro-touch to take the ball away from the defenders, just lifted his right leg and threaded the ball through the narrow space between Issa Diop and Noussair Mazraoui.

The ball still had a lot to traverse before it beat Yassine Bounou, the guardian of Morocco’s goalpost. The ball almost brushed Diop’s shirt, the bend just sufficed; it kept swinging away, before it swerved back into the goal. Half a yard less whip, Diop’s shoulder should have rescued Morocco; a yard less swing in the final third of its journey, it would have clunked the upright. Mbappe could have a hidden protractor inside his boot, or in his brain.

But the instrument went AWOL momentarily when he took the penalty in the 22nd minute. He had too much time to think, and overthink. After Mazraoui hacked him down inside the box, the referee immediately pointed to the spot. Ousmane Dembele rolled the ball towards Mbappe. He kissed the ball, placed the ball on the spot and hurried to his run-up. The referee was still consulting with his VAR friends. Mbappe fretted, he preened and walked towards teammate Kone and whispered something in his ears. If VAR has robbed theatre out of goal celebration, it has heightened the drama in dead-ball situations. It was the wait that was killing

him. The referee confirmed it was a penalty. And Mbappe was ready to run off the block. Stop, the referee shrieked again. A couple of Moroccan men were infringing the line. Stop, he screamed again, he felt the ball had moved a bit. Three minutes and eleven seconds had lapsed from awarding the penalty to confirming it and then flicking the green light to taking it. Mbappe’s patience had worn off. He rushed towards the ball, then stopped and stuttered.

Weak stab The end product was a weak stab, the ankle withering at the exact point of contact, and the ball stuttering towards Bounou, who seconds, a goal-scorer doesn’t have time to breathe, let alone breath. After he skewed his shot and saw it saved, he went straight to the referee, perhaps complaining about the delay before the kick. But that’s the devil he would have to bear with most of his career. The VAR and the wait. He has dwelled on missed penalties before. “It’s acceptable if the goal-keeper makes a wonderful save, but not because of a poor shot. It hurts, especially if you have lost the game,” he had once said.

Mbappe wouldn’t take the split penalty to his bed because he atoned with a spectacular strike and an assist. The goal was cathartic. He flexed his muscle like a WWE wrestler, kept shouting “it is me, it is me...” and revelled all through the time the VAR dissected the replays for a foul and stopped only when the game was restarted.

Like when great players score great goals, the mood of the game altered imperceptibly. Morocco, after a regimented first-half defensive show, were just raising the offensive gear when Mbappe struck. A sense of fatalism clutched them. Ousmane Dembele’s strike, six minutes later from Mbappe’s assist, punctured all their hopes. The goalkeeper got a hand to it, but in vain. Post match, he was asked about the missed penalty. He just smiled. The smile had all the answers. It didn’t have the villain’s name. It could be the seconds ticking on the referee’s watch.

• Most goals at World Cups

NAME	NATION	GOALS	MATCHES	SPAN
L. Messi	Arg	21	31	(2006-2026)
K. Mbappe	Fra	20	20	(2018-2026)
M. Klose	Ger	16	24	(2002-2014)
Ronaldo	Bra	15	19	(1994* - 2006)
H. Kane	Eng	14	16	(2018-2026)

*RONALDO WAS PART OF THE 1994 TEAM BUT DID NOT PLAY

ond-guessed the direction of Mbappe’s shot. He kicked the turf in angst.

As with Messi, his conversion rate is not prolific by their stratospheric gold standards in other metrics (81 percent for club and country; Messi’s is 78). This was only his second miss for his country in fifteen attempts. But the most prolific goal-scorers in the world, Messi and Mbappe tied on eight goals for the golden boot, spilling as routine a piece of action is baffling. Maybe the geniuses have one option too many that they end up cluttering their sense of clarity. Maybe, they get conscious of the attention on them or the sheer fear that you could miss as simple a thing as a penalty.

Perhaps, it’s stuttery run-up style, popularised by none other than Pele, that’s the villain, where he paused to detect the goalkeeper’s imminent movement and slot the ball in the opposite direction.

Three minutes and eleven seconds are too much time to complicate your mind. In two

Tuchel needs to get back four right with Haaland looming

Sandip G
New Jersey, July 10

A FAMILIAR pack of journalists probed familiar themes to Erling Haaland who gave familiar answers in the pre-match press conference. “Should England fans stay humble?” A reminder of his famous quip at Arsenal manager Mikel Arteta two seasons ago: “Stay, humble, eh!” He replied, with a plain face and dry tone: “I think everyone should stay humble.”

Haaland has a dry sense of humour, the dryness exaggerated by the economy of emotions. Even sarcasm doesn’t invoke instant laughter, as when he said: “I think every single one of you (journalists) should put pressure on the English lads!” The floor took a second to register his words, before they were in splits. “A funny game it would be,” he said.

Funny, he emphasised, because he would be running against familiar faces and teammates. Haaland dusted up his ties with the country. “I think for me it’s super special because I play in England and I’m born in England and you also play against team-mates and everything,” he said.

Three of England’s back four who could be tasked with containing him - are his teammates. The centre-back pairing of John Stones and Marc Guehi (who though is injured) and the left back Nico O’Reilly, Ezri Konsa, who could shift from centre-back to right back, has waged several battles against Haaland. While Dan Burn has allowed only one goal to the freakishly prolific star back in 2022, not scoring in next 7 matches, playing centre back at Newcastle.

Goalkeeper Jordan Pickford would remember the nightmares Haaland had made him suffer (seven goals in six games). Some of them like Stones and Jude Bellingham (from their Borussia Dortmund days) are close friends.

A familiar question looms too. How to stop Haaland? Unlike in science, formulas and derivations don’t provide a clear solution. Managers don’t pivot their plans around one particular threat, but the team as a whole, but Haaland’s impact has been so profound that most of England’s boardroom tactical talks could have been centred around the Norwegian.

A force like him cannot be contained. Brazil kept him quiet for 79 minutes. Yet he struck with his first presented chance. Tying his legs, head, chest, ankles, thigh, or whichever part he could score goals legally with—metaphorically—is the only way he could be neutralised. He is imposing, wise, space-aware and not wasteful. All he required was 18 shots for his seven goals in the tournament. That is less than three attempts per goal.

Cutting the source is the bleeding obvious. Stifle Arsenal captain Martin Odegaard, Norway’s creative fulcrum, and half the battle could be won.

He prowls a deeper position than he does in Arsenal, helps



Erling Haaland (top) has scored in every game he’s started in this World Cup. Harry Kane (below) leads his team in training. AP



create an overload at the centre of the pitch and composes defence-disrupting passes. Brazil’s ageing midfield struggled to contain him. In Declan Rice (England would pray he is fully fit), his Arsenal chum, and Elliot Anderson (another Man City teammate), Haaland would encounter a sterner double-pivot than Bruno Guimaraes and Casemiro.

But Norway is not solely dependent on their captain, as there are creative forces on the flanks. Full-backs Julian Ryerson and David Moller Wolfe, inject pace, run in behind and could fling pinpoint crosses. Wingers Alexander Sorloth and Andreas Schjelderup, who assisted both his goals against Brazil, combine devastatingly with the full-backs.

Vulnerable on the right

Herein lies England’s migraine. The right side of their flank. Two of their prominent right-backs are fighting fitness battles; one is serving suspension. England manager Thomas Tuchel could post Ezri Konsa, who could be slower than Reece James or Djed Spence, who has aerial prowess and intervenes in the crosses flying towards Haaland. But he is susceptible to speedy wingers and full-backs.

Upfield Noni Madueke has troubled defences with his speed and directness, but full-backs have turned him over easily when he is defending. A winger that can’t defend and a full-back that can’t attack and press high-up present a unique quandary for Tuchel. Maybe, the solution could be Bukayo Saka, if he is optimally fit. He will enhance England’s creativity, while offering more defensively than Madueke. Konsa requires the protection shield to suppress the wingers from running him ragged. It’s unlikely that England would rejig their midfield

with Eberchi Eze.

At times, against Manchester City, bottle-necking the chief creators has worked in neutering Haaland. But in the last season, without Kevin de Bruyne and a masterly playmaker, Haaland has learnt to be a man of his own. Even if the routes are blocked, Haaland could dig a path of his own. Get tight to him and he’ll spin you. Step off him and he’ll expose you with any open bit of grass he can find. Double up on him? It would give his teammates more room to operate in. He is most lethal when transitioning. Of the 43 goals he scored last season, 17 arrived during transitional phases, when the team is in a structural flux. The marker’s attention leaves the marked fleetingly, and that is all it takes for Haaland to sting.

Some teams have tried man-marking and getting touch-tight with him, which is a great idea if the opponents have the right personnel. A peak Stones versus Haaland could have been a riveting tussle. But Stones has lost his reflexes after a string of injuries. Guehi is no physical match for Haaland, and injured. England, though, have the six foot seven Dan Burn, who has in the past succeeded in suffocating Haaland. But he is best used as a substitute, like against Mexico.

Generally, managers stick with the same set of defenders they have started with. But exceptions could be made when they are tasked to stop Haaland or Mbappe, because it could emotionally, as much as physically, drain them. Pickford’s enterprise in leaping out of his line and blocking crosses could be defining in reducing Haaland’s immeasurable goal-striking prowess. But it would be a familiar battle, with familiar colleagues, foes and themes. And the “stay humble” line could echo again in Miami.

• SERIOUS PASTIME

Chess park: When Bobby Haywood preceded Bobby Fischer, and then vanished

Sandip G
New York, July 10

UNDER THE sprawling canopy of a century-old elm in Washington Square Park of New York sits Marcel Anderson, a cigarette on his lip and a queen in his hand. “The edges (of the chess piece) are coming off, gosh I need to buy a new set!” he mutters to himself. And then quietly he wisecracks: “You lose the queen, you lose the battle, on the board and in your life.”

Anderson, aka Marty, is one of the dozen chess hustlers in the Washington Square Park, or merely chess park, making a living out of playing and teaching chess. A crash course costs \$30 an hour; a blitz game comes at \$10. “You beat me, you get \$10, you lose, I get the money,” Anderson, who who has an Instagram profile with 10k followers, tells *The Indian Express*. “It’s tough to beat me,” he says with the swagger of a veteran, which he is.

“(Playing for) thirty years, buddy. You beat me thrice and I

give you this chair,” he chuckles, sitting on one of those wide berth NY City iconic benches.

On a good day, he makes around \$1000 dollars, on a bad day, which are most, gets in the range of \$200-300. “The pandemic was bad man, people started playing online and stopped coming out. The tourists also declined, and we are reduced to the regulars,” says the 61-year-old. He points his index at a chair in the far west corner, soaking in the sun. “That’s where Magnus (Carlsen) sat and played.”

The one on the south east was Hikaru’s (Nakamura) favourite. “Look there, you see a stone bench, that is where Bobby (Fischer) used to sit.” Fischer never hustled but the historic park was his favourite haunt and is only three blocks down the street from Marshall Chess Club, his alma mater. “Maybe, one day I can sit down and have a game with Pragg (R Praggnanandhaa).” The Indian Grandmaster is his favourite player on the circuit.

“Mine is Gukesh,” intervenes Joseph, from the adjacent table. Though they are not professionals, they hawkishly follow the games. “I have been a cocaine addict, and I tell chess is more addictive,” Anderson says.

Dropping by the park, which has also been a gathering place for the LGBTQIA+ community for more than a century, is a ritual for professionals and amateurs in the country.

Its popularity soared after the 1993 movie Searching for Bobby Fischer.

The hustling culture, though, began in the 1970s. Its founding father in the city is widely credited to be a man named Bobby Haywood, who no one knows where he came from, or when he vanished.

The story goes that one day he set up a chess board on top of a garbage can and he solicited passers-by to play a game of chess with, for 10 cents. At first people thought he was mad, but people kept showing up to play him and the idea soon caught on. “That was the



Anderson (L) playing against FIDE Master Garrett Reynolds. EXPRESS

time when it really caught on, the 70s. Cold war, Fischer, the Russian Grandmasters,” Joseph says.

One of the regulars was director Stanley Kubrick, when he was in his teenage. He grew up in New York’s Bronx and be-

“You beat me, you get \$10, you lose, I get the money. It’s tough to beat me, playing for thirty years, buddy. You beat me thrice and I give you this chair”

MARCEL ANDERSON, ONE OF MANY CHESS HUSTLERS IN WASHINGTON SQUARE PARK

came hooked onto chess after his father gifted him a chess set. He hustled at the Park to find his early photography gigs, and the game was a leitmotif through his filmography - 2001: A Space Odyssey to The Killing and Lolita as well as A Clockwork Orange.

“Yeah, I have heard this story,” Joseph says.

A sardonic smile flickers across Anderson when the celebrity list is unveiled. The meaning goes without saying:

“No one listens to the hustlers’ stories.” They are just like the pieces on the board, failing and succeeding the moves of their lives. He was born in Baltimore in Maryland. Raised by a single mother, one among her eight children, he was good at academics and got an admission at the Milford Mill Academy in Baltimore.

His life took a turn there when he protested against the institute’s treatment of black students. “We got old and worn out books, the white teachers never gave us good grades, and we were always made to sit at the back. So a group of us protested and got chucked out,” he says.

The school eventually reinstated him, and he enrolled at the University of Baltimore. He joined the culinary arts school. Life was going smoothly before he started selling drugs to meet his ends. In months, he became a cocaine addict. “I went to rehab, got myself back and began to work as a cook in a hotel,” he says.

But unlike the moves on a

chess board, he has little control over the shifts of destiny. After his mother died, he moved to New York wanting to be an actor. He couldn’t as he fell in love with a girl and got married. He took up a teaching job, but his wife divorced him and filed a case of sexual harassment. He lost his savings and served a term in prison.

His resurrection began in Washington Square, where he drowned all his griefs. He soon found himself a job as a counsellor for drug addicts and served for nearly three decades. “I loved my job, but I wanted to retire at the first chance, because I can play here all day long, and make money,” he says. “Tax free money!” he emphasises. Just then he sketches on a potential client, and shouts in booming baritone: “See what you have got man... I think you can beat me.”

The man pulls the chair and he hurriedly sets the clock, as the evening descends over Washington Square Park and its squares of 64.

Modi, Albanese announce Big Bash opener in Chennai in Dec



Anthony Albanese (L) and Narendra Modi. ANI

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 10

INDIA AND Australia decided to strengthen sports cooperation and announced a roadmap as Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese at the Melbourne Cricket Ground on Friday, as part of his two-day Australia visit.

The two leaders announced that the opening match of the men's Big Bash League will take place in Chennai in December this year. This will be the first foreign cricket league to play in India. The event will be the cornerstone of a week-long festival, called G'Day Namaste, to be held across India in December, featuring Australian cultural, business and sports events. G'Day Namaste will promote Australia's economic priorities outlined in A New Roadmap for Australia's Economic Engagement with India.

The two leaders also announced the roadmap on sports cooperation, and the roadmap will "leverage Australia's experience and India's ambitions to host major sporting events, creating opportunities to increase our trade, tourism and investment ties", a statement by the Australian Prime Minister's office said.

It sets out priorities across capacity building, sports science and technology research, industry and investment, it said.

Deep cooperation

The roadmap will provide opportunities to deepen cooperation on major sporting events, as Australia prepares to host the 2032 Olympic Games and Paralympic and India prepares to host the 2030 Commonwealth Games.

PM Modi said, "Sport is a key pillar of the India-Australia partnership, bringing our people closer through shared passion and mutual respect. Delighted to visit the iconic Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG) with PM Albanese. More sporting exchanges, youth engagement and collaboration can further strengthen the India-Australia friendship."

INDIA'S POOR BATTING SHOW

Top-gear approach can work on flat tracks, not bowling pitches

The Indian batting order has crumbled despite the workable conditions, exposing multiple flaws in the system

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, July 10

FOUR MONTHS ago, Suryakumar Yadav lifted a T20 World Cup trophy in Ahmedabad. On Saturday, he will watch from outside the XI as India try to salvage pride at Southampton, having already lost this series, their second straight defeat in a fortnight after a three-year run without one ended in a shock whitewash to Ireland. A loss here also costs India the world No.1 T20I ranking they've held since 2022. In between, he lost the captaincy, then his place in the team altogether. Nothing about his batting changed. What changed is that India, having won a tournament playing one way, discovered it does not know how to play any other way, and needed someone to blame for that first.

The clearest proof came at Trent Bridge, where India folded for 76, their second-lowest total in T20I history. Five wickets went down inside the powerplay alone, 54 for 5, the earliest India have ever lost five in a men's T20I. Abhishek Sharma mistimed a top edge to point. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi gloved an Archer bouncer behind. Ishan Kishan and Shreyas Iyer both picked out the same fielder at deep backward square leg in successive balls.

Axar Patel edged behind trying to counter-attack. Five different shots, five different ways of failing, but the same instinct behind all of them: commit to the attack and trust the pace and bounce not to punish it. "When you're chasing 200, you need to pace up your innings, have a set pattern for how you're going to go about it," Shreyas Iyer said afterward.

"We fell a bit short in terms of that. Execution was awful."

For years, India battled cautiously in T20Is despite being home to the IPL, T20's most aggressive league. Only from the 2023 ODI World Cup was that caution shed for good, and two T20 World Cups followed. It still works against attacks that let



Indian head coach Gautam Gambhir (R) in conversation with Tilak Varma during a training session. CREIMAS FOR BCCI

The personnel excuse only stretches so far. Of the squad that won in Ahmedabad, only Suryakumar was actually removed.

the ball come on. It stops working the moment the pitch fights back, because the method leaves no room for a batter to slow down mid-innings without the whole thing stalling.

Workable conditions

England's own batters faced the same conditions and found them workable, not hostile, just demanding a few adjustments and a willingness to find the straighter parts of the ground rather than the leg-side arc India defaults to. Assistant coach Ryan ten Doeschate put it plainly: preparation for different conditions matters, and being mentally ready to shift approach matters just as much. India have shown neither.

The personnel excuse only stretches so far. Of the squad that won in Ahmedabad, only Suryakumar was actually removed. Bumrah and Pandya, the two players who featured in every match of that tournament, were rested, not injured or dropped, and their absence is the one personnel gap India

can genuinely point to. Kuldeep Yadav, Rinku Singh and Siraj were also missing, though none played every game in March either. This is a weakened side, not an unrecognisable one, and swapping in more experienced batters would not by itself fix a unit built for one gear.

Whether India arrived with the right personnel for a reset is its own question. Shubman Gill's name came up in selection meetings, but stayed just that, talk, alongside Sudharsan, Padikkal and the reinvented KL Rahul, whose 174.41 strike rate in this year's IPL beat Prabhsimran Singh's 168.87. It is Prabhsimran, not any of them, travelling to Zimbabwe next. India will keep hopping between venues like this for the foreseeable future, which makes the refusal to adapt look less like a one-series problem than a recurring one.

Underneath all of it sits something harder to coach out: fear. Suryakumar went from trophy to XI omission inside four months, and Sanju Samson was dropped without a clear public explanation.

Both send the same message to the dressing room: no place is secure, no matter what you have won. High-risk batting cannot survive that atmosphere. Fluency is the first thing fear removes, and there is already talk inside the batting

group, unofficially, about exactly that.

The board's own reading is calmer than the dressing room's. BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia called the results "not something abnormal," a "purely bad phase," and confirmed a review once the ODI series against England ends on July 19, "strictly about the performance of the team... Nothing else will be discussed." That last line does more work than it means to. A board rarely needs to specify what won't be discussed unless it already knows what everyone assumes will be.

Saturday's match at Southampton won't undo the series defeat already sealed in Bristol. Win, and India salvage some pride and keep the ranking they've defended since 2022. Lose, and they hand over the ranking too, on top of a series already gone. Either way, the review due after July 19 will have to answer a harder question than form: whether the side that discovered one ferocious gear in Ahmedabad has any idea how to find a second one, not back toward the caution they buried in 2023, but toward genuine range, batters who can shift down and still hold an innings together. Calling it a bad phase assumes the method is sound and the execution slipped. Trent Bridge suggests the opposite.

BCCI confirms review after India's England debacle

Express News Service
Mumbai, July 10

THE BOARD of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) will review the Indian men's T20 team's disappointing performances in England after the conclusion of the ODI series, the BCCI secretary, Devajit Saikia, said in a statement on Friday. Saikia insisted the board was not alarmed by the results and viewed the slump as a temporary setback. "The BCCI is currently observing the performance of the Indian T20 team, which has not been up to the mark in the ongoing series against England. However, this is not something abnormal and can happen in international cricket. We consider it as a purely bad phase," Saikia said.

India will switch focus to the three-match ODI series after Saturday's fifth and final T20I in Southampton. "Once the ODI series gets over on July 19 and the team comes back, we will have a review meeting with core members of the team to discuss what went wrong in England," the BCCI secretary said.

Sinner blows away Djokovic in a show of precise power-hitting



Jannik Sinner defeated Novak Djokovic 6-4, 6-4, 6-4. REUTERS

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, July 10

POWER (OF shots), precision (of serves) and pace (of movement). Jannik Sinner's 3Ps, if you will, that can obliterate everything and everyone in his presence — a gladiatorial Novak Djokovic too. As he did 12 months back, the top-ranked Italian again rendered Djokovic's resilience irrelevant, taking the Serbian apart in a 6-4, 6-4, 6-4 mauling to enter his second straight Wimbledon final. The burning question, going into this encounter, was how Djokovic's body would hold up after his five-hour, 15-minute epic against Félix Auger-Aliassime in the quarters. The 39-year-old incredibly managed to return on court at a world-class level, moving well and serving consistently in the first set. Sinner simply took all of that out of the equation with the brutal clinicality of his ball-striking. These were visuals we had seen before, particularly in 2026, where he now possesses a 38-3 win-loss record.

The match began on an even keel, in fact Djokovic was marginally better in terms of landing his first serves initially. But Sinner was about to turn on the heat. He began pouncing on Djokovic's second serve like nobody's business.

A double fault was all the window he needed to break through in the ninth game, topping it off with an exquisite backhand pass. The first set, wrapped up in 40 minutes, was a microcosm of the one-sided contest. Djokovic was not doing much wrong, and Sinner was sailing through games anyway.

The exhibition resumed in the second set. Sinner broke Djokovic in the seventh game, with a backhand packing all the power you'd think was possible in a groundstroke, followed by a drop shot that caught the men's G.O.A.T. out cold. Whenever the Serb looked like mounting a comeback, or even a challenge, Sinner snuffed it

out with his whipping forehand or a searing ace.

The third set began with the 24-year-old breaking Djokovic right off the bat. The former world number one was only playing catch-up from there, and did extremely well to hang on as long as he did. But the result, and his fate, were never in doubt.

A wide return was the clincher for Sinner, whose service never faltered in the 2 hours and 20 minutes that the match lasted.

Sinner was generous in his praise of Djokovic's campaign. "He had a very tough match against Felix [Auger-Aliassime], which we will remember forever here in this arena. I tried to stay aggressive, serving well helped me today. He is the best returner we have in our games so I tried to mix it up. I'm very happy with this performance," he said at the post-match interview.

A seventh Grand Slam final awaits for the Italian, and in his way stands Alexander Zverev. But going by today's display, as also the manner in which Sinner has blown the German away in the recent past, anything other than a second grass-court title for Sinner would be considered a massive upset. As for Djokovic, the quest for an outright record 25th Major continues.

His best chance, though would be when Sinner is not in the picture — five defeats in their last six duels are evidence enough.

Zverev levels up

Alexander Zverev has levelled up. A different, markedly more confident version of his has emerged post the French Open triumph. After 13 years on the Tour and seven ATP Masters 1000 titles, it's remarkable how far a maiden Grand Slam conquest has gone in lifting the German's belief. Arthur Fery was the latest victim of his prime form in a ruthless 7-6 (7-0), 6-2, 6-4 victory that made Zverev a first-time Wimbledon finalist.

Mandhana shines as India bowled out for 285

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, July 10

AT 189/3 after 44 overs, India appeared to have seized control of the opening day of the one-off Test at Lord's. But a brief stoppage after Harmanpreet Kaur required treatment on her left arm disrupted India's rhythm, offering England a chance to reset. The hosts capitalised immediately.

Issy Wong, who had already broken the 64-run stand between Smriti Mandhana and Jemimah Rodrigues before lunch, claimed the wicket England desperately needed four balls after play resumed, dismissing Smriti Mandhana for 83. From a position where they looked set to dominate, India lost their last six wickets for 96 runs, handing England a route back into the contest.

Mandhana was the architect of India's recovery after early setbacks, producing an innings that blended her trademark fluency with patience. After Shafali Verma and Yastika Bhatia fell cheaply to leave India at 24/2, the left-hander assumed responsibility alongside Rodrigues.

She countered England's early movement by punishing anything overpitched and pulling confidently whenever the seamers dropped short. Crisp drives through cover, authoritative pulls, elegant flicks and a confident slog-swept six off Sophie Ecclestone highlighted an innings that remained posi-

tive without sacrificing discipline. After Rodrigues fell for 35 in the first session, Mandhana controlled the scoring, bringing up a fluent half-century before extending the recovery in an 89-run fourth-wicket stand with Harmanpreet Kaur. Looking destined for a century, she continued to find gaps with effortless timing until Wong, rewarded for a disciplined spell from around the wicket, tempted her into driving away from her body. Mandhana edged behind to Amy Jones for 83, falling 17 runs short of a deserved hundred but giving India the platform for a competitive first-innings total.

Harmanpreet ensured India did not surrender the initiative after Rodrigues' dismissal, compiling a composed 58. She absorbed the pressure before settling into a patient rhythm, rotating the strike and cashing in on the occasional loose delivery.

The innings gained added significance as she twice required on-field treatment, first to her left arm and later to her hamstring, but battled through the discomfort before debutant Mady Villiers beat her ambitious drive with one that turned sharply through the gate.

BRIEF SCORES: India 285 all out in 74.5 overs (Smriti 83, Harmanpreet 58, Deepti 57; Ecclestone 3/68) vs England 21/1 in 11 overs, lead by 264 runs.



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- Narendra Modi, Prime Minister

DEBT FUND OUTFLOWS OF RS 1.09 LAKH CRORE, MOSTLY FROM LIQUID & LOW DURATION FUNDS IN JUNE

June equity MF inflows up 26% from May; gold ETFs see rebound

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, July 10

INFLOWS INTO equity mutual funds (MFs) rose 26% in June from the previous month, with contributions from systematic investment plans (SIPs) at a three-month high of Rs 31,781 crore. Overall net MF outflows from the overall mutual funds industry narrowed to Rs 52,949 crore from Rs 64,021 crore in May as more money poured into equity schemes, while gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) saw a 65% month-on-month increase in flows.

Flows into ETFs rebounded during the month, especially for gold and silver ETFs, while those into hybrid mutual funds also jumped, signifying that investors preferred to diversify across schemes as the stock market remained volatile in June amid geopolitical uncertainties.

"June marked positive equity inflows for the 64th consecutive month. SIP contributions touched a record Rs 31,781 crore, reflecting growing investor confidence and the increasing adoption of disciplined, long-term investing," said Venkat Chalasani, Association of Mutual Funds in India's (AMFI) Chief Executive.

Assets under management (AUM) of the MF industry rose further to a new record of Rs 82.2 lakh crore as of June 30 from Rs 81.6 lakh crore on the last day of the previous month. Last month also saw the assets under control (AUC) of the MF industry, at Rs 76.41 lakh crore, surpassing that of foreign investors' Rs 76.22 lakh crore for the first time.

This indicates continued growth of the industry amidst heavy foreign outflows this year. AUM represents the total value of all schemes managed by the industry, including factors such as accrued returns, while AUC only represents the total underlying assets held by

an institution.

Equity inflows rose 26% MoM and 23% year-on-year to Rs 28,973 crore in June, with inflows into mid-cap funds — the most popular category — increased nearly 39%, while those into multi-cap, large, and mid-cap funds, focused funds, and value funds also rose by over 30%. "The increase in inflows into multi-cap, mid-cap, and small-cap funds suggests investors are participating across the market-cap spectrum rather than chasing a single pocket of the market," said Suranjana Borthakur, head of distribution and strategic alliances at Mirae Asset Investment Managers (India).

On the debt side, outflows widened to Rs 1.09 lakh crore from Rs 96,949 crore in May. In June 2025, debt outflows were a mere Rs 1,711 crore. The rising debt scheme outflows is primarily due to exits from liquid, low-duration, and short-duration funds, which are often used by companies and institutional players to park their money safely in the short term.

June was a good month for ETFs, with those related to gold seeing net inflows of Rs 3,443 crore after the outflow of Rs 725 crore in May.

The rebound in gold ETF flows suggests investors continue to value gold as an effective portfolio diversifier amid global uncertainty, according to Rohit Sarin, co-founder of wealth management firm Client Associates. Silver ETFs also saw inflows of Rs 4,287 crore compared to an outflow of Rs 2,113 crore in the previous month.

The fall in gold prices from its peak in late January may have played a part in the revival of precious metal ETF inflows, giving investors a good entry point with potential for future returns.

Gold ETFs are backed by physical gold and are thus directly linked to gold prices.

FPIs return to Indian stocks, but not much has changed

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, July 10

After four months, foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) — at least in the first 10 days of July — have been net buyers of Indian stocks, having purchased shares worth \$1.6 billion.

However, it may not amount to much. The West Asia war in late February sparked a \$28-billion exit by FPIs from the domestic equity markets over the next four months.

The US-Iran peace deal, announced on June 14, turned sentiment around, with the second half of last month seeing net inflows of \$1.1 billion after outflows of \$6.7 billion in the first half. But there is little to suggest that the return of FPIs — which has coincided with a sharp pullback in AI-led markets such as South Korea on worries about the tech rally being overstretched — has changed how foreign investors view India as a market.

Limited downsides, AI alternative

Some experts think that while foreign flows into Indian equities may remain iffy going forward, a deep sell-off may not be seen again as FPIs may see India as an opportunity after valuations in AI-driven markets have gone through the roof. "Thus, they are entering markets like India, where the downside is very limited at this point, so they can at least protect their money," said Pravin Bokade, head of research at IDBI Capital Markets.

Further, as the initial AI capex cycle matures, investors will also look for opportunities in secondary AI markets. In this regard, India becomes more at-



The war in late February sparked a \$28-billion exit by FPIs. REUTERS

tractive thanks to improving macro fundamentals, Motilal Oswal Financial Services said in a report earlier this month.

According to Motilal Oswal analysts, India's valuation premium over emerging markets "has compressed to a historic low of 18% in June, significantly below its long-term average of 73% and CY22 peak of 147%". This, according to them, leaves fewer reasons for FPIs to remain net sellers for long.

The measures taken by the government and the Reserve Bank of India on June 5 to boost inflows into debt may have also had an indirect effect on equity markets by having a positive impact on keenly-eyed metrics such as Balance of Payments, deeper foreign participation, and a more stable rupee. Vishad Turakhia, MD and CEO of Equirus Securities, pointed out that currency stability is a key consideration for overseas equity investors as continued depreciation can "significantly erode" returns in dollar terms. In June, foreign inflows into the debt market jumped to \$5.8 billion from \$291 million in May, with talk of the

rupee hitting 100-per-dollar in the coming months having vanished entirely.

AI, geopolitics 'superficial' reasons

Inflows have been far too modest so far, making it difficult to extrapolate any positives, said Dhananjay Sinha, Systematix Group's CEO and co-head of institutional equities. The Indian

market, Sinha said, remains expensive and no earnings growth to match it.

Others are not as charitable. According to Kotak Institutional Equities, using AI and geopolitics to argue away India's weak performance over the last two years "seem superficial".

"We believe sections of the market have been too complacent on the quality of the business models of Indian companies and disruption risks to their business models, too generous in valuing the market for the past few years, and too optimistic on earnings," Kotak analysts led by Sanjeev Prasad said in a note on July 1.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

KERALA ONLY MAJOR STATE LAGGING BEHIND, BUT NOT OPPOSED

Boost for labour reforms as West Bengal on board now

Ravi Dutta Mishra & Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, July 10

THE BJP's recent electoral gains has led to an upside for labour reforms. States that were holding out from implementing the long-pending labour codes are now coming on board. With a BJP government in place now, West Bengal, which lagged behind in framing the draft rules for the four labour codes, is getting ready to roll them out.

Opposition-ruled state Kerala is now the only major state that still remains out of the loop on the new labour codes and is yet to notify the rules, a senior government official said. However, Kerala is "not against" the implementation but is moving slowly in formalising the process for rollout of the four labour codes, the official added.

With the Congress-led UDF replacing the CPI(M)-led LDF government in Kerala, the official said the change in government could open the doors somewhat as the state is "not against" the implementation of the labour codes and will open up to the benefits of the codes.

"West Bengal and Kerala are yet to notify the rules for the labour codes. But West Bengal is going to implement the codes soon. Kerala is the only major state that's left. It has said that it will assess the same but has not opposed it. That there could be challenges at the time of implementation of the new rules has been discussed with the states. The Centre has assured the states that it will resolve all queries," the official said.

The official pointed out that Karnataka, despite being an Opposition-ruled state, has accepted the codes and prepared the draft rules.

The Centre had notified the four labour codes — Code on Wages, 2019; Industrial Relations Code, 2020; Code on Social Security, 2020; and Occupational Safety, Health and Work-



ROAD AHEAD

WEST BENGAL, which lagged behind in framing the draft rules for the four labour codes, is getting ready to roll them out after the BJP government came to power

OPPOSITION-RULED Kerala is now the only major state that still remains out of the loop on the new labour codes and is yet to notify the rules. However, the state is "not against" the implementation

THE CENTRE had notified the four labour codes in November 2025. In December last year, the government had told that 34 of the 36 states and UTs had finalised the rules for the Code on Wages, Code on Social Security and Industrial Relations Code.

ing Conditions (OSH) Code, 2020 — in November 2025, close to five years after getting the law passed in Parliament. In December last year, the Ministry of Labour and Employment, in a written response, had said that states/Union Territories are still in the process of finalising the rules, adding that 34 of the 36 states and Union Territories (UTs) had finalised the rules for the Code on Wages, Code on Social Security and Industrial Relations Code.

The Mamata Banerjee-led government in West Bengal had refused to comply with the labour codes, alleging that if the law was implemented, many workers would be deprived of social security.

Last December, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge had also opposed the codes, saying they pose a threat to job security as the threshold for requiring prior government approval for layoffs had been raised from 100 to 300 workers, adding that companies would hire short-term workers to avoid giving benefits to long-term workers.

The Code on Wages seeks to redefine the break-up of wages to increase the share of the basic pay component — to enable higher provision for social security, especially in the service sector. The codes also aim to expand the social security provisions for gig workers.

While most states have finalised draft rules under the labour codes, as per the government reply in Parliament, the progress varied, depending on the government in power. For instance, BJP-ruled states like Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, Haryana and Assam finalised the draft rules in the first half of the year, but Opposition-ruled states like Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Telangana were slower. Labour laws fall under the concurrent list of the Constitution. Hence, both the Centre and states are empowered to make rules. But in the event of a conflict between state and central laws, central legislation generally takes precedence, unless the state's law has obtained presidential assent.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

OpenAI's ChatGPT Work raises stakes for Indian IT

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, July 10

OPENAI ON Thursday launched ChatGPT Work — a new artificial intelligence (AI) agent capable of executing complex tasks across enterprise applications and files — a move that is expected to accelerate enterprise adoption of autonomous AI while raising the stakes for India's IT services industry and the government's push to build a domestic AI ecosystem.

The launch marks OpenAI's biggest shift yet from conversational AI towards agentic AI, where software systems can independently carry out multi-step assignments rather than simply respond to user prompts. ChatGPT Work can access files and enterprise applications with user permission, gather information across multiple sources, and create finished outputs such as presentations, spreadsheets, reports and web applications. The company also introduced GPT-5.6, a new family of

models comprising Sol, Terra and Luna, alongside a redesigned desktop application that integrates chat, coding and AI agents. For India, the significance extends well beyond a new AI model.

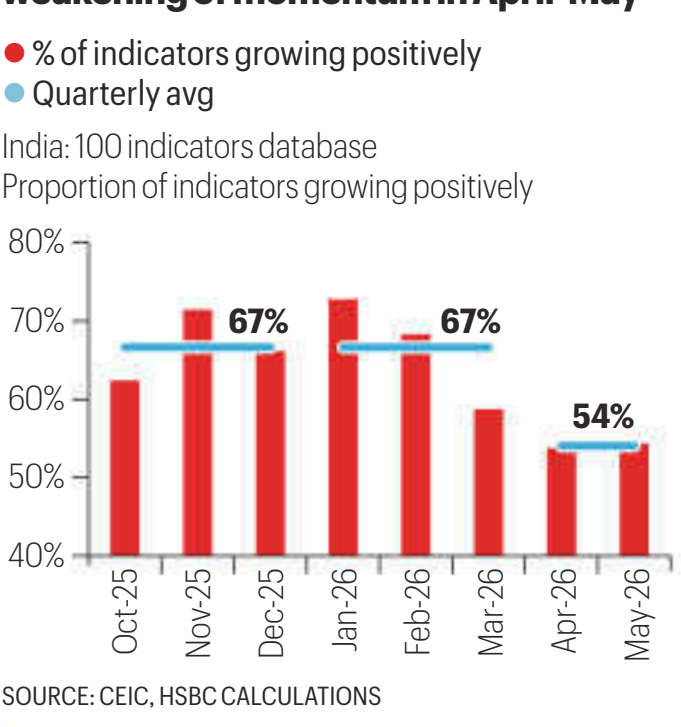
The launch comes as the government is investing in compute infrastructure, AI models and applications under the IndiaAI Mission, while Indian enterprises are beginning to move from experimenting with generative AI to deploying it across core business functions. More capable AI agents are expected to widen enterprise use cases across software development, finance, procurement, legal services, customer support, compliance and back-office operations.

The development could also reshape the opportunity landscape for India's \$280-billion IT services industry. Over the past two years, companies have been increasingly positioning themselves as AI transformation partners, helping global clients integrate generative AI into their operations. FE

•GROWTH MOMENTUM WEAKENED IN APRIL-MAY?

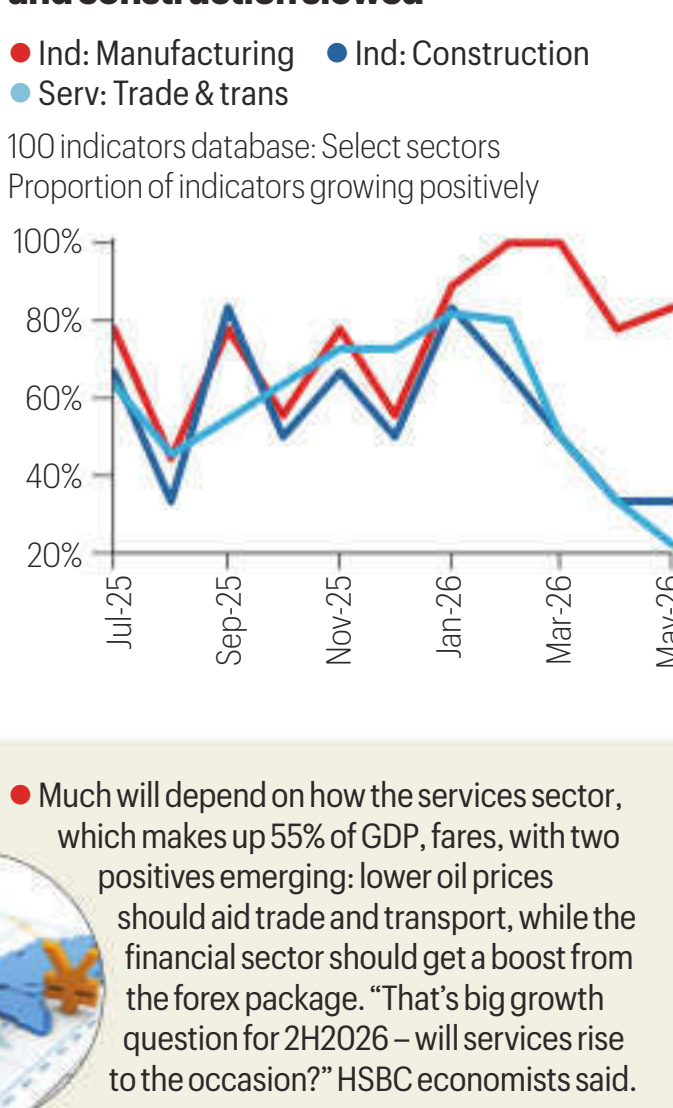
At 7.8%, India's GDP growth surprised on the upside in the first three months of 2026, even though the war in West Asia was expected to weigh heavy. While the expected slowdown may not have materialised, HSBC economists said in a July 6 report that the first two months of the April-June quarter have seen "weakening of momentum".

Database of 100 growth indicators suggest weakening of momentum in April-May



While the manufacturing sector is estimated to have been "notably resilient" in April and May, rural demand is "already showing early signs of strain" due to above-normal temperatures denting the farm sector. Transport and construction sectors have also slowed down.

While manufacturing held up, transport and construction slowed



Much will depend on how the services sector, which makes up 55% of GDP, fares, with two positives emerging: lower oil prices should aid trade and transport, while the financial sector should get a boost from the forex package. "That's big growth question for 2H2026 — will services rise to the occasion?" HSBC economists said.

NEWLY-APPOINTED US FEDERAL RESERVE CHAIRMAN KEVIN WARSH HAS ANNOUNCED FIVE TASK FORCES

Rajan, Raj Chetty on panels to review US Fed functioning

Press Trust of India
Washington, July 10

FORMER RBI Governor Raghuram Rajan, Delhi-born American economist Raj Chetty and senior Microsoft executive Asha Sharma have been roped in by the US Federal Reserve to review the manner in which it conducts monetary policy.

The five task forces announced by the newly appointed US Federal Reserve chairman Kevin Warsh also include former Bank of England Governor Mervyn King, former Walmart CEO Doug McMillon, Nobel laureate Thomas Sargent and Silicon Valley venture capitalist Marc Andreessen.

"I am honoured that the best minds from a range of disciplines have agreed to work with us to sharpen our performance as an institution. The goal is straightforward: to ensure the Fed is best positioned to achieve our objectives in this consequential time," Warsh said in a statement on Thursday.

He said the US economy has changed significantly over the last generation, and each task force will carefully consider whether policymakers' means, methods, analytical tools and policy approaches can be improved.

The five task forces will examine areas central to the broad conduct of monetary pol-

icy. They will be co-led by external advisers accomplished economists, business leaders, and former central bank practitioners with deep expertise in their fields. Supported by Federal Reserve staff, they will operate independently, with a mandate to follow the evidence, provide candid feedback, and produce rigorous findings for the Federal Open Market Committee, the Federal Reserve said in a statement.

Rajan will serve on the Balance Sheet Policy task force alongside Harvard economist Karen Dynan and former Federal Reserve Governor Jeremy Stein. The panel will examine the costs, benefits and institu-



Raghuram Rajan will serve on the Balance Sheet Policy task force alongside Harvard economist Karen Dynan. FILE PHOTO

tional implications of the Federal Reserve's current balance sheet regime, including its asset holdings and their role in imple-

menting monetary policy. Chetty, a Harvard University economist, co-lead the Data task force with McMillon and the

University of Chicago economist, Kevin Murphy.

The group will focus on improving the quality and timeliness of real-world economic signals that inform the Federal Reserve's policy decisions. Chetty is known for pioneering the use of large administrative and real-time datasets to study economic mobility, inequality and labour markets in the United States.

Wisconsin-born Sharma, the executive vice president of Microsoft and CEO of Xbox, will serve on the Productivity and Jobs task force alongside venture capitalist Andreessen and Stanford economist Charles I Jones.

•MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
77,569.39	24,206.90	₹1,43,368	₹95.32
827.57	244.10		
1.08%	1.02%	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
		₹2,20,390	\$74.37

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 9, 2026

SALUTE THE SOLDIER



11 GORKHA RIFLES REGIMENTAL CENTRE
Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart No 9420789 Late Rfn Raj Kumar Rai of 1/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during OP VLJAY (Kargil) on 11 Jul 1999.

COLONEL 11 GR & SIKKIM SCOUTS AND ALL RANKS

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

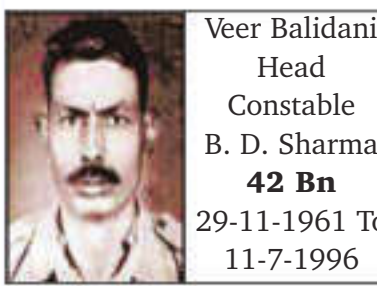
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans on their Balidan Diwas.



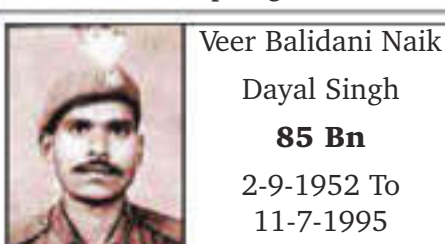
CONSTABLE
HARISH CHANDRA
64 BN BSF
19.11.1968
– 11.07.1993

CONSTABLE
KAWAL NAIN SINGH
14 BN BSF
15.03.1977
– 11.07.2007

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

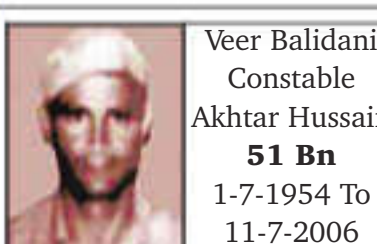


DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable B. D. Sharma of 42 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 11 July 1996 after sustaining grievous injuries while bravely combating insurgents during an operation in Khonsa, Arunachal Pradesh on 5 July 1996. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



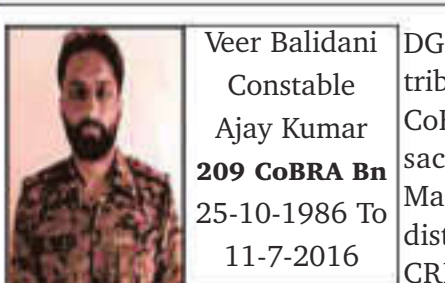
VEER BALIDANI
NAIK
Dyal Singh
85 Bn
2-9-1952 To
11-7-1995

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Naik Dyal Singh and Constable Sat Pal Singh of 85 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in a grenade attack by militants in Anantnag, Jammu & Kashmir on 11 July 1996. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



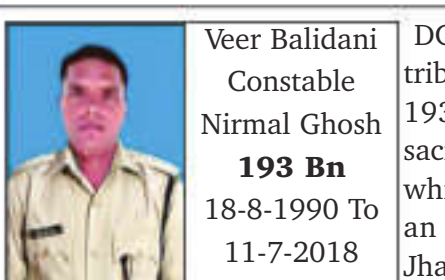
VEER BALIDANI
CONSTABLE
Akhtar Hussain
51 Bn
1-7-1954 To
11-7-2006

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Akhtar Hussain of 51 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an attack on Arampur Camp in Dantewada, Chhattisgarh on 11 July 2006. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



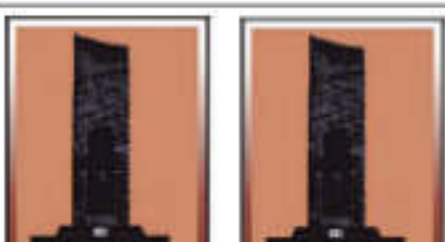
VEER BALIDANI
CONSTABLE
Ajay Kumar
209 CoBRA Bn
25-10-1986 To
11-7-2016

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Ajay Kumar of 209 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Garhwa district, Jharkhand on 11 July 2016. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



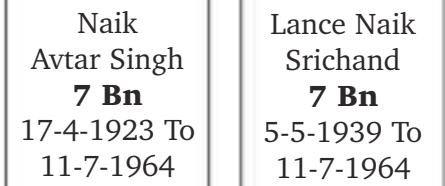
VEER BALIDANI
CONSTABLE
Nirmal Ghosh
193 Bn
18-8-1990 To
11-7-2018

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Nirmal Ghosh of 193 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in East Singhbhum, Jharkhand on 11 July 2018. For his exceptional courage and unwavering devotion to duty, he was posthumously awarded the Police Medal for Gallantry. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



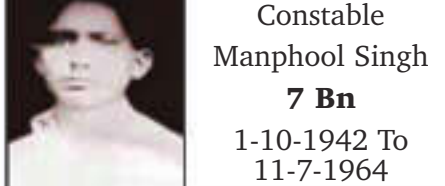
VEER BALIDANI
NAIK
Avtar Singh
7 Bn
17-4-1923 To
11-7-1964

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Naik Avtar Singh and Constable Surat Singh of 7 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during an ambush in Nagaland on 11 July 1964. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



VEER BALIDANI
CONSTABLE
Manphool Singh
7 Bn
1-10-1942 To
11-7-1964

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Manphool Singh and Constable Ramadhar Mishra of 7 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during an ambush in Nagaland on 11 July 1964. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



VEER BALIDANI
CONSTABLE
Ramadhar Mishra
7 Bn
10-9-1944 To
11-7-1964

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to six bravehearts of 7 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during an ambush in Nagaland on 11 July 1964. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
Office of the Superintending Engineer,
Electricity Distribution Circle (R), 18 E.C. Road, Dehradun

"ई-निविदा सूचना"

अयोध्यासाक्षरकार्य द्वारा अनुमोदित/प्रतिष्ठित तथा उत्तराखण्ड शासन द्वारा विद्युत अधिष्ठापन कार्य के लिए अधिभूत 'ए' क्लास लाइसेन्सधारी ठेकेदार जो ईन्कम टैक्स, उत्तराखण्ड जीएसटीएन, ई-पीएफ और ईएसआईई में पंजीकृत हों से निम्न निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

- ई-निविदा संख्या **42/EDCRDDUN/2026-27**
- ई-निविदा संख्या **43/EDCRDDUN/2026-27**
- ई-निविदा संख्या **44/EDCRDDUN/2026-27**

उपरोक्त निविदाओं की अधिक जानकारी हेतु वेबसाइट **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर देखें।

पत्रांक: 2441 / वि०वि०म०ग्रान्दे० / उपकाशि (अधीक्षण अभियन्ता)
दिनांक: 09.07.2026

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION."
(Customer Care Toll Free No. 1800 419 0405)

Varthana Finance Private Limited
Registered Office at: No. 5BC-110, Varasiddhi, Outer Ring Road, Service Road, 3rd Block, HRRR Layout, Kalyan Nagar, Bangalore-560043, Website: www.varthana.com, Email: care@varthana.com, Phone: 080-68455777, Branch Offices: #1162 & #1163, Tower B-1, 11th Floor, Space 1 Tech Park, Sector 49, Sohna Road, Gurugram 122018.

POSSESSION NOTICE [Rule 8(1)] (For Immovable Property)

Whereas, The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the M/s. Varthana Finance Private Ltd. (Formerly Known as M/s. Thirumani Finance Private Ltd.) Gurugram, Under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued a Demand Notice dated: 24-04-2026, calling upon the Applicants/ Co-Aplicants/ Mortgagees, in Loan Account No. H13101001095 & 17610200007, 1.M/s. Sita Ram Public Middle School, Represented by Authorized Signatory/Hassanpur, Hodal, Palwal, Haryana-121107, 2.M/s. Sita Ram Siksha Samiti, Represented by Authorized Signatory, Hassanpur, Hodal, Palwal, Haryana-121107, 3. Mr. Gautam, S/o Baljeet, Jaat Mohalla, Village-Darana (117), Palwal, Haryana-121107, 4. Mr. Baljeet Singh, S/o Lala Ram, Village-Darana (117), Hassanpur, Hodal, Palwal, Haryana-121107, 5.Mr. Yogender Tanwar S/o Sabarjeet Tanwar, Village-Darana (117), Palwal, Haryana-121107, 6. Mrs. Sheela, W/o Sabarjeet, Jaat Mohalla, Village-Darana (117), Hassanpur, Palwal, Haryana-121107. To repay the amount mentioned in the said notice being a sum of Rs.71,38,403/- (Rupees Seventy One Lakh Thirty Eight Thousand Four Hundred and Three Only) as on 15-04-2026, to repay agreed contractual rate of interest together with incidental expenses, cost and other charges etc, as details mentioned in the Demand Notice, till the date of payment, within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. However the Applicants/ Co-Aplicants/ Mortgagees herein above having failed to repay the full amount with interest/other charges, notice is hereby given to the Applicants/ Co-Aplicants/Mortgagees in particular and to the public in general that the undersigned being Authorized Officer of the M/s. Varthana Finance Private Ltd., Gurugram Branch has taken POSSESSION of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under section 13(4) of the said Act, read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002 on this day of 08-July-2026.

The Applicants/ Co-Aplicants/ Mortgagees in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the properties will be subject to the charge of the M/s. Varthana Finance Private Ltd., Gurugram for an amount of Rs. 71,38,403/- (Rupees Seventy One Lakh Thirty Eight Thousand Four Hundred and Three Only) as on 15-04-2026, with agreed contractual rate of interest, as mentioned herein above until the date of payment together with incidental expenses, cost and other charges. The Applicants/Co-Aplicants/Mortgagees attention is invited to provisions of Section 13(8) of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured Assets. Be notified that the above subject Loan Account number has been assigned from Indian School Finance Company to Varthana Finance Private Limited vide assignment deed dated 29/02/2024. Further, Varthana Finance Private Limited has now stepped into the shoes of the Creditor and now has the rights to lawfully collect the credit dues from you. Further, all the rights, title and interests of Indian School Finance Company with respect to the financial assets pertaining to the above referred loan account numbers and along with underlying security interests, guarantees, pledges have vested in Varthana Finance Private Limited in respect of the financial assistance availed by the Borrower(s) and Varthana Finance Private Limited exercises all its rights as the secured creditor.

Description of the Immovable Property: All that Piece and Parcel of the Property bearing Khevat/Khata No.21/21 rect.No.11 Kila No. 15/1(4/0), Total measuring 04. Kanal 0 Maria, Situated within the revenue estate of village Ramgarh, Tehsil Hassanpur, Dist. Palwal, Haryana, Total Area- 4 Kanal 00 Maria (2420 Sq yrd) : Four Boundaries : North by: Land of Parkash, South by: Land of others, East by: Land of Others, West by: Road/Land/Land of Satpa.

Date: 08-July-2026
Place: Dist - Palwal

Sd/- Authorized Officer,
Varthana Finance Private Limited

RajCOMP Info Services Limited (RISL)
C-Block, 1st Floor, Yojana Bhawan, Tilak Marg, C-Scheme, Jaipur

RISL invites e-bids through eProcurement portal from the eligible bidders for the following:

NIB No./ Date/ Unique bid no.	Particulars	Estimated Cost/EMD	Start of sale / Last date
F.4.3(576)/RISL/ Tech/2023/1947 Dated 10.07.2026 UBN No.: RIS26275LOB00041	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Technology Partner for Design, Development and Operation & Maintenance (FMS) of Disaster Management Information System-2.0 for (DMIS 2.0) for Disaster Management, Relief & Civil Defense Department, GoR.	Rs. 425 Crore EMD as per RFP	10.07.2026 18.08.2026

Details can be seen on the websites <http://risl.rajabasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajabasthan.gov.in>, <http://doitc.rajabasthan.gov.in>. Bids are to be submitted through <http://eprocr.rajabasthan.gov.in>
Raj.Samwad/C/26/6718 System Analyst (Joint Director)

NORTHERN RAILWAY E-AUCTION NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in/>) for the allotment of Deluxe Pay & Use Toilet Contracts on ROMT & MOT Basis, at following Railway stations/locations:

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
PaynUse-8-2026	27.07.2026 at 12:00 hrs.	Hazrat Nizamuddin (NZM) 02 Sites, Delhi (DLI) 01 Site, Anand Vihar (ANVT) 01 Site, Patel Nagar (PTNR) 01 Site, Jind 01 Site, Narwana (NRW) 01 Site, Mansa (MSZ) 01 Site & Panipat 01 Site (PNP) Total 9 Sites.

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen <https://ireps.gov.in/>

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids: • Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module • Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module • Payment of One Time Registration Fee: Current Account in State Bank of India: Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details. • A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism.

The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions. • Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query

Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055
E-Mail: sanitationcell@gmail.com
Tel.:011-23743084

No. 7PUB/TN/Pay&Use Toilets/Auction/2022 Dated: 10.07.2026 2387/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NAGAR NIGAM LUCKNOW
T.N. Road, Lalbagh, Hazratganj, Lucknow-226001

Ref. No.: 114/मुअ०/2026-27 Dated: 10.07.2026

E-Procurement Tender Notice (1st Call)

Lucknow Municipal Corporation invites RFPs from established & reputed Agencies/Firms/Companies for Selection of Consultant/ Architects cum Urban Planner for Providing Consultancy Services for Development of Roads under Chief Minister Green Road Infrastructure Development Scheme (CM-GRIDS) Phase-4. Tender Documents can be downloaded from the U.P. Government's e-procurement website <http://etender.up.nic.in> from 10.07.2026 to 30.07.2026 till 3:00 pm. The technical bids in prescribed format will be opened on the same day at 4:00 pm. Any Corrigendum/Addendum in this regard can be downloaded from the website <http://etender.up.nic.in>.

CHIEF ENGINEER

BRANCH DEHRADUN SUB AREA CANTEN (18516)

The sale by public auction of jewellery pledged with the Bank in the following gold loan accounts, details of which are given under will be held at the above branch premises on 27.07.2026 at 12:30 P.M.

Sl. No.	Name of Borrower	Gross Weight & Net Weight	Inspection Details	EMD Amount	EMD Amount Details	Reserve Price
1.	Krishna Singh 36. Garhi Cantt, Dehradun, Uttarakhand-248001. Mobile No. 9456116586, GL No. 125007621590	Gross Weight :- 26.70 gms Net Weight :- 22.95 gms	24.07.2026	EMD Rs.25,000/- and last date to Deposit EMD 26.07.2026	Account No. 209272946 IFSC CNRB0018516	Rs. 3,06,000/-

Auction Date & Time 27.07.2026 at 12.30 PM.

The said auction is on the following conditions:

- It is 'as is where is' condition.
- Reserve Price mentioned in the auction notice may vary based on the market price as on the date of auction.
- The successful bidder shall pay the entire bid amount at once and take delivery of the jewellery at his/her absolute risk and responsibility and the said bidder shall not have any recourse to our Bank for any reason whatsoever.
- The Bank reserves its right to put to auction all or any of the jewellery pledged in the account as considered necessary or stop auction at any time without any prior notice and at its absolute discretion.
- The Bank has absolute discretion to either reject or accept any bid without assigning any reasons whatsoever.
- The Bank has right to adjourn/postpone the auction sale at any stage to any future date at the convenience of the Bank and no person shall be entitled to claim any prior notice or right therefor.
- If the successful bidder does not clear the bid amount and/or does anything which may give rise to a necessity of adjourning/postponing/holding fresh auction sale, he/she shall be liable to indemnify the Bank to the extent of loss, if any, caused on account of his/her lapses which may come in the way of completing the auction.
- In case the auction fails, Bank shall publish another paper publication and conduct auction on any date subsequent to the auction date mentioned in this paper notification.
- The successful bidder should make full payment at least by next working day of the auction. Otherwise, bid shall be cancelled and EMD amount shall be forfeited.

For further details and detailed terms, contact **Mr. Sakaj Prakash Mobile No 9997341008 Branch Manager Dehradun Sub Area Canteen**. Email cb18516@canarabank.com, during office hours on any working day

Date: 10.07.2026 Place: Dehradun Authorised Officer, Canara Bank

समाहरणालय, पश्चिम चम्पारण, बेतिया
Collectorate: West Champaran, Bettiah

बिहार मखनिषेध और उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 (यथा संशोधित 2016, 2022 एवं 2023) के अन्तर्गत जन्म एवं अधिहरित वाहनो के वाहन स्वामियों के लिए अत्यन्तानि सूचना

बिहार मखनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम 2016 के अन्तर्गत निम्नलिखित व्यक्तियों का जन्म वाहन शराब परिवहन में विभिन्न थाना कांडों में अधिहरित / राजस्व का की गई है।

जिसका नौलागी दिनांक-22.07.2026, 27.07.2026 एवं 31.07.2026 को निर्धारित है।

अतः आप सभी वाहन स्वामियों को सूचित किया जाता है कि दिनांक-15.07.2026 के अपराहन तक अधीक्षक मखनिषेध, पश्चिम चम्पारण, बेतिया के कार्यालय में अपना वाहन रखने हेतु आवेदन दे सकते हैं। सख्यम उपस्थित नहीं होने पर यह माना जायेगा कि आपको इस संबंध में कुछ नहीं कहना है। तत्परभावात् वाहन की नौलागी कर दी जायेगी। वाहनो का विवरण निम्न तालिका में अधिष्ट है:-

क्र० सं०	CRM वाहन सं०	थाना का नाम	थाना का सं०	गाड़ी का प्रकार	गाड़ी का रजिस्ट्रेशन	ईजन नम्बर	वेचिन नम्बर	वाहन स्वामी का नाम एवं पता
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10
1	1950/24-25	धनौरी	221/24	कार	DL-3CBA-5845	L15A71219187	MAKGM252GA N106074	-
2	1600/23-24	सहोदरा	08/24	मोटरसाइकिल	DL75BZ-1357	PFZPFL07383	MD2A76A2ZPFL 07342	-
3	89/25-26	बीरतवा	152/24	स्कोटर ऑटो हेलिका	DL6CM-2462	CLS086166	TMB8DFNA1CG 024921	-
4	339/23-24	बनगा	189/23	बलेनो कार	DL12CN-7242	K12MN4433565	MA3EWB22S/G5 18782	सुमन बसलत तनेजा गिरा-मनसुज तनेजा सहा-अभ्येदकर नगर, जिला-दक्षिण दिल्ली

विवरित जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No. 007466 (Excise) 2026-27 नरो की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार। जिला पदाधिकारी, पश्चिम चम्पारण, बेतिया

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Chand Babu @ Baccha, S/o: Birbal, R/o: 308/9/39, Old Chandrawal, Civil Line, North Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.: 394/2025, U/s: 309(4)/309(6)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023, P.S. Timarpur, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Chand Babu @ Baccha** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Chand Babu @ Baccha** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Chand Babu @ Baccha of P.S. Timarpur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Karanbir Singh
JMFC-02, (Central), Room No. 26, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8788/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jyoti W/o Ramesh R/o Premises opposite to Plot No. 255, Ground & First Floor, Khakra No. 43/8, Indira Market, Najafgarh, New Delhi-110043** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **Ct. Case No. 153/2023 U/S 135 of Indian Electricity Act. at P.S. Baba Haridas Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Jyoti** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Jyoti** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.PC.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Jyoti** accused of **Ct. Case No. 153/2023 U/S 135 of Indian Electricity Act. at P.S. Baba Haridas Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **09.09.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Harleen Singh,
District & Sessions Judge (South-West),
Special Court Electricity, Court No. 609,
Dwarka Distt. Courts, New Delhi.

DP/9350/DW/2026

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Uttar Pradesh State Tourism Development Corporation Ltd. (UPSTDC) invites e-tenders for Selection of an Agency for Operation & Maintenance of Boat Jetty on the Bank of River Saryu, Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh

Interested Parties may download e-tender document from the e-tender website <https://etender.up.nic.in> from 11th July, 2026 and submit their proposals on e-tender portal latest by 27th July, 2026, 12:00 noon

Management reserves all rights to accept or reject any or all offers without assigning any reason and the decision shall be final.

MANAGING DIRECTOR

DEPARTMENT OF TOURISM
Government of Uttar Pradesh (India)
Paryatan Bhawan, C-13, Vipin Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow - 226010

UttarPradeshTourism UttarPradeshTourism uptourismgov.in UttarPradeshTourism

उत्तर प्रदेश पुलिस आवास निगम लि०
(उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार का एक उपक्रम)
पंजीकृत कार्यालय-बिहार नगर व्यवसायिक अयुध यार्ड-1
गोमती नगर सखन-226010
<https://uppoliceवासनigam.com/>

विज्ञापन संख्या-02/पुअनि-35/से०नि०का०अनु०/2025-26

विज्ञापित

उ०प्र० पुलिस आवास निगम लि० में रिक्त सहायक अभियन्ता (सिविल) एवं अन्य पदों पर अस्थायी रूप से नियत मानदेय पर सीमित अवधि हेतु सेवाये लिये जाने के सम्बन्ध में निगम द्वारा प्रकाशित विज्ञापन संख्या-०१/पुअनि-३५/से०नि०का०अनु०/२०२५-२६ विनांक- २७.०५.२०२६ को अपरिहार्य कारणांश एतद्वारा निरस्त किया जाता है।

निगम में अनुबन्धन नियुक्ति हेतु विस्तृत विज्ञापन निगम की वेबसाइट www.uppoliceवासनigam.com पर उपलब्ध है। मुख्य प्रशिक्षण निम्नवत है:-

- अनुबन्धन नियुक्ति की सम्भाव्यता ११ माह होगी।
- सहायक अभियन्ता (सिविल) के ०४ पर उपलब्ध हैं जिनको यथा आवश्यकतानुसार घटिया या बढ़िया या सकता है।
- लेखाकार का पद आरक्षित श्रेणी का है।

प्राप्त आवेदन पत्रों की शार्टलिस्टिंग करने के उपरान्त अर्ह पाये गये अभ्यर्थियों को साक्षात्कार हेतु बुलाया जायेगा। आवेदन प्राप्त करने की अन्तिम तिथि २०.०७.२०२६ है।

महाप्रबन्धक (परियोजना प्रबन्ध)
उ०प्र० पुलिस आवास निगम लि०

NORTHERN RAILWAY TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

Description	N.I.T.	17 & 19-2026-27-WV
1 Name of work with its location	17	Provision of VIP lounge by merging existing old vacant panel room & yard master room and Ladies waiting room in vacant CTNC office room and improvement of ating area by providing shed and seating arrangement for passengers at DEE Station in the section of SSEW/DEE under ADEN/DEE. Similar nature of work:- Any Civil work other than track work
2 Approx. Cost of work	17	Rs. 1299987.94
3 Earnest Money Deposit: (It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway Only. Note:- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no 201025/CE-I/CT/5/1 dated 31.08.2016)	19	Rs. 8499849.08
4 Completion period of Work	17	06 Months
5 Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender: Upto 15.00 hrs on 03.08.2026 Opening of tender at 15.00 hrs. On 03.08.2026	19	24 Months
6 Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc. Above tender available on IREPS site i.e www.ireps.gov.in	17	Rs. 226000.00
No. 128-W/280/OET/2026-27W-VNIT-17 & 19-2026-27 Date 08.07.26	19	Rs. 170000.00

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"IMPORTANT"

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Divisional Railway Manager (Engg), Chakradharpur acting For & On behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Open Tender. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Sl. No., Tender Notice No. & Name of works** are as follows: (1) **CKP-SOUTH-26-27-16**, Extension of line no-4 to facilitate full rake loading/unloading at one go in Barbil (BBN) station yard under jurisdiction of Sr. DEN(South)/CKP.(2nd Call). **Tender Value** : ₹ 3,37,08,568.71. **Earnest Money Deposit** : ₹ 6,74,200/-. **Date of Opening** : 30.07.2026. (2) **CKP-SOUTH-26-27-17**, Through Ballast Renewal for 19.981 TKM in Padapahar-Nayagarh section & for 25.644 TKM in Talaburu-Dangoposi section under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN(South)/CKP. (2nd Call). **Tender Value** : ₹ 2,36,33,555.82. **Earnest Money Deposit** : ₹ 4,72,700/-. **Date of Opening** : 30.07.2026. (3) **CKP-WEST-26-27-16**, Improvement in infrastructure facilities at Exchange yard Bondamunda. **Tender Value** : ₹ 21,44,22,457.57. **Earnest Money Deposit** : ₹ 42,88,500/-. **Date of Opening** : 31.07.2026. (4) **CKP-WEST-26-27-18**, Fire Safety Audit at (NSG-2) Tatanagar and Rourkela and NSG-3 Chakradharpur and Jharsuguda) Railway Stations under Chakradharpur Division. **Tender Value** : ₹ 15,09,220/-. **Earnest Money Deposit** : ₹ 30,200/-. **Date of Opening** : 30.07.2026. (5) **CKP-WEST-26-27-17**, Repair of roads at Bondamunda and Jharsuguda settlements under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN(West)/CKP. **Tender Value** : ₹ 3,30,09,536.45. **Earnest Money Deposit** : ₹ 6,60,200/-. **Date of Opening** : 03.08.2026. **Cost of Tender form** : ₹ 0 for each. The tender can be viewed at website : <http://www.ireps.gov.in> The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered under on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/ bidder can participate on e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. Note : e-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. (Authority-Rly. Bd.'s letter No. 2020/CE-I/CT/3E/GCC/Policy dtd. 16.07.2020) (PR-460)

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE, U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN), Jhansi
Email: seurbanjircircle@gmail.com
Mob. No.-9473942511

Letter No: 965 /F-03/129
Date: 09.07.2026</



ICAR-INDIAN VETERINARY RESEARCH INSTITUTE

IZATNAGAR- 243 122

Walk-in-interview

Walk in interview has been scheduled to be held at **Division of Biological Standardization, ICAR-IVRI, Izatnagar, Bareilly,** Uttar Pradesh **on 23.07.2026 at 10:30 AM** onwards for engagement of one **“Young Professional-II”** under ICAR-CRP funded project entitled **“Development of live attenuated indigenous genotype matched Newcastle disease virus vaccine”**. The engagement is purely on temporary/contractual basis. For details, please visit institute website: www.ivri.nic.in. Interested candidates can submit their biodata well in advance in the format mentioned in the site to vupmanyu17@gmail.com.

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TENDER NOTICE

STATE INSTITUTE OF HOTEL MANAGEMENT
TITILAGARH ROAD, BALANGIR - 767001 (ODISHA)

No.609/SIHM/2026-27/TENDERDate: 10.07.2026

Sealed tenders are invited under the Two-Bid System from reputed firms/agencies/companies/OEMs/authorized dealers/authorized distributors/ authorized channel partners having valid registrations and licenses for the Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning, and Comprehensive On-site Warranty Support of an Enterprise Tower Server along with Windows Server 2022 Standard Operating System, SQL Server 2022 Standard Edition or Latest Version, and Server Antivirus (3-Year Subscription) for the State Institute of Hotel Management, Balangir.

The sealed tender should reach the office of the Principal, State Institute of Hotel Management, Balangir (Odisha) - 767001 through Government Speed Post/Courier on or before 09.08.2026 up to 5.00 P.M. Late bids will not be entertained.

For detailed tender documents, eligibility criteria, technical specifications, and terms & conditions, visit www.sihmbalangir.org

Sd/-
Principal

HIGH COURT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH, SHIMLA-171001

HC-Advt./2026 (2) 20377Date: 04th July, 2026.

Website/ Recruitment portal for Online : <https://highcourt.hp.gov.in>

Recruitment Application (ORA) <https://www.hphcrecruitment.in/login>

“ADVERTISEMENT NOTICE”

The High Court of Himachal Pradesh invites Online Recruitment Applications (ORA) from all the eligible desirous candidates for filling-up following vacancies in the establishment of the High Court of HP:

1. Stenographer :
(Group-C)

Total-01 Post (Regular)
(01-SC)

2. Clerk/Proof Reader :
(Group-C)

Total-01 Post (Regular)
(01-PH)

For more information and detailed advertisement notice, kindly visit our website i.e., <https://highcourt.hp.gov.in>. Last date of receipt of Online Recruitment Application (ORA) is 31.07.2026 till 11:59 P.M.

Sd/-
REGISTRAR GENERAL

न्यायालय अपर जिला एवं सत्र न्यायाधीश-यष्टम गौतमबुद्धनगर	
सिविल प्रकीर्ण वाद संख्या- 128 सन्-2019	
National Highways Authority of India Through PIU-EPE-II Project Implementation Unit EPE-II, Noida. Urblech NPX Building, 4 th Floor, Sector-153, Noida, U.P.-701301	
..... Applicant	
VERSUS	
1. Azad Singh S/o Nepal, R/o Village Samauddinpur.	
2. Mam Chand S/o Pahlad, R/o Village Samauddinpur.	
3. Karam Chand S/o Pahlad, R/o Village Samauddinpur.	
4. Raj Singh S/o Nepal, R/o Village Samauddinpur	
Village Samauddinpur.	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 656	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-593.50	
5. Pawan Kumar S/o Dharam Pal, R/o Village Bairangpur.	
6. Prem Kumar W/o Dharam Pal, R/o Village Bairangpur.	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village Bairangpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 709	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-252	
7. Charta S/o Diyan R/o Village Dadupur	
8. Shubhash S/o Diyan R/o Village Dadupur	
9. Aruna minor age 14 years	
C/o Smt. Sunita Mata R/o Village Dadupur	
10. Sagar minor age 9 years C/o Smt Sunita Mata R/o Village Dadupur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Attai Muradpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 185	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -273.00	
11. Deep Chand S/o Prem Raj R/o Sec- 27. Noida	
12. Sumit Awana S/o Devendra R/o Sec- 27. Noida	
13. Smt. Siksha Widow of Late Sh. Devendra R/o Sec-27. Noida.	
14. Ankit Awana S/o Lal Chand R/o Sec-27. Noida.	
15. Smt. Poonam Widow of Late Sh. Lal Chand R/o Sec-27. Noida.	
16. Yogesh S/o Badie R/o Chuharpur	
17. Khadar Kumar S/o Badie R/o Chuharpur	
18. Khadar Pramod Kumar S/o Pahlad Singh R/o Choda Sadatpur	
19. Vinod Kumar S/o Pahlad Singh R/o Choda Sadatpur	
20. Roopchand S/o Munshi Singh R/o Village Atta Challera.	
21. Dhaniram S/o Chetram R/o village Amarpur	
22. Anand S/o Mange Ram R/o village Amarpur	
23. Azad S/o Mange Ram R/o village Amarpur	
24. Rahul S/o Mange Ram R/o village Amarpur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Amarpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D - 05.05.2017	
Survey No.-115	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-24544.00	
25. Devi Ram S/o Dilip R/o Village Dadupur	
26. Hans Raj S/o Pratap Devi Ram S/o Dilip R/o Village Dadupur	
27. Sukhveer S/o Chahat Devi Ram S/o Dilip R/o Village Dadupur	
28. Devi Ram S/o Dilip R/o Village Dadupur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Attai Muradpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 639	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -727.30	
29. Dhani Ram S/o Chet Ram, R/o Village Amarpur.	
.....Respondents/Land Owner	
Vill. -Amarpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 109	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-4000	
30. Gaggi Singh S/o Girwar Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
31. Rajveer Singh S/o Girwar Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
32. Omveer Singh S/o Girwar Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
33. Kunwar S/o Ramveer R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village - Imliyaka	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 108	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) 453.00	
34. Hans Raj S/o Pratap Singh R/o Village Dadupur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village -Attai Muradpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 638	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-429.00	
35. Jitendra S/o Gopi Chand R/o Village Amarpur	
36. Dharmendra S/o Gopi Chand 36 R/o Village Amarpur	
37. Rati Rem S/o Bhukad R/o Village Amarpur	
38. Zile S/o Ant Ram R/o village Amarpur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village -Amarpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 120	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -3725.00	
39. Kamal Singh S/o Ved Ram R/o Village Imliyaka	
40. Balveer Singh S/o Ved Ram R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Imliyaka	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 109	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) - 442.00	

.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village -Attai Muradpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 673	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -78.00	
70. Raghuwar Dayal S/o Pahlad, R/o Village Dadupur.	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village -Attai Muradpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 657	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -1247.50	
71. Ragwar S/o Likhi Ram R/o Village Imliyaka	
72. Leela S/o Likhi Ram R/o Village Imliyaka	
73. Hariya S/o Likhi Ram R/o Village Imliyaka.	
74. Chain Pal S/o Likhi Ram R/o Village Imliyaka	
75. Brijesh minor age 10 years S/o Kartar C/o Suman Mata, R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. Imliyaka	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 100	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -1207.00	
76. Rameshwari W/o Mam Chand R/o Chandawal Delhi	
77. Kailashe S/o Kheem Chand R/o Nagla Teh.	
78. Baghatpal S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal Delhi	
79. Bharam Singh S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal Delhi	
80. Om Prakash S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal Delhi	
81. Yograj S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal Delhi Mahendra Singh	
S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal. Delhi	
82. Raj Pal S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal Delhi.	
83. Raj Kumar S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal Delhi	
84. Veerendra Singh S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal Delhi	
85. Chandra Pal S/o Chatar Singh R/o Chandawal Delhi	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Rithaori	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 195	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-1716	
86. Richh Pal S/o Ram Saran R/o village Ladhpora	
87. Jayveer S/o Rishal R/o village Ladhpora.	
88. Sukhveer S/o Rishal R/o village Ladhpora.	
89. Vikram Singh S/o Rishal R/o village Ladhpora.	
90. Sanjay S/o Rishal R/o village Ladhpora.	
91. Ramveer Singh S/o Lekh Ram R/o village Ladhpora.	
92. Ranjeet Singh S/o Leki. Ram R / village ladhpora	
93. Satya Pal Singh S/o Munshi Singh R/o village Ladhpora	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village-Ladhpora	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 220	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) - 467.00	
94. Satveer S/o Hans Raj R/o Village Dadupur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Attai Muradpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 636	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -36.40	
95. Satyaveer S/o Mahipal R/o Village Imliyaka	
96. Yashveer S/o Mahipal R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Visaich	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 183	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) - 226.40	
97. Satyaveer S/o Mahipal R/o Village Imliyaka	
98. Yashveer S/o Mahipal R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village -Imliyaka	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 184	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-268.70	
99. Satyaveer S/o Mahipal R/o Village Imliyaka	
100. Yashveer S/o Mahipal R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Vasaich	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 185	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) 61.80	
101. Satyaveer Singh S/o Ved Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
102. Smt. Dharmwati beva Late Sh. Jaggu Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
103. Ram Singh S/o Roomal Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
104. Ashok Kumar S/o Megh Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
105. Yashveer S/o Mahi Pal R/o Village Imliavaka	
106. Bhram Pal S/o Lekha R/o Village Imliyaka	
107. Gyan Pal S/o Lekha R/o Village Imliyaka	
108. Gaurav minor S/o Ved Pal C/o Raj wala Mata R/o Village Imliyaka	
109. Aadesh minor S/o Ved Pal C/o Raj wala Mata R/o Village Imliyaka	
110. Smt. Raj Wala W/o Ved Pal R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Imliyaka	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 202	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) - 500.00	
111. Yogesh Soni S/o Raj Kumar Verma R/o Shaheed Bhagat Singh Marg, Railway Road Dadri.	
112. Chaman Kumar S/o Raj Kumar Verma R/o Shaheed Bhagat Singh Marg, Railway Road Dadri.	
113. Ravi Kurzar Verma S/o Devi Ram R/o Viasyna, Kasba Khanpur, Tehsil Khanpur, Bulandshah.	
114. Devendra Kumar S/o Devi Ram R/o Viasyna, Kasba Khanpur, Tehsil Khanpur, Bulands.nahr	
115. Sailu S/o Ashok Kumar, R/o Viasyna, Kasba Khanpur, Tehsil Khanpur, Bulands.nahr	
116. Rohit Verma S/o Ashok kumar, R/o Viasyna, Kasba Khanpur, Tehsil Khanpur, Bulands.nahr	
117. Smt. Santosh Widow of late Ashok kumar, R/o Viasyna, Kasba Khanpur, Tehsil Khanpur, Bulands.nahr.	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. Bairangpur (Nai Basti)	
Award-[18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 709	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-252.00	

Vill. -Amarpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D - 05.05.2017	
Survey No. -115	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-2454.00	
25. Devi Ram S/o Dilip R/o Village Dadupur	
26. Hans Raj S/o Pratap Devi Ram S/o Dilip R/o Village Dadupur	
27. Sukhveer S/o Chahat Devi Ram S/o Dilip R/o Village Dadupur	
28. Devi Ram S/o Dilip R/o Village Dadupur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Vill. -Attai Muradpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 639	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -727.30	
29. Dhani Ram S/o Chet Ram, R/o Village Amarpur	
.....Respondents/Land Owner	
Vill. -Amarpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 109	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-4000	
30. Gaggi Singh S/o Girwar Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
31. Rajveer Singh S/o Girwar Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
32. Omveer Singh S/o Girwar Singh R/o Village Imliyaka	
33. Kunwar S/o Ramveer R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village - Imliyaka	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D-05.05.2017	
Survey No. 108	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) 453.00	
34. Hans Raj S/o Pratap Singh R/o Village Dadupur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village -Attai Muradpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 638	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter)-429.00	
35. Jitendra S/o Gopi Chand R/o Village Amarpur	
36. Dharmendra S/o Gopi Chand 36 R/o Village Amarpur	
37. Rati Rem S/o Bhukad R/o Village Amarpur	
38. Zile S/o Ant Ram R/o village Amarpur	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	
Village -Amarpur	
Award [18.07.2017]	
Date of Notification U/s 3D 05.05.2017	
Survey No. 120	
Area of Land (In Sq. Meter) -3725.00	
39. Kamal Singh S/o Ved Ram R/o Village Imliyaka	
40. Balveer Singh S/o Ved Ram R/o Village Imliyaka	
.....Respondents/Land Owners	

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,SHAKIL AHMAD,S/O
HAQIMUL,R/O-VILL MAHILA,
KATHIHAR,,BIHAR-854105,HAVE
CHANGED MY NAME, FROM
SHAKILUR RAHMAN AND
SHAKILOOR RAHMAN TO
SHAKIL AHMAD. 0040865287-5

We, Uday Kumar Singh &
Anamika Kumar, R/o House No.
722, Tulip Tower, SKA Metro
Ville, Sector-Eta-II, Greater
Noida, Distt. G.B. Nagar, UP-
201310 state that my minor
son's correct name & date of
birth as Shipirist Kumar &
27.07.2012. 0040865157-1

I,hitherto known as PURU,S/O-
GURUDEV SINGH,R/O-RZ-
1119C,GALI NO-10,SADH-
NAGAR,PALAM COLONY,SOUTH
WEST,DELHI-110045,have
changed my name and shall
hereafter be known as PURU
SIDHUH 0040865286-9

I, Dhuliyah Wakhala S/o Muhna
R/o Bor Faliya, VTC Khutuja
Bada, PO- Badakhuntaja,
Bhavra, Dist-Airajpur, Madhya
Pradesh-457882, have changed
my minor son's name from
Ashivan aged 13 years to
Manish Vakhla forever
0071046881-1

I, Km Seenu Kumar, w/o Gaurav
Kumar, R/o Village-Kasumi,
post-Soi Pahasu, Tehsil
Shikarpur, District
Bulandshahr, UP, have
changed my name to Seenu for
all future purposes.
0071046926-1

I,PUSP RAJ THAKUR,S/o Hans
Raj/R/O E-40/3,Gali No.5,Rama-
vihar Mohammed Pur Majri
Karala Delhi-110081,have
changed my name to
PUSHPRAJ TANWAR
0040865286-2

I Ashish Kumar Mittal S/o Vinod
Kumar Gupta R/o VVIP Homes,
D-404, Tower D, Gaur City-2,
Next to Gaur City-2, 14th
Avenue, GC-3K, GH-3, Bishrakh,
Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar
Pradesh-201306 have changed
my name from Ashish Kumar
Mittal to Aashish Mittar for all
future Purposes. 0071046852-1

I,Rishikesh Sharma S/O Prem
Sagar Sharma R/O H.No.122,
VPO-Rithala, Rohini, Delhi-
110085, have changed my
minor daughter name from
Aaroshi Sharma to Aarohi
Sharma. 0040865317-4

I, Sabitri Sharma W/o No
13611531P Rank Ex HAV (Late)
Anand Prasad Sharma R/O C-
224/4, Gali No-9, Bhajanpura,
Garhi Mendu Po- Bhajan pura,
Dist: North East Delhi, Delhi-
110053 have changed my name
to Savitri Sharma vide affidavit
date 8-7-26 before Delhi.
0071046900-1

I,SMT.SHRAVAN KUMARI,W/O-
VINOD KUMAR,R/O-
359/7,GALI NO.3, NEAR-
RAVIDAS MANDIR,MANDAWALI
FAZALPUR,EAST-DELHI,DELHI-
110092,has modified/changed
my name. She may hereafter
be known as SMT. SHREWEN
KUMARI. 0040865287-7

I,Anil Kumar Gupta s/o-Maman
Chand, R/o E-13, First Floor,
Bhagwan Dass Nagar, East
Punjabi Bagh, New Delhi-
110026, have changed my name
to Anil Gupta. 0040865214-1

I Asha Chandrakant Pawar R/At:
H.No. 1167, Sinhadag Road,
Lamanwadi, Khadakwasla,
Pune-411024, have changed my
Date of Birth Twenty Fourth
June Nineteen Seventy Five to
Twelve September Nineteen
Seventy Five, Vide Gazette No.
P-2653376. 0071046840-1

I, HINA, W/o MOHD NASEEM,
R/o- 3/19, GALI NO.-8,
GURUDWARA
MOHALLA,MAUJPUR, DELHI-
110053, have changed my name
from HINA SIDDIQUI to HINA,
for all purposes. 0040865311-1

I, SHEETAL TYAGI, declare that
SANJAY KUMAR TYAGI (in Govt
IDS) and SANJAY TYAGI (in Edu
docs) are one and the same
person, i.e., my father. Certified
vide Affidavit dated 06-July-2026
0130066659-1

I, Rajesh Kumar Singh Residing
at Flat No. 47-C, Ana Enclave
Mayur Vihar Phase-I, New
Delhi-110091, That I am the
Father of SHREYA, aged about
15 Years, That I have decided to
change my daughter's name
from SHREYA to SHREYA SINGH
for all future purposes,
records, and correspondences.
0040865281-1

I,Ishan S/o Shri Pawan Kumar
Singh R/o Flat No.204, TDI City,
Tower S-3, Kundli Industrial
Estate, District Sonitap,
Haryana have changed my
name to Ishan Singh for all
purposes. 0040865150-2

I,RENU D/O Gorakh Prasad
Sahani,R/O-34 and 34,Ram-
Chander Enclave,First
Floor,Mohan Garden,Delhi-
110059,have changed my name
to RENU SAHANI and also my
correct-DOB is 21.09.1982
0040865286-4

I Sushma Khanna w/o Rajesh
Kumar Khanna r/o C-51, DDA
Flats, JahangirPuri, Delhi-33,
have changed my name from
Sushma Rani Khanna to Sushma
Khanna for all purposes.
0040865178-1

I, GITIKA SANDEEP THAPLIYAL
D/O HARESH HIRANI R/O A 203
MANGAL APARTMENTS
VASUNDHARA ENCLAVE NEAR
CHILLA SPORTS COMPLEX
VASUNDHARA ENCLAVE EAST
DELHI 110096 have changed my
name GITIKA THAPLIYAL for all
future purpose
0071046847-1

I, PARBA KUMARI D/o No.
7055490 Rank Ex HAV Name
(Late) RAJENDRA PRASAD
THAPLIYAL R/O B-1/85 KIRAN
GARDEN, GALI NO-20, MOHAN
GARDEN, D.K. MOHAN GARDEN,
DELHI-110059 have changed
my name to PRABHA DEVI PANT
vide affidavit date 8-7-2026
before Delhi. 0071046904-1

I,DEEPA SHARMA,W/O-ROHIT
SHARMA,R/O,0.363,MAIN-17 FEET
ROAD M.B.EXTN
BADARPUR,NEW-DELHI-
110044,HAVE CHANGED MY
NAME TO DEEPA JANGID FOR
ALL FUTURE PURPOSE
0040865287-9

I TARANG BURMAN W/O JAYESH
BHARAT BURMAN R/O A-503,
EXOTICA FRESCO, SECTOR-137,
NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR,
UTTAR PRADESH-201301 HAVE
CHANGED MY NAME TO
TARANG JAYESH BURMAN FOR
ALL THE FUTURE PURPOSE.
0071046843-1

I,Deepa Rajput,D/o Sureshr
Singh,W/o Mr. Subhash
Chand,R/O C-28,Gali
No.5,Ashok-Vihar Phase-3
Extn.,Gurgaum,Haryana-
122001, have changed my name
to Deepa Chauhan
0040865311-3

It is for general information that
I, Subhajit Das S/o Ravinder
Nath R/O Bidhan Park, Block- D,
Jora Mandir, Barasat, Barasat
(M), North 24 Parganas, West
Bengal- 700124, declare that
name of my father has been
wrongly written as Rabi Das in
my 10th and 12th Class School
Certificate cum Marksheet,
Pan Card No.- BMGPD7646L and
Passport No.- A1194295. The
actual name of my father is
Ravinder Nath, which may be
amended accordingly.
0071046885-1

I,AMIT KUMAR S/O-SIYARAM
TIWARI,R/O- F-
204,MAYURDHWAJ
APARTMENT I,EXTENSION
PATPARGANJ,DELHI-
110092,HAVE CHANGED MY
NAME TO AMIT TIWARI FOR ALL
PURPOSES 0040865311-5

I, Jaskaran Singh S/o Lt. Sh.
Attar Singh R/O H.No.228, N-
Block, Mangolpuri, Delhi-83 has
been wrongly written as
Jaskaran in my Son's Namely
Hritik Singh Educational
Documents (CBSE Xth Roll No.
25111984 & Xlth Roll
No.25616431). The actual name
of mine is Jaskaran Singh
respectively which may be
amended accordingly.
0040865282-2

I,JEENES MARRY JOSEPH,D/O-
JOSEPH POWATHIKUNNEL
ABRAHAM,R/O-C-101A
UPPER,GROUND-FLOOR BACK
SIDE,SOM BAZAR-ROAD
JEEWAN-PARK UTTAM-
NAGAR,DELHI-110059,have
changed my name to JEENES
MARY JOSEPH,for all,future
purpose. 0040865287-2

I, Ahju Goyal, W/o Harish Goel,
R/o D7/5, Sector-6, Rohini,
Delhi-110085, have changed my
name to Anju Goel, for all
purposes. 0040865152-1

I,Divya Ahlawat,W/o-Rajiv
Ahlawat-R/O B-803,Howelia-
Valenova-Park,Amrapali
Dream-Village,Techzone-
4,Greater Noida
West,G.B.Nagar,U.P.201318,hav
e changed my name,from
Divya Ahlawat to Divya
Tavethya for all future
purposes. 0040865286-6

I, Pramila Kumar W/o Sanjay
Kumar R/O-328, Vartalok
Apartment, Sec-4C,
Vasundhara, Ghaziabad have
changed my name to Pramila
Chauhan. 0071046874-1

I, Birmi Balmiki W/o No.
4426472A Rank TS NK (Late)
Satpal Singh R/O F-4/239,
Sultanpuri, Delhi-110086 have
changed my name to Birmi vide
affidavit date 8-7-26 before
Delhi. 0071046908-1

I, Shazia Asthana, R/o H-32A,Top
Floor, Kalkaji, New Delhi,
declare that "Shalu" appearing
in my son Ayaan Asthana's
Birth Certificate is my alias and
both names pertain to me. I
confirm that Shalu alias Shazia
Asthana is the same person
0050292942-1

I,Govind Kumar
Updhyay(existing name of
dependent as per
NOK/POR/IAFF(P)5,S/o Late
Ramcharan Updhyay and
father of Mr.Harendra Kumar
Updhyay,R/o Village-
Tarapur,Post-Gonda,Distt-
Aligarh, U.P.-201213,Have
changed my name from Govind
Kumar Updhyay to Govind
Updhyay,That Govind Kumar
Updhyay Govind Updhyay
both are one and same person.
0040865287-11

I, GUDHIYA W/O AJAY
VINDHYACHAL ROY R/O 178
AND 179 K H NO 12/4/01, DEEP
ENCLAVE PART -2 NEAR VEER
BAZAR VIKAS NAGAR,
VIKASपुरी D.K MOHAN
GARDEN WEST DELHI 110059
have changed my name
GURIYA ROY for all future
purpose 0071046845-1

I Govindrappa Rudrappa Barker
S/o Rudrappa R/O Hiregunjal,
Dharwad Hiregunjal,
Karnataka - 581117, have
changed my name to
Govindappa Rudrappa Barker
0071046848-1

I, RAM BAHADUR BHUJEL S/O SH.
DAL BAHADUR BHUJEL R/O R-
101, STREET NO.3, VIKAS
NAGAR,UTTAM NAGAR, NEW
DELHI-110059 declare that RAM
BAHADUR BHUJEL S/O SH. DAL
BAHADUR BHUJEL and R.B.
BHUJEL S/O D.B. BHUJEL are the
name of mine and my father
respectively. Both the names
pertain to same and one
person. 0040865233-1

I,SHASHIKANT SAINI S/o
Gangaprasad R/o 222, Agota,
Bulandshahr Uttar Pradesh -
203001, have changed my name
to SHASHI KANT permanently.
0040865287-4

I, Abhishek Chowdhary S/O Sh.
Joginder Choudhary, R/O 1786,
Second Floor, Outram Lane,
GTB Nagar, Delhihi-110009, have
changed my name from
Abhishek Choudhary to
Abhishek Chowdhary, for all
future purposes. 0040865155-1

I,Kanta Devi w/o-Anil Gupta,
R/O-28-B, Madan Park, East
Punjabi Bagh, New Delhi-26,
have changed my name to
Kanta Gupta. 0040865214-2

I,Satendra Joshi,S/o Banwari Lal
Joshi,R/O 104,Bhagyodaya Guru
Krapa,Appt, Mahavidya
Colony,Phase-2,Ahilya Ganj
Bangar,Mathura,have changed
my name to Satendra Kumar
Joshi. 0040865286-8

I, Santosh Kumar Gawande S/o
Mahadev Gawande R/o
Gorakhar, Kolgaon, Betul,
Madhya Pradesh - 460001, have
changed my minor son's name
from Chetan Gawande Aged 15
Years to Chirag Gawande
forever 0071046880-1

I, Ajay Kumar S/O R.S Srivastava
R/ B-204 Aakash Enclave
Virindavan Yojana Sec-6
Lucknow UP-226029 have
changed my name to Ajai
Kumar for all purposes.
0071046911-1

I, Asha Rani Gupta, W/o Late
Inder Sen Gupta, R/o D-29,
Sector-55, Noida, UP-201301,
have changed my name to
ASHA GUPTA for all future
purposes. 0071046829-1

I,SWATI DHEER/SWATI,W/o Anil
Sahni,R/O Flat No.75 1st Floor
Vikas Sheel Apartment
Sector-13,Rohini Delhi-
110085,have changed my name
to SWATI SAHNI 0040865286-1

I Monika Keddia D/o Ram Avtar
Kedia and W/o Rakesh Jain R/o
D-11, Hakikat Rai Road, Adarsh
Nagar, Delhi-110033, have
changed my name to Monica
Jain for all purposes
0071046849-1

I,Saeed Ahmed S/o Shamsuddin
residing at t-358, Karampara
New Delhi-110015 declare that
my wife's name is incorrectly
spelled as Naz Mijra in my
passport. The correct name of
my wife is Mizra which is
supported by her official
documents. Henceforth she
shall be known as Mizra for all
purposes. 0040865317-3

I Nitin Tyagi,W/O Prashant
kumar, R/O Greater Noida,
kulesara,Gautam buddha
nagar, U.P. have changed my
name from Neetu Tyagi to Nitin
Tyagi. Henceforth I would be
known by the name of Nitin
Tyagi for all future purposes
0071046897-1

I,Vijay Kumar,S/o-Late
Sh.Mukesh Kumar And Late
Smt Suman Lata, R/O-H.No.616-
A,First-Floor,Chirag-Delhi,New
Delhi-110017,have changed my
sister name SUNITA CHOCHAN
to DASUNITA,for all,future
purposes. 0040865287-6

I,Mohammad Sagir S/O,Mohd.
Saddiq R/O,F-359/13,Chand
Bagh, Dayalpur,North East
Delhi-110094,Have Changed My
Name To Mohd. Sagir For All
Purposes. 0040865286-10

I, Tina Wesley w/o Manish
Wesley R/O 1093/1/80 St. John's
Church Compound, Mehrauli,
N.D.-30 have changed my name
to TEENA WESLEY vide affidavit
Dtd:09.07.2026 sworn before
Notary Subhash Chand
Sharma, Delhi 0130066658-1

I, DAYANAND SHUKLA alias
DAYA NAND S/O. DEV NARAYAN
SHUKLA R/O HOUSE NO.1240,
SHRI SHRI LAXMI NARAYAN
MANDIR, SOUTH AVENUE
MARKET, NIRMAM BHAWAN,
DELHI-110001 have changed my
name from DAYANAND SHUKLA
alias DAYA NAND S/O DEO
NARAYAN to DAYANAND
SHUKLA S/O DEV NARAYAN
SHUKLA for all purposes.
0040865161-1

I Parvez S/o Vizarat Hussain, R/o
S-15/4, Fourth Floor, Joga Bai
Extension, Jamia Nagar, New
Delhi-110025 have changed my
name to Parvez Zaidi for all
purposes. 0040865150-1

I,Gopal Krishan S/O Ram Kishan
R/O B/6/349 SECTOR-7,ROHINI
NORTH WEST DELHI 110085
HAVE CHANGED Name to Mr
Maresh Chand 0040865286-3

I, SOURABH KANDHARI, S/O SHRI
BHARAT KUMAR KANDHARI,
R/O BJ-76, WEST SHALIMAR
BAGH, DELHI-110088, changed
my name from SOURABH
KANDHARI to SAURABH
KANDHARI for all purposes.
0071046902-1

I,JAYESH BURMAN S/O BHARAT
CHHABIDAS BURMAN R/O A-
503, EXOTICA FRESCO, SECTOR-
137, NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDH
NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-
201301 HAVE CHANGED MY
NAME TO JAYESH BHARAT
BURMAN FOR ALL THE FUTURE
PURPOSE. 0071046842-1

I,Vimlesh Kumar Kanth,S/o
Sh.Ram Sharan Kanth,R/o
House-No-08,Gali No-
13A,Yumuna Enclave,22
Killa,Gali.No13A,Pride Public
School,Dheeraj
Nagar,Tilpat,Faridabad
Haryana-121003,have changed
my,name Vimlesh Kumar to
Vimlesh Kumar Kanth,,for
all,future purposes.
0040865311-6

I Hitherto Known as Yachna W/O
Ayush Jaiwal R/O H. No-262,
Sector-14, Rohtak, Haryana
124001 Have Changed My Name
and Shall Hereafter Be Known
as Yachna Kaushik Jaiwal.
0040865311-6

I Esmina Xess D/o Bhagan Ram
Xess R/o Ward No-3, Dakaipara
Odgi Naka, VTC-
Baikhuntapur, Distt- Koriya,
Chhattisgarh- 497335, have
changed my name to Ismina
Khes. 0071046883-1

I, Amita Kaur W/o Sh. Jaskaran
Singh R/o H.No.225, N-Block,
Mangolpuri, Delhi-83 has been
wrongly written as Amita in
my Son's Namely Hritik Singh
Educational Documents (CBSE
Xth Roll No. 25111984 & XIth
Roll No.25616431). The actual
name of mine is Amita Kaur
respectively which may be
amended accordingly.
0040865282-1

I,PRACHI JAIN W/O RAHUL
JAIN,R/O-house number-6
sector-12 vasundhara
Ghaziabad-201012,have
changed my name to PRACHI
CHAUHAN permanently
0040865287-1

I,Aman Rana,Father of
minor,daughter Amaira
Rana,R/o Flat no.11101,Block
Ebony,GH-04,Sector-
16C,Mahagan Mywoods,
Greater-Noida West,G.B.
Nagar,U.P.201318, have
corrected-my minor daughter
date.of.birth from 24-06-2015
to 24-06-2014. 0040865286-5

I, SYED SHAKIR JAMIL NAQVI
S/O LATE ZAHOOORUL HASAN,
R/O RZ-3202, UPPER GROUND,
STREET NO-36, GATE NO-6,
JAMIA HAMDARD,
TUGHLAKABAD EXTN.
KALKAJI, SOUTH DELHI 110019,
INDIA, HAVE CHANGED MY
NAME TO SHAKIR JAMIL FOR
ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.
0040865159-1

I, BHARAT KUMAR, S/O SHRI
RATTAN CHAND, R/O BJ-76,
WEST SHALIMAR BAGH, DELHI-
110088, changed my name
from BHARAT KUMAR to
BHARAT KUMAR KANDHARI
for all purposes. 0071046906-1

I,Amit Kumar S/o Swadesh
Kumar,R/O A-10/120,Street No-
10,Near Power
House,Bhajanpura,Garhi
Mendu,Delhi-110053,my Son
Atharv Choudhary School
Records his name is
Written/Mentioned as
Aathrav Choudhary instead of
Atharv Choudhary,Which may
be amended accordingly.
0040865287-10

I, AJAY VINDYACHAL ROY S/O
PRABHUNATH SINGH R/O
SARANAGARH ROAD ATAL
CHOWK CHHATTANAGRA PO
CHHATTANAGRA RAIGARH
CHHATTISGARH 496001 have
changed my name AJAY
VINDHYACHAL ROY for all
future purpose 0071046844-1

I,Kulvir Singh S/o, Palvirinder
Singh R/o.Flat No-C-4/2,Kh No-
105/10,3rd floor,Street No.116,
Block-B,Sant Nagar,Burari,
Delhi-110084,have changed my
name to KULDEEP SINGH
permanently 0040865311-4

I Prashant Kumar, S/o
Mahendra Singh Tyagi, R/O
Greater Noida, kulesara,
Gautam buddha nagar, U.P.
have changed my name from
Prashant Tyagi to Prashant
kumar. Henceforth I would be
known by the name of
Prashant kumar for all future
purposes 0071046887-1

I, YOGITA SHUKLA alias GEETA
SHUKLA W/o. DAYANAND
SHUKLA R/O 39-A, DDA JANTA
FLATS, PHASE-2, KATWARIA
SARAI, HAUZ KHAS, DELHI -
110016 have changed my name
from YOGITA SHUKLA alias
GEETA SHUKLA to YOGITA
SHUKLA W/o DAYANAND
SHUKLA for all purposes.
0040865160-1

I,GURWANT SINGH,S/O-
HARBHAJAN SINGH ANAND,
R/O-1526A HOUSING BOARD-
COLONY SECTOR-
29,FARIDABAD-121008,HAVE
CHANGED MY NAME
GURWANT SINGH AN

UPGRADATION OF STATION ILLUMINATION AT KATHIHAR DIVISION

Tender Notice No. EL/29/46
2028/K/806 Date: 08-07-2026.

Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below: **Tender No. 46, 2026. Name of work:** Upgradation of Station Illumination for Improvement in Passenger Amenities Facility at Stations under the jurisdiction of SSE/EL/CT/PIC/Malda Town & Siliguri
Estimate Value: ₹6,33,77,476/-
Estimated Money: ₹12,67,600/-
Date of time of closing of tender: At 15.00 hrs. and opening at 15.30 hrs. on 30-07-2026. The complete information with tender documents above tender will be available in the website www.irps.gov.in

Sr. DEE/ G & Chg, Kathihar
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

 JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU 0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in		
Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191		
SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Daropiti Devi alias Bina W/O Late Daitree Behra R/O Bena Panjari Tehsil Khurda District Khurda, Oddisa is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 221/2017 U/S 8/15 NDPS Act P/S Nagrota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded. It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact/Telephone numbers.		
Description Roll :- Name :- Daropiti Devi alias Bina W/O :- Late Daitree Behra Address:- Bena Panjari Tehsil Khurda District Khurda, Oddisa Age :- 38 years Height:- 5'4" Complexion :- Wheatish Eyes :- Brown		
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:- 1. DPO, Jammu :- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578 2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D. :- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in 3. PCR Jammu :- 0191-2605949 4. SP Rural Jammu :- 0191-2605949 5. SDPO Nagrota:- 0191-2673666 6. SHO P/S Nagrota:- 0191-2673025		
For Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu Date:- .07.2026		
DIP/J-5477/26, DATE:- 10 JULY 2026		

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)					
The Executive Engineer HP.PWD., Division Naudaun District Hamirpur H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed below on the table below:-					
Sr. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.)	Starting Date for downloading Bid	EMD (Rs.)	Deadline for Submission of Bid
1	Upgradation/Improvement of various roads in the campus of Dr RKGMC Hamirpur at Jolsapur from KM 0/00 to 6/090. (SH: ROFD for 7/9 mtr wide, R/wall/breast walls, CD , Cement Concrete pavement , drain Parapets & Road Furniture, Dumping sites etc. 0/00 to 3/00. Time Limit:- Nine Months Cost of tender form: 10000/-	9,18,08,789/-	17-07-2026 from 10:30 AM	18,36,200/-	25-07-2026 upto 10:30 AM

		ONLINE TENDERING Project Implementation Unit, Gandhinagar (Health & Family Welfare Dept.) TENDER NOTICE PI-U/2026-27				
Online tenders for Health Care facilities Civil works of Various Districts Gujarat as below are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Project Implementation Unit, NRHM/PIU Building 4th Floor, Civil Hospital Campus, Gandhinagar-382012, Ph. 079-23231434, 23231393, www.tender.nprocure.com						
Sr. No.	Name of Work	Est.Cost in Lacs (Rs.)	(1) Tender Fee (2) EMD(Rs.)	Approved Regst. Class	Time Limit in Months	ID NO
1	New Construction Of 30 Bedded Ayush Hospital At.-Atkot, TA.-Jasdan, Dist.-Rajkot	832.08	(1) 12,000 (2) 8,32,300	A A Class & SP Building Cat.-I	11	8358
Pre Bid Dtd 23.07.2026 up to 12.00 hrs On Line Submission Dtd. 13.08.2026 upto 18.00 hrs.				Submission of Tender Fee, EMD & Other Original Documents on Dtd 13.08.2026 Online (Documents Shall have to be Scanned & put up Online. The Original Documents shall have to be submitted within 7 days through R.P.A.D only) Bid Opening of tender dtd 14.08.2026 upto 12.00 hrs.		
				INF-850-2026-27		

e-Procurement Cell OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER BUILDING CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT BUILDING DIVISION No. – 1, RANCHI (Behind State Guest House Morhabadi) Dindyal Nagar Booty Road Ranchi-834008				
Very Short-Term e-Procurement Notice				
Sl. No.	Tender Reference No.	Work Name	Amount (Rs.)	Completion Time
1	BCD/Div.No.-1, Ranchi/36/2026-27	Construction of Market Shade with Toilet, Deep Boring, PCC Road and Solar Light in the Campus of Agriculture Market, Oramanji Near Thana, Ranchi	15120700	Three Month
2	BCD/Div.No.-1, Ranchi/37/2026-27	Construction of Market Shade with Toilet, Deep Boring, PCC Road and Solar Light in the Campus of Agriculture Market, Lapung, Sapukera Bazar, Ranchi	15120700	Three Month
3	BCD/Div.No.-1, Ranchi/38/2026-27	Construction of Market Shade with Toilet, Deep Boring, PCC Road and Solar Light in the Campus of Agriculture Market, Naro Nagri, Ranchi	15120700	Three Month
4	BCD/Div.No.-1, Ranchi/39/2026-27	Construction of Market Shade with Toilet, Deep Boring, PCC Road and Solar Light in the Campus of Agriculture Market, Bero Bazartand, Ranchi	10461573	Three Month
5	Start Date of Submission of Bids		18-07-2026 at 11.00 AM	
6	Last Date/Time of Submission of Bids		27-07-2026 at 11.00 AM	
7	Date/Time of Opening of Bid		28-07-2026 at 11.00 AM	
8	Helpline Number of e-procurement Cell		8527519262	
9	e-mail ID		eebcddiv1ranchi@gmail.com	

NORTHERN RAILWAY

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE
OF THE ACCUSED (Section 84 of the
Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita - BNSS)**

It is hereby informed to the general public that the accused Mohit Kumar S/o Umesh Kumar R/o AWARAGARD FOOTPATH DELHI, has committed (or is suspected to have committed), a punishable offence in Case No. 01/25 under Section 3 of the RP (UP) Act, under the jurisdiction of the Railway Protection Force (RPF), Safdarjung, Delhi.

Arrest warrants issued against him were affixed at the afore mentioned address on various occasions, yet no information regarding the accused, Mohit Kumar, has been obtained so far and it has been duly shown to me that the said Mohit Kumar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant)

Therefore, a proclamation is hereby made that the said Mohit Kumar is required to appear before this Court (or before me) to answer the said complaint on or before 17.08.2026.

By order
Vaibhav Garg,
Magistrate First Class, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

2376/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

E-AUCTION

Asper Section 130 and Section 68(3) of the GGST Act- 2017 and CGST Act-2017, the State Tax Department's Mehsana Mobile Squad detained vehicle number RJ27GE9146 at the GST Office, Mehsana on 14/06/2026. Upon inspection, Unmanufactured Tobacco was found in the vehicle. These goods have been confiscated under Section 130 of the GGST and CGST Acts.

A public e-auction of the confiscated goods has been scheduled to take place on 18/07/2026, from 11:00 AM to 01:00 PM. The revenue generated from this auction will be deposited into the government treasury.

Details regarding the auction will be available on The State Tax Department's official website: www.commercialtax.gujarat.gov.in and (n) Code Solution's auction website: <https://nprocure.com> For assistance, (n) Code Solution's helpline number is: Toll-Free: 7359021663.

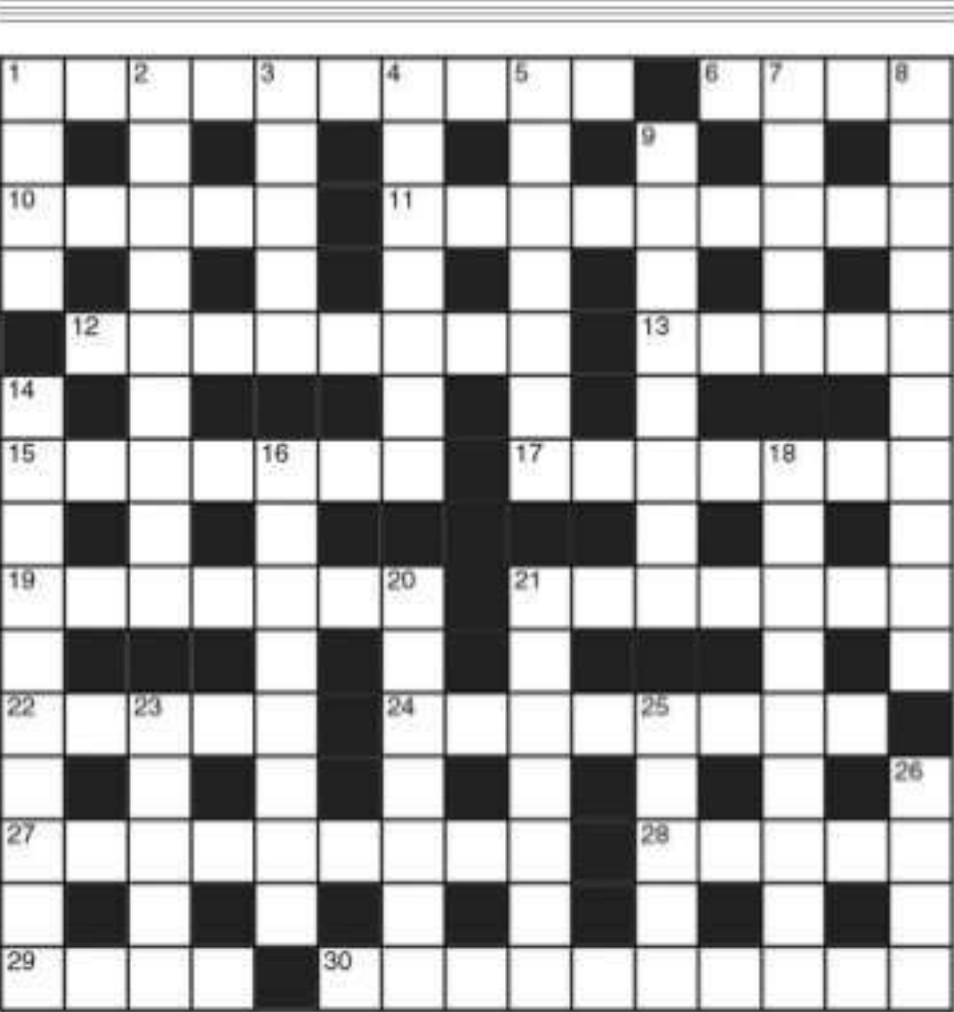
As the auction will be conducted online through e-auction, participants must obtain a Digital Signature Certificate (DSC). To acquire the DSC, participants are required to contact: (n) Code Solution, Gift City Tower 1, Zone-5, Gandhinagar. Without a valid Digital Signature Certificate, participation in the auction will not be permitted.

Place : Mehsana
Date : 11.07.2026

(P.R. Rathod)
State Tax Officer,
Mehsana Mobile Squad
Div-4, Mehsana
DDI-MEH-156-2026-27

CENTRAL RAILWAY	
REPAIR AND MAINTENANCE WORK	
Open e-tender notice No.CR-DRM(W)BB-2026-35 of 08.07.2026.	
Sr.No.1. Name of work -CSMT-KYN: Tunnel protection arrangement above tunnel portal at Parsik tunnel and Nutan tunnel. Approximate Value Rs.1502.55 lakhs EMD Rs. 3005100/- Completion period -12 months.	
Sr.No.2. Name of work - Loading, unloading and Transportation of switch, Seel,Rail/Crossing and fittings from various stations and yards in CSMT-KYN section under Sr.DEN(S) to Hajibundar scrap yard. Approximate Value Rs.137.79 Lakhs EMD Rs. 275600/- Completion period -12 months.	Sr.No.3. Name of work - (A)Renovation of RPF surveillance room above mainline concourse toilet at CSMT. (B)Badhwar Park- Periodical and Regular Internal Painting of Officers' Quarters for the Year 2025-26. (C)CSMT-Internal & External Painting of Service Buildings of Old Annex building, New Annex building, GM building, New Administrative building (NAB) and 4th & 5th floor of parcel building at CSMT. (D) Sess Lowering Work from Platform Edges up to 20 m and 0.7 m Depth of PF-1 to PF-18 at CSMT.Approximate Value Rs.301.49 Lakhs EMD Rs. 603000/- Completion period -12 months.
Sr.No.4. Name of work - (Ghansoli, Rabale, Seawood-Darave, Bamanandongri & Kharkopar : Repairs to Railway offices & Toilets, Platform wall , Coping & platform surface, COP, Valley Gutter, Downtake pipes, Staircase, Subway, Wall tiles, Facility for Divyangjan on platforms, Toilets, Water booth, Platform name boards & Signboards including complete painting at Ghansoli Railway Station under DEN (HB)/CSMT.Approximate Value Rs.849.90 Lakhs EMD Rs. 1699800/- Completion period -12 months.	
Sr.No.5. Name of work- Juinagar & Sanpada : Repairs to Railway offices & Toilets, Platform wall , Coping & Platform surface, COP, Valley Gutter, Downtake pipes, Staircase, Subway, Wall tiles, Facility for Divyangjan on platforms, Toilets, Water booth, Platform name boards & Signboards including complete painting at Nerul & Airoli Railway Station under DEN (HB)/CSMT section. Approximate Value Rs.973.92 Lakhs EMD Rs. 1947800/- Completion period -12 months.	
Sr.No.6. Name of work- Supply of portable drinking water through road tankers for Sanpada carshed, J.N.I Railway Colony, Turbhey colony, Gawan to Uran Railway station and various location in ADEN/(M)/J.N.I & ADEN/(M)/MKNK Section under Sr. DEN(HB) CSMT section. Approximate Value Rs.47.05 Lakhs EMD Rs. 94100/- Completion period -12 months.	
Sr.No.7. Name of work -MSD -PNVL:- Strengthening/rehabilitation of major & minor bridges in MasjidPanvel, Thane-Vashi&Nerul-Kharkopar section, PH-32, RRSK, (IRPSM 001.002.32.25.31.044). Approximate Value Rs.556.05 Lakhs EMD Rs. 1112100/- Completion period -12 months	
I) Tender closing date & time of aforesaid tender: Up-to 15.00 hrs. of Sr.No.1,2 and 6 & 7 on 28.07.2026, Sr.No.3 on 24.07.2026, Sr.No.4 & 5 on 31.07.2026 to be opened after 15.00 hrs. II) The prospective tenderers are requested to visit the website www.ireps.gov.in for details of tenders & corrigendum, if any. III) Tenderer may participate in above e-tender electronically through website www.ireps.gov.in only & submission of manual offers against e-tender are not allowed. Manually, if submitted shall neither be opened nor considered. IV) The Bid Security shall be deposited either in cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in tender documents. V) For further enquiry, may contact, Divisional Railway Manager (Works) Office, Central Railway on phone. 022-67455323. VI) This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy Order 2017 dated 16-9-2017. Complete details of tenders are available at the website " www.ireps.gov.in ". The complete details of tenders are also available in the "Notice Board" of the Divisional Railway Manager (Works) Office, Mumbai CSMT.	

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 Consenting by letter (10)
6 It is dry in the Kalahari Desert (4)
10 Cadet behaved badly (5)
11 Call to mind (2,7)
12 Being virtuous, he has spoken in some obscurity (8)
13 When dancers take them they're on the level (5)
15 Greed for caviare spread (7)
17 The head cleaner (7)
19 No mean poet! (7)
21 Spinning the hardest yarns (7)
22 Maps some mountains (5)
24 Associates with swindling types (8)
27 Hasty article written about corporal punishment (9)
28 Girl given ring might be thrown over by cowboy (5)
29 Stone jar (4)
30 They step on many feet (10)
- DOWN
- 1 Perform song with piano introduction (4)
2 Limit the drink; it makes good sense (9)
3 Country engaged in taking back help (5)
4 Glorious rendering of "Under the Linden Tree" (7)
5 Annuls new caveats (7)
7 Rob with a gun (5)
8 Accommodation for a model family (5-5)
9 Invigorating new tune? (5,3)
14 How a food mixer can relieve boredom? (5,1,4)
16 Neglected but is found in fresh undies (2,6)
18 Perfectly proficient? (9)
20 Admit that you take in stolen goods? (7)
21 Thing to change into this evening (7)
23 A song from Cyril (5)
25 Deck or dock (5)
26 Head man in the stud (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6037 ACROSS: 1 Astride, 5 Codes, 8 Highchair, 9 Spa, 10 Same, 12 Refusing, 14 Pillow, 15 Mouser, 17 Endanger, 18 Blur, 21 Ego, 22 Inflation, 24 Title, 25 Resents DOWN: 1 Ashes, 2 Tug, 3 Inca, 4 Erased, 5 Circular, 6 Dismissal, 7 Stagger, 11 Maladroit, 13 Hornpipe, 14 Present, 16 Heifer, 19 Ranks, 20 Lass, 23 Ion

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

___ sullies the noblest character. - Marcus Livius Drusus Claudianus (5)

ANVER

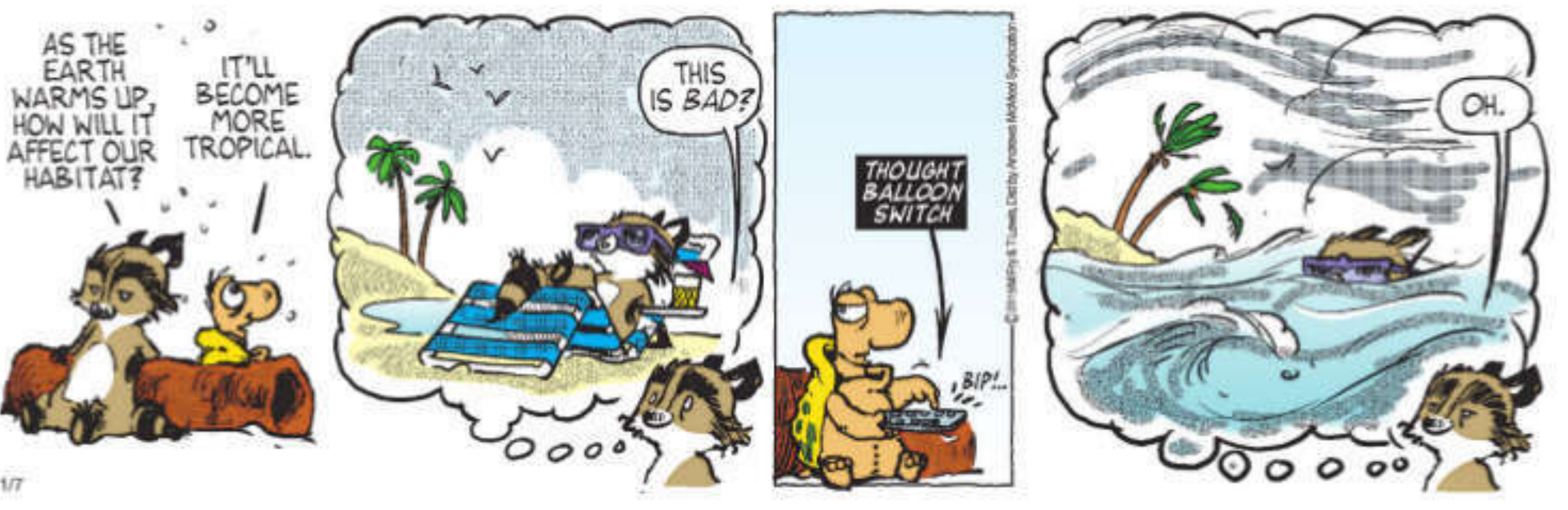
EELMYD

DEFNI

ACDILP

SOLUTIONS: ANVER: Raven, EELMYD: Friend, DEFNI: Friend, ACDILP: Placid

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



SUDOKU 6376

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6375

8 6 5 2 7 1 3 4 9
3 1 2 5 4 9 7 6 8
9 4 7 3 6 8 5 2 1
5 9 3 1 8 2 6 7 4
7 8 6 4 3 5 9 1 2
4 2 1 7 9 6 8 3 5
1 3 8 9 2 7 4 5 6
6 5 4 8 1 3 2 9 7
2 7 9 6 5 4 1 8 3

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is your kind of day. Be daring and bold with your visions for what might be, and don't hesitate to share your ideas. Be aware that with Mercury being retrograde, it's a poor time to initiate new things, but the perfect time to finish projects. Tonight: Discussions.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): You are the financial wizard of the zodiac. Today you might have spontaneous and imaginative ideas about how to boost your income. Believe in yourself. Tonight: Maintain your possessions.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): The Moon is in your sign creating a situation that is dreamy, bold and spontaneous. You are a fast-thinking. Do not dismiss your ideas today. Even though Mercury is retrograde, jot them down somewhere for future use. Tonight: You're strong.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Things tend to go your way because the Sun is in your sign attracting good circumstances and people to you. (Yes, Mercury retrograde is also in your sign, attracting ex-partners and old friends.) Enjoy talking with others today, and pay attention to ideas that pop up out of nowhere. Tonight: Solitude.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): This is an interesting day because you might meet a real character, or perhaps someone you know will surprise you with an unusual suggestion. Tonight: Be friendly.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Stay on your toes today, because parents, bosses and the police might suddenly do something that catches you off guard. However, an unexpected opportunity might come your way from an authority figure. Tonight: Look modest.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Sudden opportunities to travel might fall in your lap today. You might explore exciting avenues, you're brimming over with ideas that are imaginative, bold and doable. Write them down. Wait until Mercury retrograde is over. Tonight: Learn something new.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Keep an eye on financial matters related to shared property, taxes, debt, insurance issues and inheritances, because something unexpected might occur. It could be an opportunity to reshape things in a way that is better for you. Tonight: Check your finances.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This is an interesting day, in no small measure because a close friend, partner or spouse might suggest or do something that surprises you. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Your work routine might be interrupted today because of something unexpected. Whatever the case, be bold and consider new options and different opportunities. Tonight: Get better organized.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Artists can be creative and productive, because all kinds of spontaneous vibes are in the air. You might receive a surprise invitation. Parents should be vigilant about their kids to avoid accidents. Tonight: Be playful.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Something unexpected might change your home routine today. Perhaps a small appliance breaks down. Surprise company might arrive. Keep your cool. Tonight: Relax at home.

Government of Rajasthan

Office of the DSO KHAIRTHAL-TIJARA

Email:- dsfood-khe.tij-rj@nic.in

F)(PDS/Tender/2026/1815

Date:- 03/07/26

NOTICE INVITING BID 04/2026-27

e-Bids for selection of Handling and Transportation of Food grains Under PDS from FCI Depots to all FPS District Khairthal-Tijara are invited from interested bidders up to 22-07-26 time 06:00 pm. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://proc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <http://ppp.rajasthan.gov.in> of the state. The approximate value of the procurement is Rupees 2.25 Crore for One year.

NIB No. :-FCC2627A0071

UBN No. :-FCC2627SLOB00076

Sd/- District Supply Officer Khairthal-Tijara

DIPR/C/12108/2026

NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY AND JUDICIAL ACADEMY, ASSAM

(ESTABLISHED BY ASSAM ACT NO. XXV OF 2009)

HAJO ROAD, AMINGAON, GUWAHATI-781031

Adv. No.: NLUJAA/ADMIN/FIT-AUDIT/2026/42

Date: 10-07-2026

SNQ EXTENSION NOTICE

Quotations are invited from interested and eligible bidders for Comprehensive IT Audit of National Law University and Judicial Academy, Assam.

The last date for receipt of quotations is 15-07-2026.

For detailed terms and conditions, please visit www.nluassam.ac.in

Sd/- Registrar

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

DOGRA REGIMENTAL

In proud memory of Sep Suraj Parkash, SC of 6th Battalion The Dogra Regiment, who made the supreme sacrifice while serving the Nation at Nagaon (J&K) on 11 Jul 1997. Your act of valour, raw courage & devotion to duty will always remain a source of inspiration and motivation to all of us.

REMEMBERED BY COMMANDING OFFICER AND ALL RANKS 6 DOGRA

NORTHERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF TELANGANA LIMITED

Corporate Identity Number: U40109TG2000SGC034119

e-Auction Notice

TGNPDCL is intends to sale of Scrap Materials through e-auction platform. e-auction Specification No: CE/P&MM/SCR-01 TO SCR-03/2026-27.

Name of the Material: Various scrap materials. E-Auction starts From 01-08-2026 at 11.00 Hrs to 01.08.2026 at 13.00 Hrs.

INSPECTION: 15-07-2026 to 30.07.2026.(Every day from 10.00 Hrs. to 17.00 Hrs. Excluding Holidays)

EMD Submission Last date and Time is: 31.07.2026 at 17.00hrs.

For further details visit: auction.telangana.gov.in and www.tgnpdcl.in

For further details contact: Vupadhi Techno Services Pvt. Ltd Hyderabad M.No:7337445545 Note: Changes if any, shall be uploaded as corrigendum only through website: <http://www.auction.telangana.gov.in/>

MAIL ID: cgmpmm@tgnpdcl.com

Sd/-CHIEF ENGINEER (P&MM) TGNPDCL/WARANGAL

DIPR R.O.No.303-PP/CIL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:10-07-2026.

SCOPE Atul Sobti, DG, SCOPE and Anne Hammill, Associate VP, Resilience, IISD have recently signed a MoU to support the sustainable energy transition of Indian PSUs. The partnership will focus on climate resilience, renewable energy, ESG, green finance, capacity building and knowledge sharing. It will also strengthen the PSUs for PLANET platform to promote collaboration on decarbonisation and just transition.

PNB has launched the Tribal Plus Loan Scheme, a customised housing loan product for eligible borrowers in tribal areas under its Guwahati & Raipur Zones. Offering loans of up to Rs.40 lakh for housing-related needs, the scheme aims to improve access to formal credit, promote home ownership & strengthen financial inclusion in underserved tribal communities. Subodh Kumar, GM, PNB, said: "At PNB, we remain committed to expanding the reach of formal financial services to underserved parts of the country through innovative and need-based banking solutions."

NHB recently celebrated its 39th Foundation Day in New Delhi, marking nearly four decades of transformative contributions to the country's housing and finance sector. The event was graced by Hari Har Mishra, AS, DFS, GOI; Kuldip Narayan, Joint Secretary, MoHUA, GOI & other officials. The celebration featured the launch of the "NHB Term Deposit Scheme" & a national-level "Housing Design Competition," alongside the signing of a MoU with IIT Roorkee for technical collaboration.



BOB Mizuho Bank and Bank of Baroda have entered into a strategic partnership to strengthen collaboration in M&A financing, structured lending, cross-border financing and corporate and investment banking. The alliance combines Mizuho's global expertise and international network with Bank of Baroda's strong domestic presence and deep understanding of the Indian corporate market.

DTC The Government of NCT of Delhi will gradually replace paper-based pink tickets with the Pink Saheli Smart Card (NCMC) for women availing free travel on DTC and DoT (Cluster) buses. Paper tickets will remain valid until 31 July 2026. From 1 August 2026, only women carrying a valid Pink Saheli Smart Card will be eligible for the free travel benefit, while others will have to purchase regular tickets.

CORPORATE BRIEFS



PRESENTATION OF LETTERS OF CREDENCE H.E. Dr. Ulziit Luvsanjav, Ambassador Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary of Mongolia to the Republic of India, presented his Letters of Credence to H.E. Smt. Droupadi Murmu, President of India. He conveyed the greetings of President Khurelsukh Ukhnaa, reaffirmed the invitation for a visit to Mongolia, and pledged to further strengthen the Mongolia-India Strategic Partnership.

SAIL recently signed an MoU with PT Krakatau Steel (Persero) Tbk in New Delhi to explore a joint venture for manufacturing stainless steel slabs in Indonesia. Announced during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Indonesia visit, the partnership combines Indonesia's nickel resources with SAIL's steelmaking expertise to meet growing demand in India and ASEAN. The proposed Joint Venture is expected to support the increasing demand for stainless steel in India & the ASEAN region while promoting value addition to Indonesia's mineral resources.

SCOPE and International Coaching Federation (ICF), USA, the world's largest coaching organisation convened a Roundtable on "Coaching for National Transformation". Atul Sobti, DG, SCOPE, Ms. Magdalena Nowicka Mook, CEO, ICF and Robert Garcia, Vice President, CIO, ICF addressed the roundtable. CMDs, Directors, SCOPE Executive Board Members and senior officers from major public sector organisations took part in the roundtable. Various aspects of coaching, its growing need in today's time and how PSEs can embed coaching in the organisational strategy to ensure its effectiveness were discussed during the meet. This roundtable marks a milestone in the long-term collaboration between SCOPE and ICF. Highlighting the vision behind the initiative, Atul Sobti underscored SCOPE and ICF's commitment to advancing governance excellence and national leadership capabilities.

EAST WEST DEDICATED FREIGHT CORRIDOR (EWDF)

DFCCIL recently organised a stakeholder conference at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi on the proposed EWDFC. The event was led by Praveen Kumar, MD, DFCCIL; Shyam Sundar Gupta, Principal ED (Infrastructure), Railway Board & others. Convened by Ajay Kumar, ED (Asset Management) & Sanjeev Gupta, ED (Finance), the conference was attended by Shobhit Bhatnagar, Director (Operations & Business Development) & other officials.

RKGIIT has signed an MoU with IIT Mandi to offer a six-semester Minor Degree Programme in Artificial Intelligence. IIT Mandi will design, teach & evaluate one AI course each semester, with successful students receiving a Minor Degree Certificate, enhancing their technical skills, employability & multidisciplinary learning. Director Dr. B.C. Sharma said the initiatives align with the National Education Policy by promoting multidisciplinary, industry-oriented education.

NNG Ghaziabad Municipal Corporation will undertake a mega plantation drive on 12 July across Vijaynagar and all 100 wards, targeting 1.4 lakh saplings. Preparations are being led by Dr. Anuj, Garden Incharge, and Narendra Kumar Chaudhary, Senior Garden Incharge. The Municipal Commissioner has appealed for public participation, with geo-tagging through the Haritima Amrit Van app and support from over 800 gardeners.

GDA recently held a meeting with operators of schools, coaching institutes, play schools & day care centres sealed for building by-law violations. Chaired by GDA Secretary Vivek Kumar Mishra, the meeting focused on fire safety compliance & regulatory requirements. The Authority granted a two-month extension for institutions to obtain building plan approvals, fire safety NOCs and complete other mandatory legal formalities.